

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns, rendered in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 23

Isaiah

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 23*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Isaiah

Isaiah 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 The vision that Isaiah son of Amoz saw regarding Judah and Jerusalem during the times of the kings of Judah: Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah.
- 1 The vision concerning Judah and Jerusalem that Isaiah son of Amoz saw during the reigns of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.
- 2 Heaven and earth, you're the jury. Listen to GOD's case: "I had children and raised them well, and they turned on me.
- 2 Hear, O heavens! Listen, O earth! For the LORD has spoken: "I reared children and brought them up, but they have rebelled against me.
- 3 The ox knows who's boss, the mule knows the hand that feeds him, But not Israel. My people don't know up from down.
- 3 The ox knows his master, the donkey his owner's manger, but Israel does not know, my people do not understand."
- 4 Shame! Misguided GOD-dropouts, staggering under their guilt-baggage, Gang of miscreants, band of vandals-- My people have walked out on me, their GOD, turned their backs on The Holy of Israel, walked off and never looked back.
- 4 Ah, sinful nation, a people loaded with guilt, a brood of evildoers, children given to corruption! They have forsaken the LORD; they have spurned the Holy One of Israel and turned their backs on him.
- 5 "Why bother even trying to do anything with you when you just keep to your bullheaded ways? You keep beating your heads against brick walls. Everything within you protests against you.
- 5 Why should you be beaten anymore? Why do you persist in rebellion? Your whole head is injured, your whole heart afflicted.
- 6 From the bottom of your feet to the top of your head, nothing's working right. Wounds and bruises and running sores-- untended, unwashed,

unbandaged.

- 6 From the sole of your foot to the top of your head there is no soundness-- only wounds and welts and open sores, not cleansed or bandaged or soothed with oil.
- 7 Your country is laid waste, your cities burned down. Your land is destroyed by outsiders while you watch, reduced to rubble by barbarians.
- 7 Your country is desolate, your cities burned with fire; your fields are being stripped by foreigners right before you, laid waste as when overthrown by strangers.
- 8 Daughter Zion is deserted-- like a tumbledown shack on a dead-end street, Like a tarpaper shanty on the wrong side of the tracks, like a sinking ship abandoned by the rats.
- 8 The Daughter of Zion is left like a shelter in a vineyard, like a hut in a field of melons, like a city under siege.
- 9 If GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies hadn't left us a few survivors, we'd be as desolate as Sodom, doomed just like Gomorrah.
- 9 Unless the LORD Almighty had left us some survivors, we would have become like Sodom, we would have been like Gomorrah.
- 10 "Listen to my Message, you Sodom-schooled leaders. Receive God's revelation, you Gomorrah-schooled people.
- 10 Hear the word of the LORD, you rulers of Sodom; listen to the law of our God, you people of Gomorrah!
- 11 "Why this frenzy of sacrifices?" GOD's asking. "Don't you think I've had my fill of burnt sacrifices, rams and plump grain-fed calves? Don't you think I've had my fill of blood from bulls, lambs, and goats?
- 11 The multitude of your sacrifices-- what are they to me? says the LORD. "I have more than enough of burnt offerings, of rams and the fat of fattened animals; I have no pleasure in the blood of bulls and lambs and goats.
- 12 When you come before me, who ever gave you the idea of acting like this, Running here and there, doing this and that-- all this sheer commotion in the place provided for worship?
- 12 When you come to appear before me, who has asked this of you, this trampling of my courts?
- 13 "Quit your worship charades. I can't stand your trivial religious games: Monthly conferences, weekly Sabbaths, special meetings-- meetings,

- meetings, meetings--I can't stand one more!
- 13 Stop bringing meaningless offerings! Your incense is detestable to me.
New Moons, Sabbaths and convocations-- I cannot bear your evil assemblies.
- 14 Meetings for this, meetings for that. I hate them! You've worn me out!
I'm sick of your religion, religion, religion, while you go right on sinning.
- 14 Your New Moon festivals and your appointed feasts my soul hates.
They have become a burden to me; I am weary of bearing them.
- 15 When you put on your next prayer-performance, I'll be looking the other way.
No matter how long or loud or often you pray, I'll not be listening.
And do you know why? Because you've been tearing people to pieces, and your hands are bloody.
- 15 When you spread out your hands in prayer, I will hide my eyes from you;
even if you offer many prayers, I will not listen. Your hands are full of blood;
- 16 Go home and wash up. Clean up your act. Sweep your lives clean of your evildoings
so I don't have to look at them any longer. Say no to wrong.
- 16 wash and make yourselves clean. Take your evil deeds out of my sight!
Stop doing wrong,
- 17 Learn to do good. Work for justice. Help the down-and-out. Stand up for the homeless.
Go to bat for the defenseless.
- 17 learn to do right! Seek justice, encourage the oppressed. Defend the cause of the fatherless,
plead the case of the widow.
- 18 "Come. Sit down. Let's argue this out." This is GOD's Message: "If your sins are blood-red,
they'll be snow-white. If they're red like crimson, they'll be like wool.
- 18 Come now, let us reason together, says the LORD. "Though your sins are like scarlet,
they shall be as white as snow; though they are red as crimson, they shall be like wool.
- 19 If you'll willingly obey, you'll feast like kings.
- 19 If you are willing and obedient, you will eat the best from the land;
- 20 But if you're willful and stubborn, you'll die like dogs." That's right. GOD says so.

- 20 but if you resist and rebel, you will be devoured by the sword." For the mouth of the LORD has spoken.
- 21 Oh! Can you believe it? The chaste city has become a whore! She was once all justice, everyone living as good neighbors, And now they're all at one another's throats.
- 21 See how the faithful city has become a harlot! She once was full of justice; righteousness used to dwell in her-- but now murderers!
- 22 Your coins are all counterfeits. Your wine is watered down.
- 22 Your silver has become dross, your choice wine is diluted with water.
- 23 Your leaders are turncoats who keep company with crooks. They sell themselves to the highest bidder and grab anything not nailed down. They never stand up for the homeless, never stick up for the defenseless.
- 23 Your rulers are rebels, companions of thieves; they all love bribes and chase after gifts. They do not defend the cause of the fatherless; the widow's case does not come before them.
- 24 This Decree, therefore, of the Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, the Strong One of Israel: "This is it! I'll get my oppressors off my back. I'll get back at my enemies.
- 24 Therefore the Lord, the LORD Almighty, the Mighty One of Israel, declares: "Ah, I will get relief from my foes and avenge myself on my enemies.
- 25 I'll give you the back of my hand, purge the junk from your life, clean you up.
- 25 I will turn my hand against you; I will thoroughly purge away your dross and remove all your impurities.
- 26 I'll set honest judges and wise counselors among you just like it was back in the beginning. Then you'll be renamed City-That-Treats-People-Right, the True-Blue City."
- 26 I will restore your judges as in days of old, your counselors as at the beginning. Afterward you will be called the City of Righteousness, the Faithful City."
- 27 GOD's right ways will put Zion right again. GOD's right actions will restore her penitents.
- 27 Zion will be redeemed with justice, her penitent ones with righteousness.

- 28 But it's curtains for rebels and GOD-traitors, a dead end for those who walk out on GOD.
- 28 But rebels and sinners will both be broken, and those who forsake the LORD will perish.
- 29 "Your dalliances in those oak grove shrines will leave you looking mighty foolish, All that fooling around in god and goddess gardens that you thought was the latest thing.
- 29 You will be ashamed because of the sacred oaks in which you have delighted; you will be disgraced because of the gardens that you have chosen.
- 30 You'll end up like an oak tree with all its leaves falling off, Like an unwatered garden, withered and brown.
- 30 You will be like an oak with fading leaves, like a garden without water.
- 31 'The Big Man' will turn out to be dead bark and twigs, and his 'work,' the spark that starts the fire That exposes man and work both as nothing but cinders and smoke."
- 31 The mighty man will become tinder and his work a spark; both will burn together, with no one to quench the fire."

Isaiah 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Message Isaiah got regarding Judah and Jerusalem:
- 1 This is what Isaiah son of Amoz saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem:
- 2 There's a day coming when the mountain of GOD's House Will be The Mountain-- solid, towering over all mountains. All nations will river toward it, people from all over set out for it.
- 2 In the last days the mountain of the LORD's temple will be established as chief among the mountains; it will be raised above the hills, and all nations will stream to it.
- 3 They'll say, "Come, let's climb GOD's Mountain, go to the House of the God of Jacob. He'll show us the way he works so we can live the way we're made." Zion's the source of the revelation. GOD's Message comes from Jerusalem.

- 3 Many peoples will come and say, "Come, let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, to the house of the God of Jacob. He will teach us his ways, so that we may walk in his paths." The law will go out from Zion, the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.
- 4 He'll settle things fairly between nations. He'll make things right between many peoples. They'll turn their swords into shovels, their spears into hoes. No more will nation fight nation; they won't play war anymore.
- 4 He will judge between the nations and will settle disputes for many peoples. They will beat their swords into plowshares and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation will not take up sword against nation, nor will they train for war anymore.
- 5 Come, family of Jacob, let's live in the light of GOD.
- 5 Come, O house of Jacob, let us walk in the light of the LORD.
- 6 GOD, you've walked out on your family Jacob because their world is full of hokey religion, Philistine witchcraft, and pagan hocus-pocus,
- 6 You have abandoned your people, the house of Jacob. They are full of superstitions from the East; they practice divination like the Philistines and clasp hands with pagans.
- 7 a world rolling in wealth, Stuffed with things, no end to its machines and gadgets,
- 7 Their land is full of silver and gold; there is no end to their treasures. Their land is full of horses; there is no end to their chariots.
- 8 And gods--gods of all sorts and sizes. These people make their own gods and worship what they make.
- 8 Their land is full of idols; they bow down to the work of their hands, to what their fingers have made.
- 9 A degenerate race, facedown in the gutter. Don't bother with them! They're not worth forgiving!
- 9 So man will be brought low and mankind humbled-- do not forgive them.
- 10 Head for the hills, hide in the caves From the terror of GOD, from his dazzling presence.
- 10 Go into the rocks, hide in the ground from dread of the LORD and the splendor of his majesty!
- 11 People with a big head are headed for a fall, pretentious egos brought down a peg. It's GOD alone at front-and-center on the Day we're talking about,

- 11 The eyes of the arrogant man will be humbled and the pride of men brought low; the LORD alone will be exalted in that day.
- 12 The Day that GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies is matched against all big-talking rivals, against all swaggering big names;
- 12 The LORD Almighty has a day in store for all the proud and lofty, for all that is exalted (and they will be humbled),
- 13 Against all giant sequoias hugely towering, and against the expansive chestnut;
- 13 for all the cedars of Lebanon, tall and lofty, and all the oaks of Bashan,
- 14 Against Kilimanjaro and Annapurna, against the ranges of Alps and Andes;
- 14 for all the towering mountains and all the high hills,
- 15 Against every soaring skyscraper, against all proud obelisks and statues;
- 15 for every lofty tower and every fortified wall,
- 16 Against ocean-going luxury liners, against elegant three-masted schooners.
- 16 for every trading ship and every stately vessel.
- 17 The swelled big heads will be punctured bladders, the pretentious egos brought down to earth, Leaving GOD alone at front-and-center on the Day we're talking about.
- 17 The arrogance of man will be brought low and the pride of men humbled; the LORD alone will be exalted in that day,
- 18 And all those sticks and stones dressed up to look like gods will be gone for good.
- 18 and the idols will totally disappear.
- 19 Clamber into caves in the cliffs, duck into any hole you can find. Hide from the terror of GOD, from his dazzling presence, When he assumes his full stature on earth, towering and terrifying.
- 19 Men will flee to caves in the rocks and to holes in the ground from dread of the LORD and the splendor of his majesty, when he rises to shake the earth.
- 20 On that Day men and women will take the sticks and stones They've decked out in gold and silver to look like gods and then worshiped, And they will dump them in any ditch or gully,
- 20 In that day men will throw away to the rodents and bats their idols of silver and idols of gold, which they made to worship.

- 21 Then run for rock caves and cliff hideouts To hide from the terror of GOD, from his dazzling presence, When he assumes his full stature on earth, towering and terrifying.
- 21 They will flee to caverns in the rocks and to the overhanging crags from dread of the LORD and the splendor of his majesty, when he rises to shake the earth.
- 22 Quit scraping and fawning over mere humans, so full of themselves, so full of hot air! Can't you see there's nothing to them?
- 22 Stop trusting in man, who has but a breath in his nostrils. Of what account is he?

Isaiah 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, is emptying Jerusalem and Judah Of all the basic necessities, plain bread and water to begin with.
- 1 See now, the Lord, the LORD Almighty, is about to take from Jerusalem and Judah both supply and support: all supplies of food and all supplies of water,
- 2 He's withdrawing police and protection, judges and courts, pastors and teachers,
- 2 the hero and warrior, the judge and prophet, the soothsayer and elder,
- 3 captains and generals, doctors and nurses, and, yes, even the repairmen and jacks-of-all-trades.
- 3 the captain of fifty and man of rank, the counselor, skilled craftsman and clever enchanter.
- 4 He says, "I'll put little kids in charge of the city. Schoolboys and schoolgirls will order everyone around.
- 4 I will make boys their officials; mere children will govern them.
- 5 People will be at each other's throats, stabbing one another in the back: Neighbor against neighbor, young against old, the no-account against the well-respected.
- 5 People will oppress each other-- man against man, neighbor against neighbor. The young will rise up against the old, the base against the honorable.

- 6 One brother will grab another and say, 'You look like you've got a head on your shoulders. Do something! Get us out of this mess.'
- 6 A man will seize one of his brothers at his father's home, and say, "You have a cloak, you be our leader; take charge of this heap of ruins!"
- 7 And he'll say, 'Me? Not me! I don't have a clue. Don't put me in charge of anything.'
- 7 But in that day he will cry out, "I have no remedy. I have no food or clothing in my house; do not make me the leader of the people."
- 8 "Jerusalem's on its last legs. Judah is soon down for the count. Everything people say and do is at cross-purposes with GOD, a slap in my face.
- 8 Jerusalem staggers, Judah is falling; their words and deeds are against the LORD, defying his glorious presence.
- 9 Brazen in their depravity, they flout their sins like degenerate Sodom. Doom to their eternal souls! They've made their bed; now they'll sleep in it.
- 9 The look on their faces testifies against them; they parade their sin like Sodom; they do not hide it. Woe to them! They have brought disaster upon themselves.
- 10 "Reassure the righteous that their good living will pay off.
- 10 Tell the righteous it will be well with them, for they will enjoy the fruit of their deeds.
- 11 But doom to the wicked! Disaster! Everything they did will be done to them.
- 11 Woe to the wicked! Disaster is upon them! They will be paid back for what their hands have done.
- 12 "Skinny kids terrorize my people. Silly girls bully them around. My dear people! Your leaders are taking you down a blind alley. They're sending you off on a wild goose chase."
- 12 Youths oppress my people, women rule over them. O my people, your guides lead you astray; they turn you from the path.
- 13 GOD enters the courtroom. He takes his place at the bench to judge his people.
- 13 The LORD takes his place in court; he rises to judge the people.
- 14 GOD calls for order in the court, hauls the leaders of his people into the dock: "You've played havoc with this country. Your houses are stuffed

with what you've stolen from the poor.

14 The LORD enters into judgment against the elders and leaders of his people: "It is you who have ruined my vineyard; the plunder from the poor is in your houses.

15 What is this anyway? Stomping on my people, grinding the faces of the poor into the dirt?" That's what the Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, says.

15 What do you mean by crushing my people and grinding the faces of the poor?" declares the Lord, the LORD Almighty.

16 GOD says, "Zion women are stuck-up, prancing around in their high heels, Making eyes at all the men in the street, swinging their hips, Tossing their hair, gaudy and garish in cheap jewelry."

16 The LORD says, "The women of Zion are haughty, walking along with outstretched necks, flirting with their eyes, tripping along with mincing steps, with ornaments jingling on their ankles.

17 The Master will fix it so those Zion women will all turn bald-- Scabby, bald-headed women. The Master will do it.

17 Therefore the Lord will bring sores on the heads of the women of Zion; the LORD will make their scalps bald."

18 The time is coming when the Master will strip them of their fancy baubles--

18 In that day the Lord will snatch away their finery: the bangles and headbands and crescent necklaces,

19 the dangling earrings, anklets and bracelets,

19 the earrings and bracelets and veils,

20 combs and mirrors and silk scarves, diamond brooches and pearl necklaces,

20 the headdresses and ankle chains and sashes, the perfume bottles and charms,

21 the rings on their fingers and the rings on their toes,

21 the signet rings and nose rings,

22 the latest fashions in hats, exotic perfumes and aphrodisiacs, gowns and capes,

22 the fine robes and the capes and cloaks, the purses

23 all the world's finest in fabrics and design.

23 and mirrors, and the linen garments and tiaras and shawls.

- 24 Instead of wearing seductive scents, these women are going to smell like rotting cabbages; Instead of modeling flowing gowns, they'll be sporting rags; Instead of their stylish hairdos, scruffy heads; Instead of beauty marks, scabs and scars.
- 24 Instead of fragrance there will be a stench; instead of a sash, a rope; instead of well-dressed hair, baldness; instead of fine clothing, sackcloth; instead of beauty, branding.
- 25 Your finest fighting men will be killed, your soldiers left dead on the battlefield.
- 25 Your men will fall by the sword, your warriors in battle.
- 26 The entrance gate to Zion will be clotted with people mourning their dead-- A city stooped under the weight of her loss, brought to her knees by her sorrows.
- 26 The gates of Zion will lament and mourn; destitute, she will sit on the ground.

Isaiah 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 That will be the day when seven women will gang up on one man, saying, "We'll take care of ourselves, get our own food and clothes. Just give us a child. Make us pregnant so we'll have something to live for!"
- 1 In that day seven women will take hold of one man and say, "We will eat our own food and provide our own clothes; only let us be called by your name. Take away our disgrace!"
- 2 And that's when GOD's Branch will sprout green and lush. The produce of the country will give Israel's survivors something to be proud of again. Oh, they'll hold their heads high!
- 2 In that day the Branch of the LORD will be beautiful and glorious, and the fruit of the land will be the pride and glory of the survivors in Israel.
- 3 Everyone left behind in Zion, all the discards and rejects in Jerusalem, will be reclassified as "holy"--alive and therefore precious.
- 3 Those who are left in Zion, who remain in Jerusalem, will be called holy, all who are recorded among the living in Jerusalem.

- 4 GOD will give Zion's women a good bath. He'll scrub the bloodstained city of its violence and brutality, purge the place with a firestorm of judgment.
- 4 The Lord will wash away the filth of the women of Zion; he will cleanse the bloodstains from Jerusalem by a spirit of judgment and a spirit of fire.
- 5 Then GOD will bring back the ancient pillar of cloud by day and the pillar of fire by night and mark Mount Zion and everyone in it with his glorious presence, his immense, protective presence,
- 5 Then the LORD will create over all of Mount Zion and over those who assemble there a cloud of smoke by day and a glow of flaming fire by night; over all the glory will be a canopy.
- 6 shade from the burning sun and shelter from the driving rain.
- 6 It will be a shelter and shade from the heat of the day, and a refuge and hiding place from the storm and rain.

Isaiah 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 I'll sing a ballad to the one I love, a love ballad about his vineyard: The one I love had a vineyard, a fine, well-placed vineyard.
- 1 I will sing for the one I love a song about his vineyard: My loved one had a vineyard on a fertile hillside.
- 2 He hoed the soil and pulled the weeds, and planted the very best vines. He built a lookout, built a winepress, a vineyard to be proud of. He looked for a vintage yield of grapes, but for all his pains he got junk grapes.
- 2 He dug it up and cleared it of stones and planted it with the choicest vines. He built a watchtower in it and cut out a winepress as well. Then he looked for a crop of good grapes, but it yielded only bad fruit.
- 3 "Now listen to what I'm telling you, you who live in Jerusalem and Judah. What do you think is going on between me and my vineyard?
- 3 Now you dwellers in Jerusalem and men of Judah, judge between me and my vineyard.

- 4 Can you think of anything I could have done to my vineyard that I didn't do? When I expected good grapes, why did I get bitter grapes?
- 4 What more could have been done for my vineyard than I have done for it? When I looked for good grapes, why did it yield only bad?
- 5 "Well now, let me tell you what I'll do to my vineyard: I'll tear down its fence and let it go to ruin. I'll knock down the gate and let it be trampled.
- 5 Now I will tell you what I am going to do to my vineyard: I will take away its hedge, and it will be destroyed; I will break down its wall, and it will be trampled.
- 6 I'll turn it into a patch of weeds, untended, uncared for-- thistles and thorns will take over. I'll give orders to the clouds: 'Don't rain on that vineyard, ever!'"
- 6 I will make it a wasteland, neither pruned nor cultivated, and briers and thorns will grow there. I will command the clouds not to rain on it."
- 7 Do you get it? The vineyard of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies is the country of Israel. All the men and women of Judah are the garden he was so proud of. He looked for a crop of justice and saw them murdering each other. He looked for a harvest of righteousness and heard only the moans of victims.
- 7 The vineyard of the LORD Almighty is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah are the garden of his delight. And he looked for justice, but saw bloodshed; for righteousness, but heard cries of distress.
- 8 Doom to you who buy up all the houses and grab all the land for yourselves-- Evicting the old owners, posting NO TRESPASSING signs, Taking over the country, leaving everyone homeless and landless.
- 8 Woe to you who add house to house and join field to field till no space is left and you live alone in the land.
- 9 I overheard GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies say: "Those mighty houses will end up empty. Those extravagant estates will be deserted.
- 9 The LORD Almighty has declared in my hearing: "Surely the great houses will become desolate, the fine mansions left without occupants.
- 10 A ten-acre vineyard will produce a pint of wine, a fifty-pound sack of seed, a quart of grain."
- 10 A ten-acre vineyard will produce only a bath of wine, a homer of seed only an ephah of grain."

- 11 Doom to those who get up early and start drinking booze before breakfast, Who stay up all hours of the night drinking themselves into a stupor.
- 11 Woe to those who rise early in the morning to run after their drinks, who stay up late at night till they are inflamed with wine.
- 12 They make sure their banquets are well-furnished with harps and flutes and plenty of wine, But they'll have nothing to do with the work of GOD, pay no mind to what he is doing.
- 12 They have harps and lyres at their banquets, tambourines and flutes and wine, but they have no regard for the deeds of the LORD, no respect for the work of his hands.
- 13 Therefore my people will end up in exile because they don't know the score. Their "big men" will starve to death and the common people die of thirst.
- 13 Therefore my people will go into exile for lack of understanding; their men of rank will die of hunger and their masses will be parched with thirst.
- 14 Sheol developed a huge appetite, swallowing people nonstop! Big people and little people alike down that gullet, to say nothing of all the drunks.
- 14 Therefore the grave enlarges its appetite and opens its mouth without limit; into it will descend their nobles and masses with all their brawlers and revelers.
- 15 The down-and-out on a par with the high-and-mighty, Windbag boasters crumpled, flaccid as a punctured bladder.
- 15 So man will be brought low and mankind humbled, the eyes of the arrogant humbled.
- 16 But by working justice, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will be a mountain. By working righteousness, Holy God will show what "holy" is.
- 16 But the LORD Almighty will be exalted by his justice, and the holy God will show himself holy by his righteousness.
- 17 And lambs will graze as if they owned the place, Kids and calves right at home in the ruins.
- 17 Then sheep will graze as in their own pasture; lambs will feed among the ruins of the rich.

- 18 Doom to you who use lies to sell evil, who haul sin to market by the truckload,
- 18 Woe to those who draw sin along with cords of deceit, and wickedness as with cart ropes,
- 19 Who say, "What's God waiting for? Let him get a move on so we can see it. Whatever The Holy of Israel has cooked up, we'd like to check it out."
- 19 to those who say, "Let God hurry, let him hasten his work so we may see it. Let it approach, let the plan of the Holy One of Israel come, so we may know it."
- 20 Doom to you who call evil good and good evil, Who put darkness in place of light and light in place of darkness, Who substitute bitter for sweet and sweet for bitter!
- 20 Woe to those who call evil good and good evil, who put darkness for light and light for darkness, who put bitter for sweet and sweet for bitter.
- 21 Doom to you who think you're so smart, who hold such a high opinion of yourselves!
- 21 Woe to those who are wise in their own eyes and clever in their own sight.
- 22 All you're good at is drinking--champion boozers who collect trophies from drinking bouts
- 22 Woe to those who are heroes at drinking wine and champions at mixing drinks,
- 23 And then line your pockets with bribes from the guilty while you violate the rights of the innocent.
- 23 who acquit the guilty for a bribe, but deny justice to the innocent.
- 24 But they won't get by with it. As fire eats stubble and dry grass goes up in smoke, Their souls will atrophy, their achievements crumble into dust, Because they said no to the revelation of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, Would have nothing to do with The Holy of Israel.
- 24 Therefore, as tongues of fire lick up straw and as dry grass sinks down in the flames, so their roots will decay and their flowers blow away like dust; for they have rejected the law of the LORD Almighty and spurned the word of the Holy One of Israel.

- 25 That's why GOD flamed out in anger against his people, reached out and knocked them down. The mountains trembled as their dead bodies piled up in the streets. But even after that, he was still angry, his fist still raised, ready to hit them again.
- 25 Therefore the LORD's anger burns against his people; his hand is raised and he strikes them down. The mountains shake, and the dead bodies are like refuse in the streets. Yet for all this, his anger is not turned away, his hand is still upraised.
- 26 He raises a flag, signaling a distant nation, whistles for people at the ends of the earth. And here they come-- on the run!
- 26 He lifts up a banner for the distant nations, he whistles for those at the ends of the earth. Here they come, swiftly and speedily!
- 27 None drag their feet, no one stumbles, no one sleeps or dawdles. Shirts are on and pants buckled, every boot is spit-polished and tied.
- 27 Not one of them grows tired or stumbles, not one slumbers or sleeps; not a belt is loosened at the waist, not a sandal thong is broken.
- 28 Their arrows are sharp, bows strung, The hooves of their horses shod, chariot wheels greased.
- 28 Their arrows are sharp, all their bows are strung; their horses' hoofs seem like flint, their chariot wheels like a whirlwind.
- 29 Roaring like a pride of lions, the full-throated roars of young lions, They growl and seize their prey, dragging it off--no rescue for that one!
- 29 Their roar is like that of the lion, they roar like young lions; they growl as they seize their prey and carry it off with no one to rescue.
- 30 They'll roar and roar and roar on that Day, like the roar of ocean billows. Look as long and hard as you like at that land, you'll see nothing but darkness and trouble. Every light in the sky will be blacked out by the clouds.
- 30 In that day they will roar over it like the roaring of the sea. And if one looks at the land, he will see darkness and distress; even the light will be darkened by the clouds.

Isaiah 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Master sitting on a throne-- high, exalted!--and the train of his robes filled the Temple.
- 1 In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord seated on a throne, high and exalted, and the train of his robe filled the temple.
- 2 Angel-seraphs hovered above him, each with six wings. With two wings they covered their faces, with two their feet, and with two they flew."
- 2 Above him were seraphs, each with six wings: With two wings they covered their faces, with two they covered their feet, and with two they were flying.
- 3 And they called back and forth one to the other, Holy, Holy, Holy is GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies. His bright glory fills the whole earth.
- 3 And they were calling to one another: "Holy, holy, holy is the LORD Almighty; the whole earth is full of his glory."
- 4 The foundations trembled at the sound of the angel voices, and then the whole house filled with smoke.
- 4 At the sound of their voices the doorposts and thresholds shook and the temple was filled with smoke.
- 5 I said, "Doom! It's Doomsday! I'm as good as dead! Every word I've ever spoken is tainted-- blasphemous even! And the people I live with talk the same way, using words that corrupt and desecrate. And here I've looked God in the face! The King! GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies!"
- 5 Woe to me! I cried. "I am ruined! For I am a man of unclean lips, and I live among a people of unclean lips, and my eyes have seen the King, the LORD Almighty."
- 6 Then one of the angel-seraphs flew to me. He held a live coal that he had taken with tongs from the altar.
- 6 Then one of the seraphs flew to me with a live coal in his hand, which he had taken with tongs from the altar.
- 7 He touched my mouth with the coal and said, "Look. This coal has touched your lips. Gone your guilt, your sins wiped out."
- 7 With it he touched my mouth and said, "See, this has touched your lips; your guilt is taken away and your sin atoned for."
- 8 And then I heard the voice of the Master: "Whom shall I send? Who will go for us?" I spoke up, "I'll go. Send me!"
- 8 Then I heard the voice of the Lord saying, "Whom shall I send? And who will go for us?" And I said, "Here am I. Send me!"

- 9 He said, "Go and tell this people: "'Listen hard, but you aren't going to get it; look hard, but you won't catch on.'
- 9 He said, "Go and tell this people: " 'Be ever hearing, but never understanding; be ever seeing, but never perceiving.'
- 10 Make these people blockheads, with fingers in their ears and blindfolds on their eyes, So they won't see a thing, won't hear a word, So they won't have a clue about what's going on and, yes, so they won't turn around and be made whole."
- 10 Make the heart of this people calloused; make their ears dull and close their eyes. Otherwise they might see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their hearts, and turn and be healed."
- 11 Astonished, I said, "And Master, how long is this to go on?" He said, "Until the cities are emptied out, not a soul left in the cities-- Houses empty of people, countryside empty of people.
- 11 Then I said, "For how long, O Lord?" And he answered: "Until the cities lie ruined and without inhabitant, until the houses are left deserted and the fields ruined and ravaged,
- 12 Until I, GOD, get rid of everyone, sending them off, the land totally empty.
- 12 until the LORD has sent everyone far away and the land is utterly forsaken.
- 13 And even if some should survive, say a tenth, the devastation will start up again. The country will look like pine and oak forest with every tree cut down-- Every tree a stump, a huge field of stumps. But there's a holy seed in those stumps."
- 13 And though a tenth remains in the land, it will again be laid waste. But as the terebinth and oak leave stumps when they are cut down, so the holy seed will be the stump in the land."

Isaiah 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 During the time that Ahaz son of Jothan, son of Uzziah, was king of Judah, King Rezin of Aram and King Pekah son of Remaliah of Israel attacked Jerusalem, but the attack sputtered out.

- 1 When Ahaz son of Jotham, the son of Uzziah, was king of Judah, King Rezin of Aram and Pekah son of Remaliah king of Israel marched up to fight against Jerusalem, but they could not overpower it.
- 2 When the Davidic government learned that Aram had joined forces with Ephraim (that is, Israel), Ahaz and his people were badly shaken. They shook like trees in the wind.
- 2 Now the house of David was told, "Aram has allied itself with Ephraim"; so the hearts of Ahaz and his people were shaken, as the trees of the forest are shaken by the wind.
- 3 Then GOD told Isaiah, "Go and meet Ahaz. Take your son Shear-jashub (A-Remnant-Will-Return) with you. Meet him south of the city at the end of the aqueduct where it empties into the upper pool on the road to the public laundry.
- 3 Then the LORD said to Isaiah, "Go out, you and your son Shear-Jashub, to meet Ahaz at the end of the aqueduct of the Upper Pool, on the road to the Washerman's Field.
- 4 Tell him, Listen, calm down. Don't be afraid. And don't panic over these two burnt-out cases, Rezin of Aram and the son of Remaliah. They talk big but there's nothing to them.
- 4 Say to him, 'Be careful, keep calm and don't be afraid. Do not lose heart because of these two smoldering stubs of firewood--because of the fierce anger of Rezin and Aram and of the son of Remaliah.
- 5 Aram, along with Ephraim's son of Remaliah, have plotted to do you harm. They've conspired against you, saying,
- 5 Aram, Ephraim and Remaliah's son have plotted your ruin, saying,
- 6 'Let's go to war against Judah, dismember it, take it for ourselves, and set the son of Tabeel up as a puppet king over it.'
- 6 Let us invade Judah; let us tear it apart and divide it among ourselves, and make the son of Tabeel king over it.
- 7 But GOD, the Master, says, "It won't happen. Nothing will come of it
- 7 Yet this is what the Sovereign LORD says: " 'It will not take place, it will not happen,
- 8 Because the capital of Aram is Damascus and the king of Damascus is a mere man, Rezin. As for Ephraim, in sixty-five years it will be rubble, nothing left of it.

- 8 for the head of Aram is Damascus, and the head of Damascus is only Rezin. Within sixty-five years Ephraim will be too shattered to be a people.
- 9 The capital of Ephraim is Samaria, and the king of Samaria is the mere son of Remaliah. If you don't take your stand in faith, you won't have a leg to stand on."
- 9 The head of Ephraim is Samaria, and the head of Samaria is only Remaliah's son. If you do not stand firm in your faith, you will not stand at all.' "
- 10 GOD spoke again to Ahaz. This time he said,
- 10 Again the LORD spoke to Ahaz,
- 11 "Ask for a sign from your GOD. Ask anything. Be extravagant. Ask for the moon!"
- 11 Ask the LORD your God for a sign, whether in the deepest depths or in the highest heights.
- 12 But Ahaz said, "I'd never do that. I'd never make demands like that on GOD!"
- 12 But Ahaz said, "I will not ask; I will not put the LORD to the test."
- 13 So Isaiah told him, "Then listen to this, government of David! It's bad enough that you make people tired with your pious, timid hypocrisies, but now you're making God tired.
- 13 Then Isaiah said, "Hear now, you house of David! Is it not enough to try the patience of men? Will you try the patience of my God also?
- 14 So the Master is going to give you a sign anyway. Watch for this: A girl who is presently a virgin will get pregnant. She'll bear a son and name him Immanuel (God-With-Us).
- 14 Therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign: The virgin will be with child and will give birth to a son, and will call him Immanuel.
- 15 By the time the child is twelve years old, able to make moral decisions,
- 15 He will eat curds and honey when he knows enough to reject the wrong and choose the right.
- 16 the threat of war will be over. Relax, those two kings that have you so worried will be out of the picture.
- 16 But before the boy knows enough to reject the wrong and choose the right, the land of the two kings you dread will be laid waste.

- 17 But also be warned: GOD will bring on you and your people and your government a judgment worse than anything since the time the kingdom split, when Ephraim left Judah. The king of Assyria is coming!"
- 17 The LORD will bring on you and on your people and on the house of your father a time unlike any since Ephraim broke away from Judah--he will bring the king of Assyria."
- 18 That's when GOD will whistle for the flies at the headwaters of Egypt's Nile, and whistle for the bees in the land of Assyria.
- 18 In that day the LORD will whistle for flies from the distant streams of Egypt and for bees from the land of Assyria.
- 19 They'll come and infest every nook and cranny of this country. There'll be no getting away from them.
- 19 They will all come and settle in the steep ravines and in the crevices in the rocks, on all the thornbushes and at all the water holes.
- 20 And that's when the Master will take the razor rented from across the Euphrates--the king of Assyria no less!--and shave the hair off your heads and genitals, leaving you shamed, exposed, and denuded. He'll shave off your beards while he's at it.
- 20 In that day the Lord will use a razor hired from beyond the River--the king of Assyria--to shave your head and the hair of your legs, and to take off your beards also.
- 21 It will be a time when survivors will count themselves lucky to have a cow and a couple of sheep.
- 21 In that day, a man will keep alive a young cow and two goats.
- 22 At least they'll have plenty of milk! Whoever's left in the land will learn to make do with the simplest foods--curds, say, and honey.
- 22 And because of the abundance of the milk they give, he will have curds to eat. All who remain in the land will eat curds and honey.
- 23 But that's not the end of it. This country that used to be covered with fine vineyards--thousands of them, worth millions!--will revert to a weed patch.
- 23 In that day, in every place where there were a thousand vines worth a thousand silver shekels, there will be only briars and thorns.
- 24 Weeds and thorn bushes everywhere! Good for nothing except, perhaps, hunting rabbits.

- 24 Men will go there with bow and arrow, for the land will be covered with briers and thorns.
- 25 Cattle and sheep will forage as best they can in the fields of weeds--but there won't be a trace of all those fertile and well-tended gardens and fields.
- 25 As for all the hills once cultivated by the hoe, you will no longer go there for fear of the briers and thorns; they will become places where cattle are turned loose and where sheep run.

Isaiah 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then GOD told me, "Get a big sheet of paper and write in indelible ink, 'This belongs to Maher-shalal-hash-baz (Spoil-Speeds-Plunder-Hurries).'"
- 1 The LORD said to me, "Take a large scroll and write on it with an ordinary pen: Maher-Shalal-Hash-Baz.
- 2 I got two honest men, Uriah the priest and Zechariah son of Jeberekiah, to witness the document.
- 2 And I will call in Uriah the priest and Zechariah son of Jeberekiah as reliable witnesses for me."
- 3 Then I went home to my wife, the prophetess. She conceived and gave birth to a son. GOD told me, "Name him Maher-shalal-hash-baz.
- 3 Then I went to the prophetess, and she conceived and gave birth to a son. And the LORD said to me, "Name him Maher-Shalal-Hash- Baz.
- 4 Before that baby says 'Daddy' or 'Mamma' the king of Assyria will have plundered the wealth of Damascus and the riches of Samaria."
- 4 Before the boy knows how to say 'My father' or 'My mother,' the wealth of Damascus and the plunder of Samaria will be carried off by the king of Assyria."
- 5 GOD spoke to me again, saying:
- 5 The LORD spoke to me again:
- 6 "Because this people has turned its back on the gently flowing stream of Shiloah And gotten all excited over Rezin and the son of Remaliah,

- 6 Because this people has rejected the gently flowing waters of Shiloah and rejoices over Rezin and the son of Remaliah,
- 7 I'm stepping in and facing them with the wild floodwaters of the Euphrates, The king of Assyria and all his fanfare, a river in flood, bursting its banks,
- 7 therefore the Lord is about to bring against them the mighty floodwaters of the River-- the king of Assyria with all his pomp. It will overflow all its channels, run over all its banks
- 8 Pouring into Judah, sweeping everything before it, water up to your necks, A huge wingspan of a raging river, O Immanuel, spreading across your land."
- 8 and sweep on into Judah, swirling over it, passing through it and reaching up to the neck. Its outspread wings will cover the breadth of your land, O Immanuel!"
- 9 But face the facts, all you oppressors, and then wring your hands. Listen, all of you, far and near. Prepare for the worst and wring your hands. Yes, prepare for the worst and wring your hands!
- 9 Raise the war cry, you nations, and be shattered! Listen, all you distant lands. Prepare for battle, and be shattered! Prepare for battle, and be shattered!
- 10 Plan and plot all you want--nothing will come of it. All your talk is mere talk, empty words, Because when all is said and done, the last word is Immanuel--God-With-Us.
- 10 Devise your strategy, but it will be thwarted; propose your plan, but it will not stand, for God is with us.
- 11 GOD spoke strongly to me, grabbed me with both hands and warned me not to go along with this people. He said:
- 11 The LORD spoke to me with his strong hand upon me, warning me not to follow the way of this people. He said:
- 12 "Don't be like this people, always afraid somebody is plotting against them. Don't fear what they fear. Don't take on their worries.
- 12 Do not call conspiracy everything that these people call conspiracy; do not fear what they fear, and do not dread it.
- 13 If you're going to worry, worry about The Holy. Fear GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.

- 13 The LORD Almighty is the one you are to regard as holy, he is the one you are to fear, he is the one you are to dread,
- 14 The Holy can be either a Hiding Place or a Boulder blocking your way, The Rock standing in the willful way of both houses of Israel, A barbed-wire Fence preventing trespass to the citizens of Jerusalem.
- 14 and he will be a sanctuary; but for both houses of Israel he will be a stone that causes men to stumble and a rock that makes them fall. And for the people of Jerusalem he will be a trap and a snare.
- 15 Many of them are going to run into that Rock and get their bones broken, Get tangled up in that barbed wire and not get free of it."
- 15 Many of them will stumble; they will fall and be broken, they will be snared and captured."
- 16 Gather up the testimony, preserve the teaching for my followers,
- 16 Bind up the testimony and seal up the law among my disciples.
- 17 While I wait for GOD as long as he remains in hiding, while I wait and hope for him.
- 17 I will wait for the LORD, who is hiding his face from the house of Jacob. I will put my trust in him.
- 18 I stand my ground and hope, I and the children GOD gave me as signs to Israel, Warning signs and hope signs from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, who makes his home in Mount Zion.
- 18 Here am I, and the children the LORD has given me. We are signs and symbols in Israel from the LORD Almighty, who dwells on Mount Zion.
- 19 When people tell you, "Try out the fortunetellers. Consult the spiritualists. Why not tap into the spirit-world, get in touch with the dead?"
- 19 When men tell you to consult mediums and spiritists, who whisper and mutter, should not a people inquire of their God? Why consult the dead on behalf of the living?
- 20 Tell them, "No, we're going to study the Scriptures." People who try the other ways get nowhere--a dead end!
- 20 To the law and to the testimony! If they do not speak according to this word, they have no light of dawn.
- 21 Frustrated and famished, they try one thing after another. When nothing works out they get angry, cursing first this god and then that one, Looking this way and that,

- 21 Distressed and hungry, they will roam through the land; when they are famished, they will become enraged and, looking upward, will curse their king and their God.
- 22 up, down, and sideways--and seeing nothing, A blank wall, an empty hole. They end up in the dark with nothing.
- 22 Then they will look toward the earth and see only distress and darkness and fearful gloom, and they will be thrust into utter darkness.

Isaiah 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 But there'll be no darkness for those who were in trouble. Earlier he did bring the lands of Zebulun and Naphtali into disrepute, but the time is coming when he'll make that whole area glorious--the road along the Sea, the country past the Jordan, international Galilee.
- 1 Nevertheless, there will be no more gloom for those who were in distress. In the past he humbled the land of Zebulun and the land of Naphtali, but in the future he will honor Galilee of the Gentiles, by the way of the sea, along the Jordan--
- 2 The people who walked in darkness have seen a great light. For those who lived in a land of deep shadows-- light! sunbursts of light!
- 2 The people walking in darkness have seen a great light; on those living in the land of the shadow of death a light has dawned.
- 3 You repopulated the nation, you expanded its joy. Oh, they're so glad in your presence! Festival joy! The joy of a great celebration, sharing rich gifts and warm greetings.
- 3 You have enlarged the nation and increased their joy; they rejoice before you as people rejoice at the harvest, as men rejoice when dividing the plunder.
- 4 The abuse of oppressors and cruelty of tyrants-- all their whips and cudgels and curses-- Is gone, done away with, a deliverance as surprising and sudden as Gideon's old victory over Midian.
- 4 For as in the day of Midian's defeat, you have shattered the yoke that burdens them, the bar across their shoulders, the rod of their oppressor.

- 5 The boots of all those invading troops, along with their shirts soaked with innocent blood, Will be piled in a heap and burned, a fire that will burn for days!
- 5 Every warrior's boot used in battle and every garment rolled in blood will be destined for burning, will be fuel for the fire.
- 6 For a child has been born--for us! the gift of a son--for us! He'll take over the running of the world. His names will be: Amazing Counselor, Strong God, Eternal Father, Prince of Wholeness.
- 6 For to us a child is born, to us a son is given, and the government will be on his shoulders. And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.
- 7 His ruling authority will grow, and there'll be no limits to the wholeness he brings. He'll rule from the historic David throne over that promised kingdom. He'll put that kingdom on a firm footing and keep it going With fair dealing and right living, beginning now and lasting always. The zeal of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will do all this.
- 7 Of the increase of his government and peace there will be no end. He will reign on David's throne and over his kingdom, establishing and upholding it with justice and righteousness from that time on and forever. The zeal of the LORD Almighty will accomplish this.
- 8 The Master sent a message against Jacob. It landed right on Israel's doorstep.
- 8 The Lord has sent a message against Jacob; it will fall on Israel.
- 9 All the people soon heard the message, Ephraim and the citizens of Samaria. But they were a proud and arrogant bunch. They dismissed the message, saying,
- 9 All the people will know it-- Ephraim and the inhabitants of Samaria-- who say with pride and arrogance of heart,
- 10 "Things aren't that bad. We can handle anything that comes. If our buildings are knocked down, we'll rebuild them bigger and finer. If our forests are cut down, we'll replant them with finer trees."
- 10 The bricks have fallen down, but we will rebuild with dressed stone; the fig trees have been felled, but we will replace them with cedars.
- 11 So GOD incited their adversaries against them, stirred up their enemies to attack:

- 11 But the LORD has strengthened Rezin's foes against them and has spurred their enemies on.
- 12 From the east, Arameans; from the west, Philistines. They made hash of Israel. But even after that, he was still angry, his fist still raised, ready to hit them again.
- 12 Arameans from the east and Philistines from the west have devoured Israel with open mouth. Yet for all this, his anger is not turned away, his hand is still upraised.
- 13 But the people paid no mind to him who hit them, didn't seek GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 13 But the people have not returned to him who struck them, nor have they sought the LORD Almighty.
- 14 So GOD hacked off Israel's head and tail, palm branch and reed, both on the same day.
- 14 So the LORD will cut off from Israel both head and tail, both palm branch and reed in a single day;
- 15 The big-head elders were the head, the lying prophets were the tail.
- 15 the elders and prominent men are the head, the prophets who teach lies are the tail.
- 16 Those who were supposed to lead this people led them down blind alleys, And those who followed the leaders ended up lost and confused.
- 16 Those who guide this people mislead them, and those who are guided are led astray.
- 17 That's why the Master lost interest in the young men, had no feeling for their orphans and widows. All of them were godless and evil, talking filth and folly. And even after that, he was still angry, his fist still raised, ready to hit them again.
- 17 Therefore the Lord will take no pleasure in the young men, nor will he pity the fatherless and widows, for everyone is ungodly and wicked, every mouth speaks vileness. Yet for all this, his anger is not turned away, his hand is still upraised.
- 18 Their wicked lives raged like an out-of-control fire, the kind that burns everything in its path-- Trees and bushes, weeds and grasses-- filling the skies with smoke.
- 18 Surely wickedness burns like a fire; it consumes briars and thorns, it sets the forest thickets ablaze, so that it rolls upward in a column of

smoke.

- 19 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies answered fire with fire, set the whole country on fire, Turned the people into consuming fires, consuming one another in their lusts--
- 19 By the wrath of the LORD Almighty the land will be scorched and the people will be fuel for the fire; no one will spare his brother.
- 20 Appetites insatiable, stuffing and gorging themselves left and right with people and things. But still they starved. Not even their children were safe from their rapacious hunger.
- 20 On the right they will devour, but still be hungry; on the left they will eat, but not be satisfied. Each will feed on the flesh of his own offspring:
- 21 Manasseh ate Ephraim, and Ephraim Manasseh, and then the two ganged up against Judah. And after that, he was still angry, his fist still raised, ready to hit them again.
- 21 Manasseh will feed on Ephraim, and Ephraim on Manasseh; together they will turn against Judah. Yet for all this, his anger is not turned away, his hand is still upraised.

Isaiah 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to you who legislate evil, who make laws that make victims--
- 1 Woe to those who make unjust laws, to those who issue oppressive decrees,
- 2 Laws that make misery for the poor, that rob my destitute people of dignity, Exploiting defenseless widows, taking advantage of homeless children.
- 2 to deprive the poor of their rights and withhold justice from the oppressed of my people, making widows their prey and robbing the fatherless.
- 3 What will you have to say on Judgment Day, when Doomsday arrives out of the blue? Who will you get to help you? What good will your money do you?
- 3 What will you do on the day of reckoning, when disaster comes from afar? To whom will you run for help? Where will you leave your riches?

- 4 A sorry sight you'll be then, huddled with the prisoners, or just some corpses stacked in the street. Even after all this, God is still angry, his fist still raised, ready to hit them again.
- 4 Nothing will remain but to cringe among the captives or fall among the slain. Yet for all this, his anger is not turned away, his hand is still upraised.
- 5 "Doom to Assyria, weapon of my anger. My wrath is a cudgel in his hands!
- 5 Woe to the Assyrian, the rod of my anger, in whose hand is the club of my wrath!
- 6 I send him against a godless nation, against the people I'm angry with. I command him to strip them clean, rob them blind, and then push their faces in the mud and leave them.
- 6 I send him against a godless nation, I dispatch him against a people who anger me, to seize loot and snatch plunder, and to trample them down like mud in the streets.
- 7 But Assyria has another agenda; he has something else in mind. He's out to destroy utterly, to stamp out as many nations as he can.
- 7 But this is not what he intends, this is not what he has in mind; his purpose is to destroy, to put an end to many nations.
- 8 Assyria says, 'Aren't my commanders all kings? Can't they do whatever they like?
- 8 'Are not my commanders all kings?' he says.
- 9 Didn't I destroy Calno as well as Carchemish? Hamath as well as Arpad? Level Samaria as I did Damascus?
- 9 'Has not Calno fared like Carchemish? Is not Hamath like Arpad, and Samaria like Damascus?
- 10 I've eliminated kingdoms full of gods far more impressive than anything in Jerusalem and Samaria.
- 10 As my hand seized the kingdoms of the idols, kingdoms whose images excelled those of Jerusalem and Samaria--
- 11 So what's to keep me from destroying Jerusalem in the same way I destroyed Samaria and all her god-idols?"
- 11 shall I not deal with Jerusalem and her images as I dealt with Samaria and her idols?" "

- 12 When the Master has finished dealing with Mount Zion and Jerusalem, he'll say, "Now it's Assyria's turn. I'll punish the bragging arrogance of the king of Assyria, his high and mighty posturing,
- 12 When the Lord has finished all his work against Mount Zion and Jerusalem, he will say, "I will punish the king of Assyria for the willful pride of his heart and the haughty look in his eyes.
- 13 the way he goes around saying, "'I've done all this by myself. I know more than anyone. I've wiped out the boundaries of whole countries. I've walked in and taken anything I wanted. I charged in like a bull and toppled their kings from their thrones.
- 13 For he says: " 'By the strength of my hand I have done this, and by my wisdom, because I have understanding. I removed the boundaries of nations, I plundered their treasures; like a mighty one I subdued their kings.
- 14 I reached out my hand and took all that they treasured as easily as a boy taking a bird's eggs from a nest. Like a farmer gathering eggs from the henhouse, I gathered the world in my basket, And no one so much as fluttered a wing or squawked or even chirped."
- 14 As one reaches into a nest, so my hand reached for the wealth of the nations; as men gather abandoned eggs, so I gathered all the countries; not one flapped a wing, or opened its mouth to chirp.' "
- 15 Does an ax take over from the one who swings it? Does a saw act more important than the sawyer? As if a shovel did its shoveling by using a ditch digger! As if a hammer used the carpenter to pound nails!
- 15 Does the ax raise itself above him who swings it, or the saw boast against him who uses it? As if a rod were to wield him who lifts it up, or a club brandish him who is not wood!
- 16 Therefore the Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, will send a debilitating disease on his robust Assyrian fighters. Under the canopy of God's bright glory a fierce fire will break out.
- 16 Therefore, the Lord, the LORD Almighty, will send a wasting disease upon his sturdy warriors; under his pomp a fire will be kindled like a blazing flame.
- 17 Israel's Light will burst into a conflagration. The Holy will explode into a firestorm, And in one day burn to cinders every last Assyrian thornbush.

- 17 The Light of Israel will become a fire, their Holy One a flame; in a single day it will burn and consume his thorns and his briers.
- 18 GOD will destroy the splendid trees and lush gardens. The Assyrian body and soul will waste away to nothing like a disease-ridden invalid.
- 18 The splendor of his forests and fertile fields it will completely destroy, as when a sick man wastes away.
- 19 A child could count what's left of the trees on the fingers of his two hands.
- 19 And the remaining trees of his forests will be so few that a child could write them down.
- 20 And on that Day also, what's left of Israel, the ragtag survivors of Jacob, will no longer be fascinated by abusive, battering Assyria. They'll lean on GOD, The Holy--yes, truly.
- 20 In that day the remnant of Israel, the survivors of the house of Jacob, will no longer rely on him who struck them down but will truly rely on the LORD, the Holy One of Israel.
- 21 The ragtag remnant--what's left of Jacob--will come back to the Strong God.
- 21 A remnant will return, a remnant of Jacob will return to the Mighty God.
- 22 Your people Israel were once like the sand on the seashore, but only a scattered few will return. Destruction is ordered, brimming over with righteousness.
- 22 Though your people, O Israel, be like the sand by the sea, only a remnant will return. Destruction has been decreed, overwhelming and righteous.
- 23 For the Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, will finish here what he started all over the globe.
- 23 The Lord, the LORD Almighty, will carry out the destruction decreed upon the whole land.
- 24 Therefore the Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, says: "My dear, dear people who live in Zion, don't be terrorized by the Assyrians when they beat you with clubs and threaten you with rods like the Egyptians once did.
- 24 Therefore, this is what the Lord, the LORD Almighty, says: "O my people who live in Zion, do not be afraid of the Assyrians, who beat you

with a rod and lift up a club against you, as Egypt did.

25 In just a short time my anger against you will be spent and I'll turn my destroying anger on them.

25 Very soon my anger against you will end and my wrath will be directed to their destruction."

26 I, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, will go after them with a cat-o'-nine-tails and finish them off decisively--as Gideon downed Midian at the rock Oreb, as Moses turned the tables on Egypt.

26 The LORD Almighty will lash them with a whip, as when he struck down Midian at the rock of Oreb; and he will raise his staff over the waters, as he did in Egypt.

27 On that day, Assyria will be pulled off your back, and the yoke of slavery lifted from your neck." Assyria's on the move: up from Rimmon,

27 In that day their burden will be lifted from your shoulders, their yoke from your neck; the yoke will be broken because you have grown so fat.

28 on to Aiath, through Migron, with a bivouac at Micmash.

28 They enter Aiath; they pass through Migron; they store supplies at Micmash.

29 They've crossed the pass, set camp at Geba for the night. Ramah trembles with fright. Gibeah of Saul has run off.

29 They go over the pass, and say, "We will camp overnight at Geba." Ramah trembles; Gibeah of Saul flees.

30 Cry for help, daughter of Gallim! Listen to her, Laishah! Do something, Anathoth!

30 Cry out, O Daughter of Gallim! Listen, O Laishah! Poor Anathoth!

31 Madmenah takes to the hills. The people of Gebim flee in panic.

31 Madmenah is in flight; the people of Gebim take cover.

32 The enemy's soon at Nob--nearly there! In sight of the city he shakes his fist At the mount of dear daughter Zion, the hill of Jerusalem.

32 This day they will halt at Nob; they will shake their fist at the mount of the Daughter of Zion, at the hill of Jerusalem.

33 But now watch this: The Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, swings his ax and lops the branches, Chops down the giant trees, lays flat the towering forest-on-the-march.

33 See, the Lord, the LORD Almighty, will lop off the boughs with great power. The lofty trees will be felled, the tall ones will be brought low.

34 His ax will make toothpicks of that forest, that Lebanon-like army reduced to kindling.

34 He will cut down the forest thickets with an ax; Lebanon will fall before the Mighty One.

Isaiah 11

MSG

NIV

1 A green Shoot will sprout from Jesse's stump, from his roots a budding Branch.

1 A shoot will come up from the stump of Jesse; from his roots a Branch will bear fruit.

2 The life-giving Spirit of GOD will hover over him, the Spirit that brings wisdom and understanding, The Spirit that gives direction and builds strength, the Spirit that instills knowledge and Fear-of-GOD.

2 The Spirit of the LORD will rest on him-- the Spirit of wisdom and of understanding, the Spirit of counsel and of power, the Spirit of knowledge and of the fear of the LORD--

3 Fear-of-GOD will be all his joy and delight. He won't judge by appearances, won't decide on the basis of hearsay.

3 and he will delight in the fear of the LORD. He will not judge by what he sees with his eyes, or decide by what he hears with his ears;

4 He'll judge the needy by what is right, render decisions on earth's poor with justice. His words will bring everyone to awed attention. A mere breath from his lips will topple the wicked.

4 but with righteousness he will judge the needy, with justice he will give decisions for the poor of the earth. He will strike the earth with the rod of his mouth; with the breath of his lips he will slay the wicked.

5 Each morning he'll pull on sturdy work clothes and boots, and build righteousness and faithfulness in the land.

5 Righteousness will be his belt and faithfulness the sash around his waist.

6 The wolf will romp with the lamb, the leopard sleep with the kid. Calf and lion will eat from the same trough, and a little child will tend them.

6 The wolf will live with the lamb, the leopard will lie down with the goat, the calf and the lion and the yearling together; and a little child will lead

them.

- 7 Cow and bear will graze the same pasture, their calves and cubs grow up together, and the lion eat straw like the ox.
- 7 The cow will feed with the bear, their young will lie down together, and the lion will eat straw like the ox.
- 8 The nursing child will crawl over rattlesnake dens, the toddler stick his hand down the hole of a serpent.
- 8 The infant will play near the hole of the cobra, and the young child put his hand into the viper's nest.
- 9 Neither animal nor human will hurt or kill on my holy mountain. The whole earth will be brimming with knowing God-Alive, a living knowledge of God ocean-deep, ocean-wide.
- 9 They will neither harm nor destroy on all my holy mountain, for the earth will be full of the knowledge of the LORD as the waters cover the sea.
- 10 On that day, Jesse's Root will be raised high, posted as a rallying banner for the peoples. The nations will all come to him. His headquarters will be glorious.
- 10 In that day the Root of Jesse will stand as a banner for the peoples; the nations will rally to him, and his place of rest will be glorious.
- 11 Also on that day, the Master for the second time will reach out to bring back what's left of his scattered people. He'll bring them back from Assyria, Egypt, Pathros, Ethiopia, Elam, Sinar, Hamath, and the ocean islands.
- 11 In that day the Lord will reach out his hand a second time to reclaim the remnant that is left of his people from Assyria, from Lower Egypt, from Upper Egypt, from Cush, from Elam, from Babylonia, from Hamath and from the islands of the sea.
- 12 And he'll raise that rallying banner high, visible to all nations, gather in all the scattered exiles of Israel, Pull in all the dispersed refugees of Judah from the four winds and the seven seas.
- 12 He will raise a banner for the nations and gather the exiles of Israel; he will assemble the scattered people of Judah from the four quarters of the earth.
- 13 The jealousy of Ephraim will dissolve, the hostility of Judah will vanish-- Ephraim no longer the jealous rival of Judah, Judah no longer the hostile rival of Ephraim!

- 13 Ephraim's jealousy will vanish, and Judah's enemies will be cut off; Ephraim will not be jealous of Judah, nor Judah hostile toward Ephraim.
- 14 Blood brothers united, they'll pounce on the Philistines in the west, join forces to plunder the people in the east. They'll attack Edom and Moab. The Ammonites will fall into line.
- 14 They will swoop down on the slopes of Philistia to the west; together they will plunder the people to the east. They will lay hands on Edom and Moab, and the Ammonites will be subject to them.
- 15 GOD will once again dry up Egypt's Red Sea, making for an easy crossing. He'll send a blistering wind down on the great River Euphrates, Reduce it to seven mere trickles. None even need get their feet wet!
- 15 The LORD will dry up the gulf of the Egyptian sea; with a scorching wind he will sweep his hand over the Euphrates River. He will break it up into seven streams so that men can cross over in sandals.
- 16 In the end there'll be a highway all the way from Assyria, easy traveling for what's left of God's people-- A highway just like the one Israel had when he marched up out of Egypt.
- 16 There will be a highway for the remnant of his people that is left from Assyria, as there was for Israel when they came up from Egypt.

Isaiah 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 And you will say in that day, "I thank you, GOD. You were angry but your anger wasn't forever. You withdrew your anger and moved in and comforted me.
- 1 In that day you will say: "I will praise you, O LORD. Although you were angry with me, your anger has turned away and you have comforted me.
- 2 "Yes, indeed--God is my salvation. I trust, I won't be afraid. GOD--yes GOD!--is my strength and song, best of all, my salvation!"
- 2 Surely God is my salvation; I will trust and not be afraid. The LORD, the LORD, is my strength and my song; he has become my salvation."
- 3 Joyfully you'll pull up buckets of water from the wells of salvation.
- 3 With joy you will draw water from the wells of salvation.

- 4 And as you do it, you'll say, "Give thanks to GOD. Call out his name. Ask him anything! Shout to the nations, tell them what he's done, spread the news of his great reputation!
- 4 In that day you will say: "Give thanks to the LORD, call on his name; make known among the nations what he has done, and proclaim that his name is exalted.
- 5 "Sing praise-songs to GOD. He's done it all! Let the whole earth know what he's done!
- 5 Sing to the LORD, for he has done glorious things; let this be known to all the world.
- 6 Raise the roof! Sing your hearts out, O Zion! The Greatest lives among you: The Holy of Israel."
- 6 Shout aloud and sing for joy, people of Zion, for great is the Holy One of Israel among you."

Isaiah 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Message on Babylon. Isaiah son of Amoz saw it:
- 1 An oracle concerning Babylon that Isaiah son of Amoz saw:
- 2 "Run up a flag on an open hill. Yell loud. Get their attention. Wave them into formation. Direct them to the nerve center of power.
- 2 Raise a banner on a bare hilltop, shout to them; beckon to them to enter the gates of the nobles.
- 3 I've taken charge of my special forces, called up my crack troops. They're bursting with pride and passion to carry out my angry judgment."
- 3 I have commanded my holy ones; I have summoned my warriors to carry out my wrath-- those who rejoice in my triumph.
- 4 Thunder rolls off the mountains like a mob huge and noisy-- Thunder of kingdoms in an uproar, nations assembling for war. GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies is calling his army into battle formation.
- 4 Listen, a noise on the mountains, like that of a great multitude! Listen, an uproar among the kingdoms, like nations massing together! The LORD Almighty is mustering an army for war.

- 5 They come from far-off countries, they pour in across the horizon. It's GOD on the move with the weapons of his wrath, ready to destroy the whole country.
- 5 They come from faraway lands, from the ends of the heavens-- the LORD and the weapons of his wrath-- to destroy the whole country.
- 6 Wail! GOD's Day of Judgment is near-- an avalanche crashing down from the Strong God!
- 6 Wail, for the day of the LORD is near; it will come like destruction from the Almighty.
- 7 Everyone paralyzed in the panic, hysterical
- 7 Because of this, all hands will go limp, every man's heart will melt.
- 8 and unstrung, Doubled up in pain like a woman giving birth to a baby. Horrified--everyone they see is like a face out of a nightmare.
- 8 Terror will seize them, pain and anguish will grip them; they will writhe like a woman in labor. They will look aghast at each other, their faces aflame.
- 9 "Watch now. GOD's Judgment Day comes. Cruel it is, a day of wrath and anger, A day to waste the earth and clean out all the sinners.
- 9 See, the day of the LORD is coming --a cruel day, with wrath and fierce anger-- to make the land desolate and destroy the sinners within it.
- 10 The stars in the sky, the great parade of constellations, will be nothing but black holes. The sun will come up as a black disk, and the moon a blank nothing.
- 10 The stars of heaven and their constellations will not show their light. The rising sun will be darkened and the moon will not give its light.
- 11 I'll put a full stop to the evil on earth, terminate the dark acts of the wicked. I'll gag all braggarts and boasters--not a peep anymore from them-- and trip strutting tyrants, leave them flat on their faces.
- 11 I will punish the world for its evil, the wicked for their sins. I will put an end to the arrogance of the haughty and will humble the pride of the ruthless.
- 12 Proud humanity will disappear from the earth. I'll make mortals rarer than hens' teeth.
- 12 I will make man scarcer than pure gold, more rare than the gold of Ophir.

- 13 And yes, I'll even make the sky shake, and the earth quake to its roots
Under the wrath of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, the Judgment Day of his
raging anger.
- 13 Therefore I will make the heavens tremble; and the earth will shake
from its place at the wrath of the LORD Almighty, in the day of his
burning anger.
- 14 Like a hunted white-tailed deer, like lost sheep with no shepherd, People
will huddle with a few of their own kind, run off to some makeshift
shelter.
- 14 Like a hunted gazelle, like sheep without a shepherd, each will return to
his own people, each will flee to his native land.
- 15 But tough luck to stragglers--they'll be killed on the spot, throats cut,
bellies ripped open,
- 15 Whoever is captured will be thrust through; all who are caught will fall
by the sword.
- 16 Babies smashed on the rocks while mothers and fathers watch, Houses
looted, wives raped.
- 16 Their infants will be dashed to pieces before their eyes; their houses will
be looted and their wives ravished.
- 17 "And now watch this: Against Babylon, I'm inciting the Medes, A
ruthless bunch indifferent to bribes, the kind of brutality that no one can
blunt.
- 17 See, I will stir up against them the Medes, who do not care for silver
and have no delight in gold.
- 18 They massacre the young, wantonly kick and kill even babies.
- 18 Their bows will strike down the young men; they will have no mercy on
infants nor will they look with compassion on children.
- 19 And Babylon, most glorious of all kingdoms, the pride and joy of
Chaldeans, Will end up smoking and stinking like Sodom, and, yes, like
Gomorraah, when God had finished with them.
- 19 Babylon, the jewel of kingdoms, the glory of the Babylonians' pride,
will be overthrown by God like Sodom and Gomorraah.
- 20 No one will live there anymore, generation after generation a ghost
town. Not even Bedouins will pitch tents there. Shepherds will give it a
wide berth.

- 20 She will never be inhabited or lived in through all generations; no Arab will pitch his tent there, no shepherd will rest his flocks there.
- 21 But strange and wild animals will like it just fine, filling the vacant houses with eerie night sounds. Skunks will make it their home, and unspeakable night hags will haunt it.
- 21 But desert creatures will lie there, jackals will fill her houses; there the owls will dwell, and there the wild goats will leap about.
- 22 Hyenas will curdle your blood with their laughing, and the howling of coyotes will give you the shivers. "Babylon is doomed. It won't be long now."
- 22 Hyenas will howl in her strongholds, jackals in her luxurious palaces. Her time is at hand, and her days will not be prolonged.

Isaiah 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 But not so with Jacob. GOD will have compassion on Jacob. Once again he'll choose Israel. He'll establish them in their own country. Outsiders will be attracted and throw their lot in with Jacob.
- 1 The LORD will have compassion on Jacob; once again he will choose Israel and will settle them in their own land. Aliens will join them and unite with the house of Jacob.
- 2 The nations among whom they lived will actually escort them back home, and then Israel will pay them back by making slaves of them, men and women alike, possessing them as slaves in GOD's country, capturing those who had captured them, ruling over those who had abused them.
- 2 Nations will take them and bring them to their own place. And the house of Israel will possess the nations as menservants and maidservants in the LORD's land. They will make captives of their captors and rule over their oppressors.
- 3 When GOD has given you time to recover from the abuse and trouble and harsh servitude that you had to endure,
- 3 On the day the LORD gives you relief from suffering and turmoil and cruel bondage,

- 4 you can amuse yourselves by taking up this satire, a taunt against the king of Babylon: Can you believe it? The tyrant is gone! The tyranny is over!
- 4 you will take up this taunt against the king of Babylon: How the oppressor has come to an end! How his fury has ended!
- 5 GOD has broken the rule of the wicked, the power of the bully-rulers
- 5 The LORD has broken the rod of the wicked, the scepter of the rulers,
- 6 That crushed many people. A relentless rain of cruel outrage Established a violent rule of anger rife with torture and persecution.
- 6 which in anger struck down peoples with unceasing blows, and in fury subdued nations with relentless aggression.
- 7 And now it's over, the whole earth quietly at rest. Burst into song! Make the rafters ring!
- 7 All the lands are at rest and at peace; they break into singing.
- 8 Ponderosa pine trees are happy, giant Lebanon cedars are relieved, saying, "Since you've been cut down, there's no one around to cut us down."
- 8 Even the pine trees and the cedars of Lebanon exult over you and say, "Now that you have been laid low, no woodsman comes to cut us down."
- 9 And the underworld dead are all excited, preparing to welcome you when you come. Getting ready to greet you are the ghostly dead, all the famous names of earth. All the buried kings of the nations will stand up on their thrones
- 9 The grave below is all astir to meet you at your coming; it rouses the spirits of the departed to greet you-- all those who were leaders in the world; it makes them rise from their thrones-- all those who were kings over the nations.
- 10 With well-prepared speeches, royal invitations to death: "Now you are as nothing as we are! Make yourselves at home with us dead folks!"
- 10 They will all respond, they will say to you, "You also have become weak, as we are; you have become like us."
- 11 This is where your pomp and fine music led you, Babylon, to your underworld private chambers, A king-size mattress of maggots for repose and a quilt of crawling worms for warmth.
- 11 All your pomp has been brought down to the grave, along with the noise of your harps; maggots are spread out beneath you and worms cover

you.

- 12 What a comedown this, O Babylon! Daystar! Son of Dawn! Flat on your face in the underworld mud, you, famous for flattening nations!
- 12 How you have fallen from heaven, O morning star, son of the dawn! You have been cast down to the earth, you who once laid low the nations!
- 13 You said to yourself, "I'll climb to heaven. I'll set my throne over the stars of God. I'll run the assembly of angels that meets on sacred Mount Zaphon.
- 13 You said in your heart, "I will ascend to heaven; I will raise my throne above the stars of God; I will sit enthroned on the mount of assembly, on the utmost heights of the sacred mountain.
- 14 I'll climb to the top of the clouds. I'll take over as King of the Universe!"
- 14 I will ascend above the tops of the clouds; I will make myself like the Most High."
- 15 But you didn't make it, did you? Instead of climbing up, you came down-- Down with the underground dead, down to the abyss of the Pit.
- 15 But you are brought down to the grave, to the depths of the pit.
- 16 People will stare and muse: "Can this be the one Who terrorized earth and its kingdoms,
- 16 Those who see you stare at you, they ponder your fate: "Is this the man who shook the earth and made kingdoms tremble,
- 17 turned earth to a moonscape, Wasted its cities, shut up his prisoners to a living death?"
- 17 the man who made the world a desert, who overthrew its cities and would not let his captives go home?"
- 18 Other kings get a decent burial, honored with eulogies and placed in a tomb.
- 18 All the kings of the nations lie in state, each in his own tomb.
- 19 But you're dumped in a ditch unburied, like a stray dog or cat, Covered with rotting bodies, murdered and indigent corpses. Your dead body desecrated, mutilated--
- 19 But you are cast out of your tomb like a rejected branch; you are covered with the slain, with those pierced by the sword, those who descend to the stones of the pit. Like a corpse trampled underfoot,

- 20 no state funeral for you! You've left your land in ruins, left a legacy of massacre. The progeny of your evil life will never be named. Oblivion!
- 20 you will not join them in burial, for you have destroyed your land and killed your people. The offspring of the wicked will never be mentioned again.
- 21 Get a place ready to slaughter the sons of the wicked and wipe out their father's line. Unthinkable that they should own a square foot of land or desecrate the face of the world with their cities!
- 21 Prepare a place to slaughter his sons for the sins of their forefathers; they are not to rise to inherit the land and cover the earth with their cities.
- 22 "I will confront them"--Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies-- "and strip Babylon of name and survivors, children and grandchildren.
- 22 I will rise up against them, declares the LORD Almighty. "I will cut off from Babylon her name and survivors, her offspring and descendants," declares the LORD.
- 23 " GOD's Decree. "I'll make it a worthless swamp and give it as a prize to the hedgehog. And then I'll bulldoze it out of existence." Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 23 I will turn her into a place for owls and into swampland; I will sweep her with the broom of destruction, declares the LORD Almighty.
- 24 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies speaks: "Exactly as I planned, it will happen. Following my blueprints, it will take shape.
- 24 The LORD Almighty has sworn, "Surely, as I have planned, so it will be, and as I have purposed, so it will stand.
- 25 I will shatter the Assyrian who trespasses my land and stomp him into the dirt on my mountains. I will ban his taking and making of slaves and lift the weight of oppression from all shoulders."
- 25 I will crush the Assyrian in my land; on my mountains I will trample him down. His yoke will be taken from my people, and his burden removed from their shoulders."
- 26 This is the plan, planned for the whole earth, And this is the hand that will do it, reaching into every nation.
- 26 This is the plan determined for the whole world; this is the hand stretched out over all nations.

- 27 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies has planned it. Who could ever cancel such plans? His is the hand that's reached out. Who could brush it aside?
- 27 For the LORD Almighty has purposed, and who can thwart him? His hand is stretched out, and who can turn it back?
- 28 In the year King Ahaz died, this Message came:
- 28 This oracle came in the year King Ahaz died:
- 29 Hold it, Philistines! It's too soon to celebrate the defeat of your cruel oppressor. From the death throes of that snake a worse snake will come, and from that, one even worse.
- 29 Do not rejoice, all you Philistines, that the rod that struck you is broken; from the root of that snake will spring up a viper, its fruit will be a darting, venomous serpent.
- 30 The poor won't have to worry. The needy will escape the terror. But you Philistines will be plunged into famine, and those who don't starve, God will kill.
- 30 The poorest of the poor will find pasture, and the needy will lie down in safety. But your root I will destroy by famine; it will slay your survivors.
- 31 Wail and howl, proud city! Fall prostrate in fear, Philistia! On the northern horizon, smoke from burned cities, the wake of a brutal, disciplined destroyer.
- 31 Wail, O gate! Howl, O city! Melt away, all you Philistines! A cloud of smoke comes from the north, and there is not a straggler in its ranks.
- 32 What does one say to outsiders who ask questions? Tell them, "GOD has established Zion. Those in need and in trouble find refuge in her."
- 32 What answer shall be given to the envoys of that nation? "The LORD has established Zion, and in her his afflicted people will find refuge."

Isaiah 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Message concerning Moab: Village Ar of Moab is in ruins, destroyed in a night raid. Village Kir of Moab is in ruins, destroyed in a night raid.
- 1 An oracle concerning Moab: Ar in Moab is ruined, destroyed in a night! Kir in Moab is ruined, destroyed in a night!

- 2 Village Dibon climbs to its chapel in the hills, goes up to lament. Moab weeps and wails over Nebo and Medba. Every head is shaved bald, every beard shaved clean.
- 2 Dibon goes up to its temple, to its high places to weep; Moab wails over Nebo and Medeba. Every head is shaved and every beard cut off.
- 3 They pour into the streets wearing black, go up on the roofs, take to the town square, Everyone in tears, everyone in grief.
- 3 In the streets they wear sackcloth; on the roofs and in the public squares they all wail, prostrate with weeping.
- 4 Towns Heshbon and Elealeh cry long and loud. The sound carries as far as Jahaz. Moab sobs, shaking in grief. The soul of Moab trembles.
- 4 Heshbon and Elealeh cry out, their voices are heard all the way to Jahaz. Therefore the armed men of Moab cry out, and their hearts are faint.
- 5 Oh, how I grieve for Moab! Refugees stream to Zoar and then on to Eglath-shelishiyah. Up the slopes of Luhith they weep; on the road to Horonaim they cry their loss.
- 5 My heart cries out over Moab; her fugitives flee as far as Zoar, as far as Eglath Shelishiyah. They go up the way to Luhith, weeping as they go; on the road to Horonaim they lament their destruction.
- 6 The springs of Nimrim are dried up-- grass brown, buds stunted, nothing grows.
- 6 The waters of Nimrim are dried up and the grass is withered; the vegetation is gone and nothing green is left.
- 7 They leave, carrying all their possessions on their backs, everything they own, Making their way as best they can across Willow Creek to safety.
- 7 So the wealth they have acquired and stored up they carry away over the Ravine of the Poplars.
- 8 Poignant cries reverberate all through Moab, Gut-wrenching sobs as far as Eglaim, heart-racking sobs all the way to Beer-elim.
- 8 Their outcry echoes along the border of Moab; their wailing reaches as far as Eglaim, their lamentation as far as Beer Elim.
- 9 The banks of the Dibon crest with blood, but God has worse in store for Dibon: A lion--a lion to finish off the fugitives, to clean up whoever's left in the land.
- 9 Dimon's waters are full of blood, but I will bring still more upon Dimon-- a lion upon the fugitives of Moab and upon those who remain in the

land.

Isaiah 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Dispatch a gift of lambs," says Moab, "to the leaders in Jerusalem-- Lambs from Sela sent across the desert to buy the goodwill of Jerusalem.
- 1 Send lambs as tribute to the ruler of the land, from Sela, across the desert, to the mount of the Daughter of Zion.
- 2 The towns and people of Moab are at a loss, New-hatched birds knocked from the nest, fluttering helplessly At the banks of the Arnon River, unable to cross:
- 2 Like fluttering birds pushed from the nest, so are the women of Moab at the fords of the Arnon.
- 3 "Tell us what to do, help us out! Protect us, hide us!
- 3 Give us counsel, render a decision. Make your shadow like night-- at high noon. Hide the fugitives, do not betray the refugees.
- 4 Give the refugees from Moab sanctuary with you. Be a safe place for those on the run from the killing fields.'" "When this is all over," Judah answers, "the tyrant toppled, The killing at an end, all signs of these cruelties long gone,
- 4 Let the Moabite fugitives stay with you; be their shelter from the destroyer." The oppressor will come to an end, and destruction will cease; the aggressor will vanish from the land.
- 5 A new government of love will be established in the venerable David tradition. A Ruler you can depend upon will head this government, A Ruler passionate for justice, a Ruler quick to set things right."
- 5 In love a throne will be established; in faithfulness a man will sit on it-- one from the house of David-- one who in judging seeks justice and speeds the cause of righteousness.
- 6 We've heard--everyone's heard!--of Moab's pride, world-famous for pride-- Arrogant, self-important, insufferable, full of hot air.
- 6 We have heard of Moab's pride-- her overweening pride and conceit, her pride and her insolence-- but her boasts are empty.

- 7 So now let Moab lament for a change, with antiphonal mock-laments from the neighbors! What a shame! How terrible! No more fine fruitcakes and Kir-hareseth candies!
- 7 Therefore the Moabites wail, they wail together for Moab. Lament and grieve for the men of Kir Hareseth.
- 8 All those lush Heshbon fields dried up, the rich Sibmah vineyards withered! Foreign thugs have crushed and torn out the famous grapevines That once reached all the way to Jazer, right to the edge of the desert, Ripped out the crops in every direction as far as the eye can see.
- 8 The fields of Heshbon wither, the vines of Sibmah also. The rulers of the nations have trampled down the choicest vines, which once reached Jazer and spread toward the desert. Their shoots spread out and went as far as the sea.
- 9 I'll join the weeping. I'll weep right along with Jazer, weep for the Sibmah vineyards. And yes, Heshbon and Elealeh, I'll mingle my tears with your tears! The joyful shouting at harvest is gone. Instead of song and celebration, dead silence.
- 9 So I weep, as Jazer weeps, for the vines of Sibmah. O Heshbon, O Elealeh, I drench you with tears! The shouts of joy over your ripened fruit and over your harvests have been stilled.
- 10 No more boisterous laughter in the orchards, no more hearty work songs in the vineyards. Instead of the bustle and sound of good work in the fields, silence--deathly and deadening silence.
- 10 Joy and gladness are taken away from the orchards; no one sings or shouts in the vineyards; no one treads out wine at the presses, for I have put an end to the shouting.
- 11 My heartstrings throb like harp strings for Moab, my soul in sympathy for sad Kir-heres.
- 11 My heart laments for Moab like a harp, my inmost being for Kir Hareseth.
- 12 When Moab trudges to the shrine to pray, he wastes both time and energy. Going to the sanctuary and praying for relief is useless. Nothing ever happens.
- 12 When Moab appears at her high place, she only wears herself out; when she goes to her shrine to pray, it is to no avail.

- 13 This is GOD's earlier Message on Moab.
- 13 This is the word the LORD has already spoken concerning Moab.
- 14 GOD's updated Message is, "In three years, no longer than the term of an enlisted soldier, Moab's impressive presence will be gone, that splendid hot-air balloon will be punctured, and instead of a vigorous population, just a few shuffling bums cadging handouts."
- 14 But now the LORD says: "Within three years, as a servant bound by contract would count them, Moab's splendor and all her many people will be despised, and her survivors will be very few and feeble."

Isaiah 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Message concerning Damascus: "Watch this: Damascus undone as a city, a pile of dust and rubble!
- 1 An oracle concerning Damascus: "See, Damascus will no longer be a city but will become a heap of ruins.
- 2 Her towns emptied of people. The sheep and goats will move in And take over the towns as if they owned them--which they will!
- 2 The cities of Aroer will be deserted and left to flocks, which will lie down, with no one to make them afraid.
- 3 Not a sign of a fort is left in Ephraim, not a trace of government left in Damascus. What's left of Aram? The same as what's left of Israel--not much." Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 3 The fortified city will disappear from Ephraim, and royal power from Damascus; the remnant of Aram will be like the glory of the Israelites," declares the LORD Almighty.
- 4 "The Day is coming when Jacob's robust splendor goes pale and his well-fed body turns skinny.
- 4 In that day the glory of Jacob will fade; the fat of his body will waste away.
- 5 The country will be left empty, picked clean as a field harvested by field hands. She'll be like a few stalks of barley left standing in the lush Valley of Rephaim after harvest,

- 5 It will be as when a reaper gathers the standing grain and harvests the grain with his arm-- as when a man glean heads of grain in the Valley of Rephaim.
- 6 Or like the couple of ripe olives overlooked in the top of the olive tree, Or the four or five apples that the pickers couldn't reach in the orchard." Decree of the GOD of Israel.
- 6 Yet some gleanings will remain, as when an olive tree is beaten, leaving two or three olives on the topmost branches, four or five on the fruitful boughs," declares the LORD, the God of Israel.
- 7 Yes, the Day is coming when people will notice The One Who Made Them, take a long hard look at The Holy of Israel.
- 7 In that day men will look to their Maker and turn their eyes to the Holy One of Israel.
- 8 They'll lose interest in all the stuff they've made--altars and monuments and rituals, their homemade, handmade religion--however impressive it is.
- 8 They will not look to the altars, the work of their hands, and they will have no regard for the Asherah poles and the incense altars their fingers have made.
- 9 And yes, the Day is coming when their fortress cities will be abandoned--the very same cities that the Hivites and Amorites abandoned when Israel invaded! And the country will be empty, desolate.
- 9 In that day their strong cities, which they left because of the Israelites, will be like places abandoned to thickets and undergrowth. And all will be desolation.
- 10 And why? Because you have forgotten God-Your-Salvation, not remembered your Rock-of-Refuge. And so, even though you are very religious, planting all sorts of bushes and herbs and trees to honor and influence your fertility gods,
- 10 You have forgotten God your Savior; you have not remembered the Rock, your fortress. Therefore, though you set out the finest plants and plant imported vines,
- 11 And even though you make them grow so well, bursting with buds and sprouts and blossoms, Nothing will come of them. Instead of a harvest you'll get nothing but grief and pain, pain, pain.

- 11 though on the day you set them out, you make them grow, and on the morning when you plant them, you bring them to bud, yet the harvest will be as nothing in the day of disease and incurable pain.
- 12 Oh my! Thunder! A thundering herd of people! Thunder like the crashing of ocean waves! Nations roaring, roaring, like the roar of a massive waterfall,
- 12 Oh, the raging of many nations-- they rage like the raging sea! Oh, the uproar of the peoples-- they roar like the roaring of great waters!
- 13 Roaring like a deafening Niagara! But God will silence them with a word, And then he'll blow them away like dead leaves off a tree, like down from a thistle.
- 13 Although the peoples roar like the roar of surging waters, when he rebukes them they flee far away, driven before the wind like chaff on the hills, like tumbleweed before a gale.
- 14 At bedtime, terror fills the air. By morning it's gone--not a sign of it anywhere! This is what happens to those who would ruin us, this is the fate of those out to get us.
- 14 In the evening, sudden terror! Before the morning, they are gone! This is the portion of those who loot us, the lot of those who plunder us.

Isaiah 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to the land of flies and mosquitoes beyond the Ethiopian rivers,
1 Woe to the land of whirring wings along the rivers of Cush,
2 Shipping emissaries all over the world, down rivers and across seas. Go, swift messengers, go to this people tall and handsome, This people held in respect everywhere, this people mighty and merciless, from the land crisscrossed with rivers.
2 which sends envoys by sea in papyrus boats over the water. Go, swift messengers, to a people tall and smooth-skinned, to a people feared far and wide, an aggressive nation of strange speech, whose land is divided by rivers.
3 Everybody everywhere, all earth-dwellers: When you see a flag flying on the mountain, look! When you hear the trumpet blown, listen!

- 3 All you people of the world, you who live on the earth, when a banner is raised on the mountains, you will see it, and when a trumpet sounds, you will hear it.
- 4 For here's what GOD told me: "I'm not going to say anything, but simply look on from where I live, Quiet as warmth that comes from the sun, silent as dew during harvest."
- 4 This is what the LORD says to me: "I will remain quiet and will look on from my dwelling place, like shimmering heat in the sunshine, like a cloud of dew in the heat of harvest."
- 5 And then, just before harvest, after the blossom has turned into a maturing grape, He'll step in and prune back the new shoots, ruthlessly hack off all the growing branches.
- 5 For, before the harvest, when the blossom is gone and the flower becomes a ripening grape, he will cut off the shoots with pruning knives, and cut down and take away the spreading branches.
- 6 He'll leave them piled on the ground for birds and animals to feed on-- Fodder for the summering birds, fodder for the wintering animals.
- 6 They will all be left to the mountain birds of prey and to the wild animals; the birds will feed on them all summer, the wild animals all winter.
- 7 Then tribute will be brought to GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, brought from this people tall and handsome, This people once held in respect everywhere, this people once mighty and merciless, From the land crisscrossed with rivers, to Mount Zion, GOD's place.
- 7 At that time gifts will be brought to the LORD Almighty from a people tall and smooth-skinned, from a people feared far and wide, an aggressive nation of strange speech, whose land is divided by rivers-- the gifts will be brought to Mount Zion, the place of the Name of the LORD Almighty.

Isaiah 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Message concerning Egypt: Watch this! GOD riding on a fast-moving cloud, moving in on Egypt! The god-idols of Egypt shudder and shake, Egyptians paralyzed by panic.
- 1 An oracle concerning Egypt: See, the LORD rides on a swift cloud and is coming to Egypt. The idols of Egypt tremble before him, and the hearts of the Egyptians melt within them.
- 2 God says, "I'll make Egyptian fight Egyptian, brother fight brother, neighbor fight neighbor, City fight city, kingdom fight kingdom--anarchy and chaos and killing!
- 2 I will stir up Egyptian against Egyptian-- brother will fight against brother, neighbor against neighbor, city against city, kingdom against kingdom.
- 3 I'll knock the wind out of the Egyptians. They won't know coming from going. They'll go to their god-idols for answers; they'll conjure ghosts and hold séances, desperate for answers.
- 3 The Egyptians will lose heart, and I will bring their plans to nothing; they will consult the idols and the spirits of the dead, the mediums and the spiritists.
- 4 But I'll turn the Egyptians over to a tyrant most cruel. I'll put them under the rule of a mean, merciless king." Decree of the Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 4 I will hand the Egyptians over to the power of a cruel master, and a fierce king will rule over them," declares the Lord, the LORD Almighty.
- 5 The River Nile will dry up, the riverbed baked dry in the sun.
- 5 The waters of the river will dry up, and the riverbed will be parched and dry.
- 6 The canals will become stagnant and stink, every stream touching the Nile dry up. River vegetation will rot away
- 6 The canals will stink; the streams of Egypt will dwindle and dry up. The reeds and rushes will wither,
- 7 the banks of the Nile-baked clay, The riverbed hard and smooth, river grasses dried up and gone with the wind.
- 7 also the plants along the Nile, at the mouth of the river. Every sown field along the Nile will become parched, will blow away and be no more.
- 8 Fishermen will complain that the fishing's been ruined.

- 8 The fishermen will groan and lament, all who cast hooks into the Nile; those who throw nets on the water will pine away.
- 9 Textile workers will be out of work, all weavers and workers in linen and cotton and wool
- 9 Those who work with combed flax will despair, the weavers of fine linen will lose hope.
- 10 Dispirited, depressed in their forced idleness-- everyone who works for a living, jobless.
- 10 The workers in cloth will be dejected, and all the wage earners will be sick at heart.
- 11 The princes of Zoan are fools, the advisors of Pharaoh stupid. How could any of you dare tell Pharaoh, "Trust me: I'm wise. I know what's going on. Why, I'm descended from the old wisdom of Egypt"?
- 11 The officials of Zoan are nothing but fools; the wise counselors of Pharaoh give senseless advice. How can you say to Pharaoh, "I am one of the wise men, a disciple of the ancient kings"?
- 12 There's not a wise man or woman left in the country. If there were, one of them would tell you what GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies has in mind for Egypt.
- 12 Where are your wise men now? Let them show you and make known what the LORD Almighty has planned against Egypt.
- 13 As it is, the princes of Zoan are all fools and the princes of Memphis, dunces. The honored pillars of your society have led Egypt into detours and dead ends.
- 13 The officials of Zoan have become fools, the leaders of Memphis are deceived; the cornerstones of her peoples have led Egypt astray.
- 14 GOD has scrambled their brains, Egypt's become a falling-down-in-his-own-vomit drunk.
- 14 The LORD has poured into them a spirit of dizziness; they make Egypt stagger in all that she does, as a drunkard staggers around in his vomit.
- 15 Egypt's hopeless, past helping, a senile, doddering old fool.
- 15 There is nothing Egypt can do-- head or tail, palm branch or reed.
- 16 On that Day, Egyptians will be like hysterical schoolgirls, screaming at the first hint of action from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 16 In that day the Egyptians will be like women. They will shudder with fear at the uplifted hand that the LORD Almighty raises against them.

- 17 Little Judah will strike terror in Egyptians! Say "Judah" to an Egyptian and see panic. The word triggers fear of the GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies' plan against Egypt.
- 17 And the land of Judah will bring terror to the Egyptians; everyone to whom Judah is mentioned will be terrified, because of what the LORD Almighty is planning against them.
- 18 On that Day, more than one city in Egypt will learn to speak the language of faith and promise to follow GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies. One of these cities will be honored with the title "City of the Sun."
- 18 In that day five cities in Egypt will speak the language of Canaan and swear allegiance to the LORD Almighty. One of them will be called the City of Destruction.
- 19 On that Day, there will be a place of worship to GOD in the center of Egypt and a monument to GOD at its border.
- 19 In that day there will be an altar to the LORD in the heart of Egypt, and a monument to the LORD at its border.
- 20 It will show how the GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies has helped the Egyptians. When they cry out in prayer to GOD because of oppressors, he'll send them help, a savior who will keep them safe and take care of them.
- 20 It will be a sign and witness to the LORD Almighty in the land of Egypt. When they cry out to the LORD because of their oppressors, he will send them a savior and defender, and he will rescue them.
- 21 GOD will openly show himself to the Egyptians and they'll get to know him on that Day. They'll worship him seriously with sacrifices and burnt offerings. They'll make vows and keep them.
- 21 So the LORD will make himself known to the Egyptians, and in that day they will acknowledge the LORD. They will worship with sacrifices and grain offerings; they will make vows to the LORD and keep them.
- 22 GOD will wound Egypt, first hit and then heal. Egypt will come back to GOD, and GOD will listen to their prayers and heal them, heal them from head to toe.
- 22 The LORD will strike Egypt with a plague; he will strike them and heal them. They will turn to the LORD, and he will respond to their pleas and heal them.

- 23 On that Day, there will be a highway all the way from Egypt to Assyria: Assyrians will have free range in Egypt and Egyptians in Assyria. No longer rivals, they'll worship together, Egyptians and Assyrians!
- 23 In that day there will be a highway from Egypt to Assyria. The Assyrians will go to Egypt and the Egyptians to Assyria. The Egyptians and Assyrians will worship together.
- 24 On that Day, Israel will take its place alongside Egypt and Assyria, sharing the blessing from the center.
- 24 In that day Israel will be the third, along with Egypt and Assyria, a blessing on the earth.
- 25 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, who blessed Israel, will generously bless them all: "Blessed be Egypt, my people! . . . Blessed be Assyria, work of my hands! . . . Blessed be Israel, my heritage!"
- 25 The LORD Almighty will bless them, saying, "Blessed be Egypt my people, Assyria my handiwork, and Israel my inheritance."

Isaiah 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the year the field commander, sent by King Sargon of Assyria, came to Ashdod and fought and took it,
- 1 In the year that the supreme commander, sent by Sargon king of Assyria, came to Ashdod and attacked and captured it--
- 2 GOD told Isaiah son of Amoz, "Go, take off your clothes and sandals," and Isaiah did it, going about naked and barefooted.
- 2 at that time the LORD spoke through Isaiah son of Amoz. He said to him, "Take off the sackcloth from your body and the sandals from your feet." And he did so, going around stripped and barefoot.
- 3 Then GOD said, "Just as my servant Isaiah has walked around town naked and barefooted for three years as a warning sign to Egypt and Ethiopia,
- 3 Then the LORD said, "Just as my servant Isaiah has gone stripped and barefoot for three years, as a sign and portent against Egypt and Cush,
- 4 so the king of Assyria is going to come and take the Egyptians as captives and the Ethiopians as exiles. He'll take young and old alike and

- march them out of there naked and barefooted, exposed to mockery and jeers--the bared buttocks of Egypt on parade!
- 4 so the king of Assyria will lead away stripped and barefoot the Egyptian captives and Cushite exiles, young and old, with buttocks bared--to Egypt's shame.
- 5 Everyone who has put hope in Ethiopia and expected help from Egypt will be thrown into confusion.
- 5 Those who trusted in Cush and boasted in Egypt will be afraid and put to shame.
- 6 Everyone who lives along this coast will say, 'Look at them! Naked and barefooted, shuffling off to exile! And we thought they were our best hope, that they'd rescue us from the king of Assyria. Now what's going to happen to us? How are we going to get out of this?'"
- 6 In that day the people who live on this coast will say, 'See what has happened to those we relied on, those we fled to for help and deliverance from the king of Assyria! How then can we escape?' "

Isaiah 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Message concerning the desert at the sea: As tempests drive through the Negev Desert, coming out of the desert, that terror-filled place,
- 1 An oracle concerning the Desert by the Sea: Like whirlwinds sweeping through the southland, an invader comes from the desert, from a land of terror.
- 2 A hard vision is given me: The betrayer betrayed, the plunderer plundered. Attack, Elam! Lay siege, Media! Persians, attack! Attack, Babylon! I'll put an end to all the moaning and groaning.
- 2 A dire vision has been shown to me: The traitor betrays, the looter takes loot. Elam, attack! Media, lay siege! I will bring to an end all the groaning she caused.
- 3 Because of this news I'm doubled up in pain, writhing in pain like a woman having a baby, Baffled by what I hear, undone by what I see.
- 3 At this my body is racked with pain, pangs seize me, like those of a woman in labor; I am staggered by what I hear, I am bewildered by what

I see.

- 4 Absolutely stunned, horror-stricken, I had hoped for a relaxed evening, but it has turned into a nightmare.
- 4 My heart falters, fear makes me tremble; the twilight I longed for has become a horror to me.
- 5 The banquet is spread, the guests reclining in luxurious ease, Eating and drinking, having a good time, and then, "To arms, princes! The fight is on!"
- 5 They set the tables, they spread the rugs, they eat, they drink! Get up, you officers, oil the shields!
- 6 The Master told me, "Go, post a lookout. Have him report whatever he spots.
- 6 This is what the Lord says to me: "Go, post a lookout and have him report what he sees.
- 7 When he sees horses and wagons in battle formation, lines of donkeys and columns of camels, Tell him to keep his ear to the ground, note every whisper, every rumor."
- 7 When he sees chariots with teams of horses, riders on donkeys or riders on camels, let him be alert, fully alert."
- 8 Just then, the lookout shouted, "I'm at my post, Master, Sticking to my post day after day and all through the night!
- 8 And the lookout shouted, "Day after day, my lord, I stand on the watchtower; every night I stay at my post.
- 9 I watched them come, the horses and wagons in battle formation. I heard them call out the war news in headlines: 'Babylon fallen! Fallen! And all its precious god-idols smashed to pieces on the ground.'"
- 9 Look, here comes a man in a chariot with a team of horses. And he gives back the answer: 'Babylon has fallen, has fallen! All the images of its gods lie shattered on the ground!' "
- 10 Dear Israel, you've been through a lot, you've been put through the mill. The good news I get from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, the God of Israel, I now pass on to you.
- 10 O my people, crushed on the threshing floor, I tell you what I have heard from the LORD Almighty, from the God of Israel.
- 11 A Message concerning Edom: A voice calls to me from the Seir mountains in Edom, "Night watchman! How long till daybreak? How

- long will this night last?"
- 11 An oracle concerning Dumah: Someone calls to me from Seir, "Watchman, what is left of the night? Watchman, what is left of the night?"
- 12 The night watchman calls back, "Morning's coming, But for now it's still night. If you ask me again, I'll give the same answer."
- 12 The watchman replies, "Morning is coming, but also the night. If you would ask, then ask; and come back yet again."
- 13 A Message concerning Arabia: You'll have to camp out in the desert badlands, you caravans of Dedanites.
- 13 An oracle concerning Arabia: You caravans of Dedanites, who camp in the thickets of Arabia,
- 14 Haul water to the thirsty, greet fugitives with bread. Show your desert hospitality, you who live in Tema.
- 14 bring water for the thirsty; you who live in Tema, bring food for the fugitives.
- 15 The desert's swarming with refugees escaping the horrors of war.
- 15 They flee from the sword, from the drawn sword, from the bent bow and from the heat of battle.
- 16 The Master told me, "Hang on. Within one year--I'll sign a contract on it!--the arrogant brutality of Kedar, those hooligans of the desert, will be over,
- 16 This is what the Lord says to me: "Within one year, as a servant bound by contract would count it, all the pomp of Kedar will come to an end.
- 17 nothing much left of the Kedar toughs." The GOD of Israel says so.
- 17 The survivors of the bowmen, the warriors of Kedar, will be few." The LORD, the God of Israel, has spoken.

Isaiah 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 A Message concerning the Valley of Vision: What's going on here anyway? All this partying and noisemaking,
- 1 An oracle concerning the Valley of Vision: What troubles you now, that you have all gone up on the roofs,

- 2 Shouting and cheering in the streets, the city noisy with celebrations!
- 2 O town full of commotion, O city of tumult and revelry? Your slain were not killed by the sword, nor did they die in battle.
- 3 You have no brave soldiers to honor, no combat heroes to be proud of. Your leaders were all cowards, captured without even lifting a sword, A country of cowards captured escaping the battle.
- 3 All your leaders have fled together; they have been captured without using the bow. All you who were caught were taken prisoner together, having fled while the enemy was still far away.
- 4 In the midst of the shouting, I said, "Let me alone. Let me grieve by myself. Don't tell me it's going to be all right. These people are doomed. It's not all right."
- 4 Therefore I said, "Turn away from me; let me weep bitterly. Do not try to console me over the destruction of my people."
- 5 For the Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, is bringing a day noisy with mobs of people, Jostling and stampeding in the Valley of Vision, knocking down walls and hollering to the mountains, "Attack! Attack!"
- 5 The Lord, the LORD Almighty, has a day of tumult and trampling and terror in the Valley of Vision, a day of battering down walls and of crying out to the mountains.
- 6 Old enemies Elam and Kir arrive armed to the teeth-- weapons and chariots and cavalry.
- 6 Elam takes up the quiver, with her charioteers and horses; Kir uncovers the shield.
- 7 Your fine valleys are noisy with war, chariots and cavalry charging this way and that.
- 7 Your choicest valleys are full of chariots, and horsemen are posted at the city gates;
- 8 God has left Judah exposed and defenseless. You assessed your defenses that Day, inspected your arsenal of weapons in the Forest Armory.
- 8 the defenses of Judah are stripped away. And you looked in that day to the weapons in the Palace of the Forest;
- 9 You found the weak places in the city walls that needed repair. You secured the water supply at the Lower Pool.
- 9 you saw that the City of David had many breaches in its defenses; you stored up water in the Lower Pool.

- 10 You took an inventory of the houses in Jerusalem and tore down some to get bricks to fortify the city wall.
- 10 You counted the buildings in Jerusalem and tore down houses to strengthen the wall.
- 11 You built a large cistern to ensure plenty of water. You looked and looked and looked, but you never looked to him who gave you this city, never once consulted the One who has long had plans for this city.
- 11 You built a reservoir between the two walls for the water of the Old Pool, but you did not look to the One who made it, or have regard for the One who planned it long ago.
- 12 The Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, called out on that Day, Called for a day of repentant tears, called you to dress in somber clothes of mourning.
- 12 The Lord, the LORD Almighty, called you on that day to weep and to wail, to tear out your hair and put on sackcloth.
- 13 But what do you do? You throw a party! Eating and drinking and dancing in the streets! You barbecue bulls and sheep, and throw a huge feast-- slabs of meat, kegs of beer. "Seize the day! Eat and drink! Tomorrow we die!"
- 13 But see, there is joy and revelry, slaughtering of cattle and killing of sheep, eating of meat and drinking of wine! "Let us eat and drink," you say, "for tomorrow we die!"
- 14 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies whispered to me his verdict on this frivolity: "You'll pay for this outrage until the day you die." The Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, says so.
- 14 The LORD Almighty has revealed this in my hearing: "Till your dying day this sin will not be atoned for," says the Lord, the LORD Almighty.
- 15 The Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, spoke: "Come. Go to this steward, Shebna, who is in charge of all the king's affairs, and tell him:
- 15 This is what the Lord, the LORD Almighty, says: "Go, say to this steward, to Shebna, who is in charge of the palace:
- 16 What's going on here? You're an outsider here and yet you act like you own the place, make a big, fancy tomb for yourself where everyone can see it, making sure everyone will think you're important.
- 16 What are you doing here and who gave you permission to cut out a grave for yourself here, hewing your grave on the height and chiseling

- your resting place in the rock?
- 17 GOD is about to sack you, to throw you to the dogs. He'll grab you by the hair,
- 17 Beware, the LORD is about to take firm hold of you and hurl you away, O you mighty man.
- 18 swing you round and round dizzyingly, and then let you go, sailing through the air like a ball, until you're out of sight. Where you'll land, nobody knows. And there you'll die, and all the stuff you've collected heaped on your grave. You've disgraced your master's house!
- 18 He will roll you up tightly like a ball and throw you into a large country. There you will die and there your splendid chariots will remain-- you disgrace to your master's house!
- 19 You're fired--and good riddance!
- 19 I will depose you from your office, and you will be ousted from your position.
- 20 "On that Day I'll replace Shebna. I will call my servant Eliakim son of Hilkiah.
- 20 In that day I will summon my servant, Eliakim son of Hilkiah.
- 21 I'll dress him in your robe. I'll put your belt on him. I'll give him your authority. He'll be a father-leader to Jerusalem and the government of Judah.
- 21 I will clothe him with your robe and fasten your sash around him and hand your authority over to him. He will be a father to those who live in Jerusalem and to the house of Judah.
- 22 I'll give him the key of the Davidic heritage. He'll have the run of the place--open any door and keep it open, lock any door and keep it locked.
- 22 I will place on his shoulder the key to the house of David; what he opens no one can shut, and what he shuts no one can open.
- 23 I'll pound him like a nail into a solid wall. He'll secure the Davidic tradition.
- 23 I will drive him like a peg into a firm place; he will be a seat of honor for the house of his father.
- 24 Everything will hang on him--not only the fate of Davidic descendants but also the detailed daily operations of the house, including cups and cutlery.

- 24 All the glory of his family will hang on him: its offspring and offshoots--all its lesser vessels, from the bowls to all the jars.
- 25 "And then the Day will come," says GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, "when that nail will come loose and fall out, break loose from that solid wall--and everything hanging on it will go with it." That's what will happen. GOD says so.
- 25 In that day, declares the LORD Almighty, "the peg driven into the firm place will give way; it will be sheared off and will fall, and the load hanging on it will be cut down." The LORD has spoken.

Isaiah 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 Wail, ships of Tarshish, your strong seaports all in ruins! When the ships returned from Cyprus, they saw the destruction.
- 1 An oracle concerning Tyre: Wail, O ships of Tarshish! For Tyre is destroyed and left without house or harbor. From the land of Cyprus word has come to them.
- 2 Hold your tongue, you who live on the seacoast, merchants of Sidon. Your people sailed the deep seas, buying and selling,
- 2 Be silent, you people of the island and you merchants of Sidon, whom the seafarers have enriched.
- 3 Making money on wheat from Shihor, grown along the Nile--multinational broker in grains!
- 3 On the great waters came the grain of the Shihor; the harvest of the Nile was the revenue of Tyre, and she became the marketplace of the nations.
- 4 Hang your head in shame, Sidon. The Sea speaks up, the powerhouse of the ocean says, "I've never had labor pains, never had a baby, never reared children to adulthood, Never gave life, never worked with life. It was all numbers, dead numbers, profit and loss."
- 4 Be ashamed, O Sidon, and you, O fortress of the sea, for the sea has spoken: "I have neither been in labor nor given birth; I have neither reared sons nor brought up daughters."
- 5 When Egypt gets the report on Tyre, what wailing! what wringing of hands!

- 5 When word comes to Egypt, they will be in anguish at the report from Tyre.
- 6 Visit Tarshish, you who live on the seacoast. Take a good, long look and wail--yes, cry buckets of tears!
- 6 Cross over to Tarshish; wail, you people of the island.
- 7 Is this the city you remember as energetic and alive, bustling with activity, this historic old city, Expanding throughout the globe, buying and selling all over the world?
- 7 Is this your city of revelry, the old, old city, whose feet have taken her to settle in far-off lands?
- 8 And who is behind the collapse of Tyre, the Tyre that controlled the world markets? Tyre's merchants were the business tycoons. Tyre's traders called all the shots.
- 8 Who planned this against Tyre, the bestower of crowns, whose merchants are princes, whose traders are renowned in the earth?
- 9 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies ordered the crash to show the sordid backside of pride and puncture the inflated reputations.
- 9 The LORD Almighty planned it, to bring low the pride of all glory and to humble all who are renowned on the earth.
- 10 Sail for home, O ships of Tarshish. There are no docks left in this harbor.
- 10 Till your land as along the Nile, O Daughter of Tarshish, for you no longer have a harbor.
- 11 GOD reached out to the sea and sea traders, threw the sea kingdoms into turmoil. GOD ordered the destruction of the seacoast cities, the centers of commerce.
- 11 The LORD has stretched out his hand over the sea and made its kingdoms tremble. He has given an order concerning Phoenicia that her fortresses be destroyed.
- 12 GOD said, "There's nothing left here to be proud of, bankrupt and bereft Sidon. Do you want to make a new start in Cyprus? Don't count on it. Nothing there will work out for you either."
- 12 He said, "No more of your reveling, O Virgin Daughter of Sidon, now crushed! "Up, cross over to Cyprus; even there you will find no rest."
- 13 Look at what happened to Babylon: There's nothing left of it. Assyria turned it into a desert, into a refuge for wild dogs and stray cats. They

- brought in their big siege engines, tore down the buildings, and left nothing behind but rubble.
- 13 Look at the land of the Babylonians, this people that is now of no account! The Assyrians have made it a place for desert creatures; they raised up their siege towers, they stripped its fortresses bare and turned it into a ruin.
- 14 Wail, ships of Tarshish, your strong seaports all in ruins!
- 14 Wail, you ships of Tarshish; your fortress is destroyed!
- 15 For the next seventy years, a king's lifetime, Tyre will be forgotten. At the end of the seventy years, Tyre will stage a comeback, but it will be the comeback of a worn-out whore, as in the song:
- 15 At that time Tyre will be forgotten for seventy years, the span of a king's life. But at the end of these seventy years, it will happen to Tyre as in the song of the prostitute:
- 16 "Take a harp, circle the city, unremembered whore. Sing your old songs, your many old songs. Maybe someone will remember."
- 16 Take up a harp, walk through the city, O prostitute forgotten; play the harp well, sing many a song, so that you will be remembered.
- 17 At the end of the seventy years, GOD will look in on Tyre. She'll go back to her old whoring trade, selling herself to the highest bidder, doing anything with anyone--promiscuous with all the kingdoms of earth--for a fee.
- 17 At the end of seventy years, the LORD will deal with Tyre. She will return to her hire as a prostitute and will ply her trade with all the kingdoms on the face of the earth.
- 18 But everything she gets, all the money she takes in, will be turned over to GOD. It will not be put in banks. Her profits will be put to the use of GOD-Aware, GOD-Serving-People, providing plenty of food and the best of clothing.
- 18 Yet her profit and her earnings will be set apart for the LORD; they will not be stored up or hoarded. Her profits will go to those who live before the LORD, for abundant food and fine clothes.

Isaiah 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 Danger ahead! GOD's about to ravish the earth and leave it in ruins, Rip everything out by the roots and send everyone scurrying:
- 1 See, the LORD is going to lay waste the earth and devastate it; he will ruin its face and scatter its inhabitants--
- 2 priests and laypeople alike, owners and workers alike, celebrities and nobodies alike, buyers and sellers alike, bankers and beggars alike, the haves and have-nots alike.
- 2 it will be the same for priest as for people, for master as for servant, for mistress as for maid, for seller as for buyer, for borrower as for lender, for debtor as for creditor.
- 3 The landscape will be a moonscape, totally wasted. And why? Because GOD says so. He's issued the orders.
- 3 The earth will be completely laid waste and totally plundered. The LORD has spoken this word.
- 4 The earth turns gaunt and gray, the world silent and sad, sky and land lifeless, colorless.
- 4 The earth dries up and withers, the world languishes and withers, the exalted of the earth languish.
- 5 Earth is polluted by its very own people, who have broken its laws, Disrupted its order, violated the sacred and eternal covenant.
- 5 The earth is defiled by its people; they have disobeyed the laws, violated the statutes and broken the everlasting covenant.
- 6 Therefore a curse, like a cancer, ravages the earth. Its people pay the price of their sacrilege. They dwindle away, dying out one by one.
- 6 Therefore a curse consumes the earth; its people must bear their guilt. Therefore earth's inhabitants are burned up, and very few are left.
- 7 No more wine, no more vineyards, no more songs or singers.
- 7 The new wine dries up and the vine withers; all the merry-makers groan.
- 8 The laughter of castanets is gone, the shouts of celebrants, gone, the laughter of fiddles, gone.
- 8 The gaiety of the tambourines is stilled, the noise of the revelers has stopped, the joyful harp is silent.
- 9 No more parties with toasts of champagne. Serious drinkers gag on their drinks.

- 9 No longer do they drink wine with a song; the beer is bitter to its drinkers.
- 10 The chaotic cities are unlivable. Anarchy reigns. Every house is boarded up, condemned.
- 10 The ruined city lies desolate; the entrance to every house is barred.
- 11 People riot in the streets for wine, but the good times are gone forever--no more joy for this old world.
- 11 In the streets they cry out for wine; all joy turns to gloom, all gaiety is banished from the earth.
- 12 The city is dead and deserted, bulldozed into piles of rubble.
- 12 The city is left in ruins, its gate is battered to pieces.
- 13 That's the way it will be on this earth. This is the fate of all nations: An olive tree shaken clean of its olives, a grapevine picked clean of its grapes.
- 13 So will it be on the earth and among the nations, as when an olive tree is beaten, or as when gleanings are left after the grape harvest.
- 14 But there are some who will break into glad song. Out of the west they'll shout of GOD's majesty.
- 14 They raise their voices, they shout for joy; from the west they acclaim the LORD's majesty.
- 15 Yes, from the east GOD's glory will ascend. Every island of the sea Will broadcast GOD's fame, the fame of the God of Israel.
- 15 Therefore in the east give glory to the LORD; exalt the name of the LORD, the God of Israel, in the islands of the sea.
- 16 From the four winds and the seven seas we hear the singing: "All praise to the Righteous One!" But I said, "That's all well and good for somebody, but all I can see is doom, doom, and more doom." All of them at one another's throats, yes, all of them at one another's throats.
- 16 From the ends of the earth we hear singing: "Glory to the Righteous One." But I said, "I waste away, I waste away! Woe to me! The treacherous betray! With treachery the treacherous betray!"
- 17 Terror and pits and booby traps are everywhere, whoever you are.
- 17 Terror and pit and snare await you, O people of the earth.
- 18 If you run from the terror, you'll fall into the pit. If you climb out of the pit, you'll get caught in the trap. Chaos pours out of the skies. The foundations of earth are crumbling.

- 18 Whoever flees at the sound of terror will fall into a pit; whoever climbs out of the pit will be caught in a snare. The floodgates of the heavens are opened, the foundations of the earth shake.
- 19 Earth is smashed to pieces, earth is ripped to shreds, earth is wobbling out of control,
- 19 The earth is broken up, the earth is split asunder, the earth is thoroughly shaken.
- 20 Earth staggers like a drunk, sways like a shack in a high wind. Its piled-up sins are too much for it. It collapses and won't get up again.
- 20 The earth reels like a drunkard, it sways like a hut in the wind; so heavy upon it is the guilt of its rebellion that it falls--never to rise again.
- 21 That's when GOD will call on the carpet rebel powers in the skies and Rebel kings on earth.
- 21 In that day the LORD will punish the powers in the heavens above and the kings on the earth below.
- 22 They'll be rounded up like prisoners in a jail, Corralled and locked up in a jail, and then sentenced and put to hard labor.
- 22 They will be herded together like prisoners bound in a dungeon; they will be shut up in prison and be punished after many days.
- 23 Shamefaced moon will cower, humiliated, red-faced sun will skulk, disgraced, Because GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will take over, ruling from Mount Zion and Jerusalem, Splendid and glorious before all his leaders.
- 23 The moon will be abashed, the sun ashamed; for the LORD Almighty will reign on Mount Zion and in Jerusalem, and before its elders, gloriously.

Isaiah 25

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD, you are my God. I celebrate you. I praise you. You've done your share of miracle-wonders, well-thought-out plans, solid and sure.
- 1 O LORD, you are my God; I will exalt you and praise your name, for in perfect faithfulness you have done marvelous things, things planned long ago.

- 2 Here you've reduced the city to rubble, the strong city to a pile of stones.
The enemy Big City is a non-city, never to be a city again.
- 2 You have made the city a heap of rubble, the fortified town a ruin, the
foreigners' stronghold a city no more; it will never be rebuilt.
- 3 Superpowers will see it and honor you, brutal oppressors bow in
worshipful reverence.
- 3 Therefore strong peoples will honor you; cities of ruthless nations will
revere you.
- 4 They'll see that you take care of the poor, that you take care of poor
people in trouble, Provide a warm, dry place in bad weather, provide a
cool place when it's hot. Brutal oppressors are like a winter blizzard
- 4 You have been a refuge for the poor, a refuge for the needy in his
distress, a shelter from the storm and a shade from the heat. For the
breath of the ruthless is like a storm driving against a wall
- 5 and vicious foreigners like high noon in the desert. But you, shelter from
the storm and shade from the sun, shut the mouths of the big-mouthed
bullies.
- 5 and like the heat of the desert. You silence the uproar of foreigners; as
heat is reduced by the shadow of a cloud, so the song of the ruthless is
stilled.
- 6 But here on this mountain, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will throw a feast
for all the people of the world, A feast of the finest foods, a feast with
vintage wines, a feast of seven courses, a feast lavish with gourmet
desserts.
- 6 On this mountain the LORD Almighty will prepare a feast of rich food
for all peoples, a banquet of aged wine-- the best of meats and the finest
of wines.
- 7 And here on this mountain, GOD will banish the pall of doom hanging
over all peoples, The shadow of doom darkening all nations.
- 7 On this mountain he will destroy the shroud that enfolds all peoples, the
sheet that covers all nations;
- 8 Yes, he'll banish death forever. And GOD will wipe the tears from every
face. He'll remove every sign of disgrace From his people, wherever they
are. Yes! GOD says so!
- 8 he will swallow up death forever. The Sovereign LORD will wipe away
the tears from all faces; he will remove the disgrace of his people from

- all the earth. The LORD has spoken.
- 9 Also at that time, people will say, "Look at what's happened! This is our God! We waited for him and he showed up and saved us! This GOD, the one we waited for! Let's celebrate, sing the joys of his salvation.
- 9 In that day they will say, "Surely this is our God; we trusted in him, and he saved us. This is the LORD, we trusted in him; let us rejoice and be glad in his salvation."
- 10 GOD's hand rests on this mountain!" As for the Moabites, they'll be treated like refuse, waste shoveled into a cesspool.
- 10 The hand of the LORD will rest on this mountain; but Moab will be trampled under him as straw is trampled down in the manure.
- 11 Thrash away as they will, like swimmers trying to stay afloat, They'll sink in the sewage. Their pride will pull them under.
- 11 They will spread out their hands in it, as a swimmer spreads out his hands to swim. God will bring down their pride despite the cleverness of their hands.
- 12 Their famous fortifications will crumble to nothing, those mighty walls reduced to dust.
- 12 He will bring down your high fortified walls and lay them low; he will bring them down to the ground, to the very dust.

Isaiah 26

MSG

NIV

- 1 At that time, this song will be sung in the country of Judah: We have a strong city, Salvation City, built and fortified with salvation.
- 1 In that day this song will be sung in the land of Judah: We have a strong city; God makes salvation its walls and ramparts.
- 2 Throw wide the gates so good and true people can enter.
- 2 Open the gates that the righteous nation may enter, the nation that keeps faith.
- 3 People with their minds set on you, you keep completely whole, Steady on their feet, because they keep at it and don't quit.
- 3 You will keep in perfect peace him whose mind is steadfast, because he trusts in you.

- 4 Depend on GOD and keep at it because in the LORD GOD you have a sure thing.
- 4 Trust in the LORD forever, for the LORD, the LORD, is the Rock eternal.
- 5 Those who lived high and mighty he knocked off their high horse. He used the city built on the hill as fill for the marshes.
- 5 He humbles those who dwell on high, he lays the lofty city low; he levels it to the ground and casts it down to the dust.
- 6 All the exploited and outcast peoples build their lives on the reclaimed land.
- 6 Feet trample it down-- the feet of the oppressed, the footsteps of the poor.
- 7 The path of right-living people is level. The Leveler evens the road for the right-living.
- 7 The path of the righteous is level; O upright One, you make the way of the righteous smooth.
- 8 We're in no hurry, GOD. We're content to linger in the path sign-posted with your decisions. Who you are and what you've done are all we'll ever want.
- 8 Yes, LORD, walking in the way of your laws, we wait for you; your name and renown are the desire of our hearts.
- 9 Through the night my soul longs for you. Deep from within me my spirit reaches out to you. When your decisions are on public display, everyone learns how to live right.
- 9 My soul yearns for you in the night; in the morning my spirit longs for you. When your judgments come upon the earth, the people of the world learn righteousness.
- 10 If the wicked are shown grace, they don't seem to get it. In the land of right living, they persist in wrong living, blind to the splendor of GOD.
- 10 Though grace is shown to the wicked, they do not learn righteousness; even in a land of uprightness they go on doing evil and regard not the majesty of the LORD.
- 11 You hold your hand up high, GOD, but they don't see it. Open their eyes to what you do, to see your zealous love for your people. Shame them. Light a fire under them. Get the attention of these enemies of yours.
- 11 O LORD, your hand is lifted high, but they do not see it. Let them see your zeal for your people and be put to shame; let the fire reserved for

- your enemies consume them.
- 12 GOD, order a peaceful and whole life for us because everything we've done, you've done for us.
- 12 LORD, you establish peace for us; all that we have accomplished you have done for us.
- 13 O GOD, our God, we've had other masters rule us, but you're the only Master we've ever known.
- 13 O LORD, our God, other lords besides you have ruled over us, but your name alone do we honor.
- 14 The dead don't talk, ghosts don't walk, Because you've said, "Enough--that's all for you," and wiped them off the books.
- 14 They are now dead, they live no more; those departed spirits do not rise. You punished them and brought them to ruin; you wiped out all memory of them.
- 15 But the living you make larger than life. The more life you give, the more glory you display, and stretch the borders to accommodate more living!
- 15 You have enlarged the nation, O LORD; you have enlarged the nation. You have gained glory for yourself; you have extended all the borders of the land.
- 16 O GOD, they begged you for help when they were in trouble, when your discipline was so heavy they could barely whisper a prayer.
- 16 LORD, they came to you in their distress; when you disciplined them, they could barely whisper a prayer.
- 17 Like a woman having a baby, writhing in distress, screaming her pain as the baby is being born, That's how we were because of you, O GOD.
- 17 As a woman with child and about to give birth writhes and cries out in her pain, so were we in your presence, O LORD.
- 18 We were pregnant full-term. We writhed in labor but bore no baby. We gave birth to wind. Nothing came of our labor. We produced nothing living. We couldn't save the world.
- 18 We were with child, we writhed in pain, but we gave birth to wind. We have not brought salvation to the earth; we have not given birth to people of the world.
- 19 But friends, your dead will live, your corpses will get to their feet. All you dead and buried, wake up! Sing! Your dew is morning dew catching

- the first rays of sun, The earth bursting with life, giving birth to the dead.
- 19 But your dead will live; their bodies will rise. You who dwell in the dust, wake up and shout for joy. Your dew is like the dew of the morning; the earth will give birth to her dead.
- 20 Come, my people, go home and shut yourselves in. Go into seclusion for a while until the punishing wrath is past,
- 20 Go, my people, enter your rooms and shut the doors behind you; hide yourselves for a little while until his wrath has passed by.
- 21 Because GOD is sure to come from his place to punish the wrong of the people on earth. Earth itself will point out the bloodstains; it will show where the murdered have been hidden away.
- 21 See, the LORD is coming out of his dwelling to punish the people of the earth for their sins. The earth will disclose the blood shed upon her; she will conceal her slain no longer.

Isaiah 27

MSG

NIV

- 1 At that time GOD will unsheathe his sword, his merciless, massive, mighty sword. He'll punish the serpent Leviathan as it flees, the serpent Leviathan thrashing in flight. He'll kill that old dragon that lives in the sea.
- 1 In that day, the LORD will punish with his sword, his fierce, great and powerful sword, Leviathan the gliding serpent, Leviathan the coiling serpent; he will slay the monster of the sea.
- 2 "At that same time, a fine vineyard will appear. There's something to sing about!
- 2 In that day-- "Sing about a fruitful vineyard:
- 3 I, GOD, tend it. I keep it well-watered. I keep careful watch over it so that no one can damage it.
- 3 I, the LORD, watch over it; I water it continually. I guard it day and night so that no one may harm it.
- 4 I'm not angry. I care. Even if it gives me thistles and thornbushes, I'll just pull them out and burn them up.

- 4 I am not angry. If only there were briers and thorns confronting me! I would march against them in battle; I would set them all on fire.
- 5 Let that vine cling to me for safety, let it find a good and whole life with me, let it hold on for a good and whole life."
- 5 Or else let them come to me for refuge; let them make peace with me, yes, let them make peace with me."
- 6 The days are coming when Jacob shall put down roots, Israel blossom and grow fresh branches, and fill the world with its fruit.
- 6 In days to come Jacob will take root, Israel will bud and blossom and fill all the world with fruit.
- 7 Has GOD knocked them to the ground as he knocked down those who hit them? Oh, no. Were they killed as their killers were killed? Again, no.
- 7 Has the LORD struck her as he struck down those who struck her? Has she been killed as those were killed who killed her?
- 8 He was hard on them all right. The exile was a harsh sentence. He blew them away on a fierce blast of wind.
- 8 By warfare and exile you contend with her-- with his fierce blast he drives her out, as on a day the east wind blows.
- 9 But the good news is that through this experience Jacob's guilt was taken away. The evidence that his sin is removed will be this: He will tear down the alien altars, take them apart stone by stone, And then crush the stones into gravel and clean out all the sex-and-religion shrines.
- 9 By this, then, will Jacob's guilt be atoned for, and this will be the full fruitage of the removal of his sin: When he makes all the altar stones to be like chalk stones crushed to pieces, no Asherah poles or incense altars will be left standing.
- 10 For there's nothing left of that pretentious grandeur. Nobody lives there anymore. It's unlivable. But animals do just fine, browsing and bedding down.
- 10 The fortified city stands desolate, an abandoned settlement, forsaken like the desert; there the calves graze, there they lie down; they strip its branches bare.
- 11 And it's not a bad place to get firewood. Dry twigs and dead branches are plentiful. It's the leavings of a people with no sense of God. So, the God who made them Will have nothing to do with them. He who formed them will turn his back on them.

- 11 When its twigs are dry, they are broken off and women come and make fires with them. For this is a people without understanding; so their Maker has no compassion on them, and their Creator shows them no favor.
- 12 At that time GOD will thresh from the River Euphrates to the Brook of Egypt, And you, people of Israel, will be selected grain by grain.
- 12 In that day the LORD will thresh from the flowing Euphrates to the Wadi of Egypt, and you, O Israelites, will be gathered up one by one.
- 13 At that same time a great trumpet will be blown, calling home the exiles from Assyria, Welcoming home the refugees from Egypt to come and worship GOD on the holy mountain, Jerusalem.
- 13 And in that day a great trumpet will sound. Those who were perishing in Assyria and those who were exiled in Egypt will come and worship the LORD on the holy mountain in Jerusalem.

Isaiah 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to the pretentious drunks of Ephraim, shabby and washed out and seedy-- Tipsy, sloppy-fat, beer-bellied parodies of a proud and handsome past.
- 1 Woe to that wreath, the pride of Ephraim's drunkards, to the fading flower, his glorious beauty, set on the head of a fertile valley-- to that city, the pride of those laid low by wine!
- 2 Watch closely: GOD has someone picked out, someone tough and strong to flatten them. Like a hailstorm, like a hurricane, like a flash flood, one-handed he'll throw them to the ground.
- 2 See, the Lord has one who is powerful and strong. Like a hailstorm and a destructive wind, like a driving rain and a flooding downpour, he will throw it forcefully to the ground.
- 3 Samaria, the party hat on Israel's head, will be knocked off with one blow.
- 3 That wreath, the pride of Ephraim's drunkards, will be trampled underfoot.
- 4 It will disappear quicker than a piece of meat tossed to a dog.

- 4 That fading flower, his glorious beauty, set on the head of a fertile valley, will be like a fig ripe before harvest-- as soon as someone sees it and takes it in his hand, he swallows it.
- 5 At that time, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will be the beautiful crown on the head of what's left of his people:
- 5 In that day the LORD Almighty will be a glorious crown, a beautiful wreath for the remnant of his people.
- 6 Energy and insights of justice to those who guide and decide, strength and prowess to those who guard and protect.
- 6 He will be a spirit of justice to him who sits in judgment, a source of strength to those who turn back the battle at the gate.
- 7 These also, the priest and prophet, stagger from drink, weaving, falling-down drunks, Besotted with wine and whiskey, can't see straight, can't talk sense.
- 7 And these also stagger from wine and reel from beer: Priests and prophets stagger from beer and are befuddled with wine; they reel from beer, they stagger when seeing visions, they stumble when rendering decisions.
- 8 Every table is covered with vomit. They live in vomit.
- 8 All the tables are covered with vomit and there is not a spot without filth.
- 9 "Is that so? And who do you think you are to teach us? Who are you to lord it over us? We're not babies in diapers to be talked down to by such as you--
- 9 Who is it he is trying to teach? To whom is he explaining his message? To children weaned from their milk, to those just taken from the breast?
- 10 'Da, da, da, da, blah, blah, blah, blah. That's a good little girl, that's a good little boy.'"
- 10 For it is: Do and do, do and do, rule on rule, rule on rule; a little here, a little there."
- 11 But that's exactly how you will be addressed. God will speak to this people In baby talk, one syllable at a time--
- 11 Very well then, with foreign lips and strange tongues God will speak to this people,
- 12 and he'll do it through foreign oppressors. He said before, "This is the time and place to rest, to give rest to the weary. This is the place to lay down your burden." But they won't listen.

- 12 to whom he said, "This is the resting place, let the weary rest"; and, "This is the place of repose"-- but they would not listen.
- 13 So GOD will start over with the simple basics and address them in baby talk, one syllable at a time-- "Da, da, da, da, blah, blah, blah, blah. That's a good little girl, that's a good little boy." And like toddlers, they will get up and fall down, get bruised and confused and lost.
- 13 So then, the word of the LORD to them will become: Do and do, do and do, rule on rule, rule on rule; a little here, a little there-- so that they will go and fall backward, be injured and snared and captured.
- 14 Now listen to GOD's Message, you scoffers, you who rule this people in Jerusalem.
- 14 Therefore hear the word of the LORD, you scoffers who rule this people in Jerusalem.
- 15 You say, "We've taken out good life insurance. We've hedged all our bets, covered all our bases. No disaster can touch us. We've thought of everything. We're advised by the experts. We're set."
- 15 You boast, "We have entered into a covenant with death, with the grave we have made an agreement. When an overwhelming scourge sweeps by, it cannot touch us, for we have made a lie our refuge and falsehood our hiding place."
- 16 But the Master, GOD, has something to say to this: "Watch closely. I'm laying a foundation in Zion, a solid granite foundation, squared and true. And this is the meaning of the stone: A TRUSTING LIFE WON'T TOPPLE.
- 16 So this is what the Sovereign LORD says: "See, I lay a stone in Zion, a tested stone, a precious cornerstone for a sure foundation; the one who trusts will never be dismayed.
- 17 I'll make justice the measuring stick and righteousness the plumb line for the building. A hailstorm will knock down the shantytown of lies, and a flash flood will wash out the rubble.
- 17 I will make justice the measuring line and righteousness the plumb line; hail will sweep away your refuge, the lie, and water will overflow your hiding place.
- 18 "Then you'll see that your precious life insurance policy wasn't worth the paper it was written on. Your careful precautions against death were

a pack of illusions and lies. When the disaster happens, you'll be crushed by it.

18 Your covenant with death will be annulled; your agreement with the grave will not stand. When the overwhelming scourge sweeps by, you will be beaten down by it.

19 Every time disaster comes, you'll be in on it-- disaster in the morning, disaster at night." Every report of disaster will send you cowering in terror.

19 As often as it comes it will carry you away; morning after morning, by day and by night, it will sweep through." The understanding of this message will bring sheer terror.

20 There will be no place where you can rest, nothing to hide under.

20 The bed is too short to stretch out on, the blanket too narrow to wrap around you.

21 GOD will rise to full stature, raging as he did long ago on Mount Perazim And in the valley of Gibeon against the Philistines. But this time it's against you. Hard to believe, but true. Not what you'd expect, but it's coming.

21 The LORD will rise up as he did at Mount Perazim, he will rouse himself as in the Valley of Gibeon-- to do his work, his strange work, and perform his task, his alien task.

22 Sober up, friends, and don't scoff. Scoffing will just make it worse. I've heard the orders issued for destruction, orders from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies--ending up in an international disaster.

22 Now stop your mocking, or your chains will become heavier; the Lord, the LORD Almighty, has told me of the destruction decreed against the whole land.

23 Listen to me now. Give me your closest attention.

23 Listen and hear my voice; pay attention and hear what I say.

24 Do farmers plow and plow and do nothing but plow? Or harrow and harrow and do nothing but harrow?

24 When a farmer plows for planting, does he plow continually? Does he keep on breaking up and harrowing the soil?

25 After they've prepared the ground, don't they plant? Don't they scatter dill and spread cumin, Plant wheat and barley in the fields and raspberries along the borders?

- 25 When he has leveled the surface, does he not sow caraway and scatter cummin? Does he not plant wheat in its place, barley in its plot, and spelt in its field?
- 26 They know exactly what to do and when to do it. Their God is their teacher.
- 26 His God instructs him and teaches him the right way.
- 27 And at the harvest, the delicate herbs and spices, the dill and cumin, are treated delicately.
- 27 Caraway is not threshed with a sledge, nor is a cartwheel rolled over cummin; caraway is beaten out with a rod, and cummin with a stick.
- 28 On the other hand, wheat is threshed and milled, but still not endlessly. The farmer knows how to treat each kind of grain.
- 28 Grain must be ground to make bread; so one does not go on threshing it forever. Though he drives the wheels of his threshing cart over it, his horses do not grind it.
- 29 He's learned it all from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, who knows everything about when and how and where.
- 29 All this also comes from the LORD Almighty, wonderful in counsel and magnificent in wisdom.

Isaiah 29

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom, Ariel, Ariel, the city where David set camp! Let the years add up, let the festivals run their cycles,
- 1 Woe to you, Ariel, Ariel, the city where David settled! Add year to year and let your cycle of festivals go on.
- 2 But I'm not letting up on Jerusalem. The moaning and groaning will continue. Jerusalem to me is an Ariel.
- 2 Yet I will besiege Ariel; she will mourn and lament, she will be to me like an altar hearth.
- 3 Like David, I'll set up camp against you. I'll set siege, build towers, bring in siege engines, build siege ramps.
- 3 I will encamp against you all around; I will encircle you with towers and set up my siege works against you.

- 4 Driven into the ground, you'll speak, you'll mumble words from the dirt--
Your voice from the ground, like the muttering of a ghost. Your speech
will whisper from the dust.
- 4 Brought low, you will speak from the ground; your speech will mumble
out of the dust. Your voice will come ghostlike from the earth; out of the
dust your speech will whisper.
- 5 But it will be your enemies who are beaten to dust, the mob of tyrants
who will be blown away like chaff. Because, surprise, as if out of
nowhere,
- 5 But your many enemies will become like fine dust, the ruthless hordes
like blown chaff. Suddenly, in an instant,
- 6 a visit from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, With thunderclaps, earthquakes,
and earsplitting noise, backed up by hurricanes, tornadoes, and lightning
strikes,
- 6 the LORD Almighty will come with thunder and earthquake and great
noise, with windstorm and tempest and flames of a devouring fire.
- 7 And the mob of enemies at war with Ariel, all who trouble and hassle and
torment her, will turn out to be a bad dream, a nightmare.
- 7 Then the hordes of all the nations that fight against Ariel, that attack her
and her fortress and besiege her, will be as it is with a dream, with a
vision in the night--
- 8 Like a hungry man dreaming he's eating steak and wakes up hungry as
ever, Like a thirsty woman dreaming she's drinking iced tea and wakes
up thirsty as ever, So that mob of nations at war against Mount Zion will
wake up and find they haven't shot an arrow, haven't killed a single soul.
- 8 as when a hungry man dreams that he is eating, but he awakens, and his
hunger remains; as when a thirsty man dreams that he is drinking, but he
awakens faint, with his thirst unquenched. So will it be with the hordes
of all the nations that fight against Mount Zion.
- 9 Drug yourselves so you feel nothing. Blind yourselves so you see
nothing. Get drunk, but not on wine. Black out, but not from whiskey.
- 9 Be stunned and amazed, blind yourselves and be sightless; be drunk, but
not from wine, stagger, but not from beer.
- 10 For GOD has rocked you into a deep, deep sleep, put the discerning
prophets to sleep, put the farsighted seers to sleep.

- 10 The LORD has brought over you a deep sleep: He has sealed your eyes (the prophets); he has covered your heads (the seers).
- 11 What you've been shown here is somewhat like a letter in a sealed envelope. If you give it to someone who can read and tell her, "Read this," she'll say, "I can't. The envelope is sealed."
- 11 For you this whole vision is nothing but words sealed in a scroll. And if you give the scroll to someone who can read, and say to him, "Read this, please," he will answer, "I can't; it is sealed."
- 12 And if you give it to someone who can't read and tell him, "Read this," he'll say, "I can't read."
- 12 Or if you give the scroll to someone who cannot read, and say, "Read this, please," he will answer, "I don't know how to read."
- 13 The Master said: "These people make a big show of saying the right thing, but their hearts aren't in it. Because they act like they're worshiping me but don't mean it,
- 13 The Lord says: "These people come near to me with their mouth and honor me with their lips, but their hearts are far from me. Their worship of me is made up only of rules taught by men.
- 14 I'm going to step in and shock them awake, astonish them, stand them on their ears. The wise ones who had it all figured out will be exposed as fools. The smart people who thought they knew everything will turn out to know nothing."
- 14 Therefore once more I will astound these people with wonder upon wonder; the wisdom of the wise will perish, the intelligence of the intelligent will vanish."
- 15 Doom to you! You pretend to have the inside track. You shut GOD out and work behind the scenes, Plotting the future as if you knew everything, acting mysterious, never showing your hand.
- 15 Woe to those who go to great depths to hide their plans from the LORD, who do their work in darkness and think, "Who sees us? Who will know?"
- 16 You have everything backwards! You treat the potter as a lump of clay. Does a book say to its author, "He didn't write a word of me"? Does a meal say to the woman who cooked it, "She had nothing to do with this"?

- 16 You turn things upside down, as if the potter were thought to be like the clay! Shall what is formed say to him who formed it, "He did not make me"? Can the pot say of the potter, "He knows nothing"?
- 17 And then before you know it, and without you having anything to do with it, Wasted Lebanon will be transformed into lush gardens, and Mount Carmel reforested.
- 17 In a very short time, will not Lebanon be turned into a fertile field and the fertile field seem like a forest?
- 18 At that time the deaf will hear word-for-word what's been written. After a lifetime in the dark, the blind will see.
- 18 In that day the deaf will hear the words of the scroll, and out of gloom and darkness the eyes of the blind will see.
- 19 The castoffs of society will be laughing and dancing in GOD, the down-and-outs shouting praise to The Holy of Israel.
- 19 Once more the humble will rejoice in the LORD; the needy will rejoice in the Holy One of Israel.
- 20 For there'll be no more gangs on the street. Cynical scoffers will be an extinct species. Those who never missed a chance to hurt or demean will never be heard of again:
- 20 The ruthless will vanish, the mockers will disappear, and all who have an eye for evil will be cut down--
- 21 Gone the people who corrupted the courts, gone the people who cheated the poor, gone the people who victimized the innocent.
- 21 those who with a word make a man out to be guilty, who ensnare the defender in court and with false testimony deprive the innocent of justice.
- 22 And finally this, GOD's Message for the family of Jacob, the same GOD who redeemed Abraham: "No longer will Jacob hang his head in shame, no longer grow gaunt and pale with waiting.
- 22 Therefore this is what the LORD, who redeemed Abraham, says to the house of Jacob: "No longer will Jacob be ashamed; no longer will their faces grow pale.
- 23 For he's going to see his children, my personal gift to him--lots of children. And these children will honor me by living holy lives. In holy worship they'll honor the Holy One of Jacob and stand in holy awe of the God of Israel.

- 23 When they see among them their children, the work of my hands, they will keep my name holy; they will acknowledge the holiness of the Holy One of Jacob, and will stand in awe of the God of Israel.
- 24 Those who got off-track will get back on-track, and complainers and whiners learn gratitude."
- 24 Those who are wayward in spirit will gain understanding; those who complain will accept instruction."

Isaiah 30

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Doom, rebel children!" GOD's Decree. "You make plans, but not mine. You make deals, but not in my Spirit. You pile sin on sin, one sin on top of another,
- 1 Woe to the obstinate children, declares the LORD, "to those who carry out plans that are not mine, forming an alliance, but not by my Spirit, heaping sin upon sin;
- 2 Going off to Egypt without so much as asking me, Running off to Pharaoh for protection, expecting to hide out in Egypt.
- 2 who go down to Egypt without consulting me; who look for help to Pharaoh's protection, to Egypt's shade for refuge.
- 3 Well, some protection Pharaoh will be! Some hideout, Egypt!
- 3 But Pharaoh's protection will be to your shame, Egypt's shade will bring you disgrace.
- 4 They look big and important, true, with officials strategically established in Zoan in the north and Hanes in the south,
- 4 Though they have officials in Zoan and their envoys have arrived in Hanes,
- 5 but there's nothing to them. Anyone stupid enough to trust them will end up looking stupid-- All show, no substance, an embarrassing farce."
- 5 everyone will be put to shame because of a people useless to them, who bring neither help nor advantage, but only shame and disgrace."
- 6 And this note on the animals of the Negev encountered on the road to Egypt: A most dangerous, treacherous route, menaced by lions and deadly snakes. And you're going to lug all your stuff down there, your

- donkeys and camels loaded down with bribes, Thinking you can buy protection from that hollow farce of a nation?
- 6 An oracle concerning the animals of the Negev: Through a land of hardship and distress, of lions and lionesses, of adders and darting snakes, the envoys carry their riches on donkeys' backs, their treasures on the humps of camels, to that unprofitable nation,
- 7 Egypt is all show, no substance. My name for her is Toothless Dragon.
- 7 to Egypt, whose help is utterly useless. Therefore I call her Rahab the Do-Nothing.
- 8 So, go now and write all this down. Put it in a book So that the record will be there to instruct the coming generations,
- 8 Go now, write it on a tablet for them, inscribe it on a scroll, that for the days to come it may be an everlasting witness.
- 9 Because this is a rebel generation, a people who lie, A people unwilling to listen to anything GOD tells them.
- 9 These are rebellious people, deceitful children, children unwilling to listen to the LORD's instruction.
- 10 They tell their spiritual leaders, "Don't bother us with irrelevancies." They tell their preachers, "Don't waste our time on impracticalities. Tell us what makes us feel better.
- 10 They say to the seers, "See no more visions!" and to the prophets, "Give us no more visions of what is right! Tell us pleasant things, prophesy illusions.
- 11 Don't bore us with obsolete religion. That stuff means nothing to us. Quit hounding us with The Holy of Israel."
- 11 Leave this way, get off this path, and stop confronting us with the Holy One of Israel!"
- 12 Therefore, The Holy of Israel says this: "Because you scorn this Message, Preferring to live by injustice and shape your lives on lies,
- 12 Therefore, this is what the Holy One of Israel says: "Because you have rejected this message, relied on oppression and depended on deceit,
- 13 This perverse way of life will be like a towering, badly built wall That slowly, slowly tilts and shifts, and then one day, without warning, collapses--
- 13 this sin will become for you like a high wall, cracked and bulging, that collapses suddenly, in an instant.

- 14 Smashed to bits like a piece of pottery, smashed beyond recognition or repair, Useless, a pile of debris to be swept up and thrown in the trash."
- 14 It will break in pieces like pottery, shattered so mercilessly that among its pieces not a fragment will be found for taking coals from a hearth or scooping water out of a cistern."
- 15 GOD, the Master, The Holy of Israel, has this solemn counsel: "Your salvation requires you to turn back to me and stop your silly efforts to save yourselves. Your strength will come from settling down in complete dependence on me-- The very thing you've been unwilling to do.
- 15 This is what the Sovereign LORD, the Holy One of Israel, says: "In repentance and rest is your salvation, in quietness and trust is your strength, but you would have none of it.
- 16 You've said, 'Nothing doing! We'll rush off on horseback!' You'll rush off, all right! Just not far enough! You've said, 'We'll ride off on fast horses!' Do you think your pursuers ride old nags?
- 16 You said, 'No, we will flee on horses.' Therefore you will flee! You said, 'We will ride off on swift horses.' Therefore your pursuers will be swift!
- 17 Think again: A thousand of you will scatter before one attacker. Before a mere five you'll all run off. There'll be nothing left of you-- a flagpole on a hill with no flag, a signpost on a roadside with the sign torn off."
- 17 A thousand will flee at the threat of one; at the threat of five you will all flee away, till you are left like a flagstaff on a mountaintop, like a banner on a hill."
- 18 But GOD's not finished. He's waiting around to be gracious to you. He's gathering strength to show mercy to you. GOD takes the time to do everything right--everything. Those who wait around for him are the lucky ones.
- 18 Yet the LORD longs to be gracious to you; he rises to show you compassion. For the LORD is a God of justice. Blessed are all who wait for him!
- 19 Oh yes, people of Zion, citizens of Jerusalem, your time of tears is over. Cry for help and you'll find it's grace and more grace. The moment he hears, he'll answer.
- 19 O people of Zion, who live in Jerusalem, you will weep no more. How gracious he will be when you cry for help! As soon as he hears, he will answer you.

- 20 Just as the Master kept you alive during the hard times, he'll keep your teacher alive and present among you. Your teacher will be right there, local and on the job,
- 20 Although the Lord gives you the bread of adversity and the water of affliction, your teachers will be hidden no more; with your own eyes you will see them.
- 21 urging you on whenever you wander left or right: "This is the right road. Walk down this road."
- 21 Whether you turn to the right or to the left, your ears will hear a voice behind you, saying, "This is the way; walk in it."
- 22 You'll scrap your expensive and fashionable god-images. You'll throw them in the trash as so much garbage, saying, "Good riddance!"
- 22 Then you will defile your idols overlaid with silver and your images covered with gold; you will throw them away like a menstrual cloth and say to them, "Away with you!"
- 23 God will provide rain for the seeds you sow. The grain that grows will be abundant. Your cattle will range far and wide.
- 23 He will also send you rain for the seed you sow in the ground, and the food that comes from the land will be rich and plentiful. In that day your cattle will graze in broad meadows.
- 24 Oblivious to war and earthquake, the oxen and donkeys you use for hauling and plowing will be fed well
- 24 The oxen and donkeys that work the soil will eat fodder and mash, spread out with fork and shovel.
- 25 near running brooks that flow freely from mountains and hills.
- 25 In the day of great slaughter, when the towers fall, streams of water will flow on every high mountain and every lofty hill.
- 26 Better yet, on the Day GOD heals his people of the wounds and bruises from the time of punishment, moonlight will flare into sunlight, and sunlight, like a whole week of sunshine at once, will flood the land.
- 26 The moon will shine like the sun, and the sunlight will be seven times brighter, like the light of seven full days, when the LORD binds up the bruises of his people and heals the wounds he inflicted.
- 27 Look, GOD's on his way, and from a long way off! Smoking with anger, immense as he comes into view, Words steaming from his mouth, searing, indicting words!

- 27 See, the Name of the LORD comes from afar, with burning anger and dense clouds of smoke; his lips are full of wrath, and his tongue is a consuming fire.
- 28 A torrent of words, a flash flood of words sweeping everyone into the vortex of his words. He'll shake down the nations in a sieve of destruction, herd them into a dead end.
- 28 His breath is like a rushing torrent, rising up to the neck. He shakes the nations in the sieve of destruction; he places in the jaws of the peoples a bit that leads them astray.
- 29 But you will sing, sing through an all-night holy feast! Your hearts will burst with song, make music like the sound of flutes on parade, En route to the mountain of GOD, on the way to the Rock of Israel.
- 29 And you will sing as on the night you celebrate a holy festival; your hearts will rejoice as when people go up with flutes to the mountain of the LORD, to the Rock of Israel.
- 30 GOD will sound out in grandiose thunder, display his hammering arm, Furiously angry, showering sparks-- cloudburst, storm, hail!
- 30 The LORD will cause men to hear his majestic voice and will make them see his arm coming down with raging anger and consuming fire, with cloudburst, thunderstorm and hail.
- 31 Oh yes, at GOD's thunder Assyria will cower under the clubbing.
- 31 The voice of the LORD will shatter Assyria; with his scepter he will strike them down.
- 32 Every blow GOD lands on them with his club is in time to the music of drums and pipes, GOD in all-out, two-fisted battle, fighting against them.
- 32 Every stroke the LORD lays on them with his punishing rod will be to the music of tambourines and harps, as he fights them in battle with the blows of his arm.
- 33 Topheth's fierce fires are well prepared, ready for the Assyrian king. The Topheth furnace is deep and wide, well stoked with hot-burning wood. GOD's breath, like a river of burning pitch, starts the fire.
- 33 Topheth has long been prepared; it has been made ready for the king. Its fire pit has been made deep and wide, with an abundance of fire and wood; the breath of the LORD, like a stream of burning sulfur, sets it ablaze.

Isaiah 31

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to those who go off to Egypt thinking that horses can help them, Impressed by military mathematics, awed by sheer numbers of chariots and riders-- And to The Holy of Israel, not even a glance, not so much as a prayer to GOD.
- 1 Woe to those who go down to Egypt for help, who rely on horses, who trust in the multitude of their chariots and in the great strength of their horsemen, but do not look to the Holy One of Israel, or seek help from the LORD.
- 2 Still, he must be reckoned with, a most wise God who knows what he's doing. He can call down catastrophe. He's a God who does what he says. He intervenes in the work of those who do wrong, stands up against interfering evildoers.
- 2 Yet he too is wise and can bring disaster; he does not take back his words. He will rise up against the house of the wicked, against those who help evildoers.
- 3 Egyptians are mortal, not God, and their horses are flesh, not Spirit. When GOD gives the signal, helpers and helped alike will fall in a heap and share the same dirt grave.
- 3 But the Egyptians are men and not God; their horses are flesh and not spirit. When the LORD stretches out his hand, he who helps will stumble, he who is helped will fall; both will perish together.
- 4 This is what GOD told me: "Like a lion, king of the beasts, that gnaws and chews and worries its prey, Not fazed in the least by a bunch of shepherds who arrive to chase it off, So GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies comes down to fight on Mount Zion, to make war from its heights.
- 4 This is what the LORD says to me: "As a lion growls, a great lion over his prey-- and though a whole band of shepherds is called together against him, he is not frightened by their shouts or disturbed by their clamor-- so the LORD Almighty will come down to do battle on Mount Zion and on its heights.
- 5 And like a huge eagle hovering in the sky, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies protects Jerusalem. I'll protect and rescue it. Yes, I'll hover and deliver."

- 5 Like birds hovering overhead, the LORD Almighty will shield Jerusalem; he will shield it and deliver it, he will 'pass over' it and will rescue it."
- 6 Repent, return, dear Israel, to the One you so cruelly abandoned.
- 6 Return to him you have so greatly revolted against, O Israelites.
- 7 On the day you return, you'll throw away--every last one of you--the no-gods your sinful hands made from metal and wood.
- 7 For in that day every one of you will reject the idols of silver and gold your sinful hands have made.
- 8 "Assyrians will fall dead, killed by a sword-thrust but not by a soldier, laid low by a sword not swung by a mortal. Assyrians will run from that sword, run for their lives, and their prize young men made slaves.
- 8 Assyria will fall by a sword that is not of man; a sword, not of mortals, will devour them. They will flee before the sword and their young men will be put to forced labor.
- 9 Terrorized, that rock-solid people will fall to pieces, their leaders scatter hysterically." GOD's Decree on Assyria. His fire blazes in Zion, his furnace burns hot in Jerusalem.
- 9 Their stronghold will fall because of terror; at sight of the battle standard their commanders will panic," declares the LORD, whose fire is in Zion, whose furnace is in Jerusalem.

Isaiah 32

MSG

NIV

- 1 But look! A king will rule in the right way, and his leaders will carry out justice.
- 1 See, a king will reign in righteousness and rulers will rule with justice.
- 2 Each one will stand as a shelter from high winds, provide safe cover in stormy weather. Each will be cool running water in parched land, a huge granite outcrop giving shade in the desert.
- 2 Each man will be like a shelter from the wind and a refuge from the storm, like streams of water in the desert and the shadow of a great rock in a thirsty land.
- 3 Anyone who looks will see, anyone who listens will hear.

- 3 Then the eyes of those who see will no longer be closed, and the ears of those who hear will listen.
- 4 The impulsive will make sound decisions, the tongue-tied will speak with eloquence.
- 4 The mind of the rash will know and understand, and the stammering tongue will be fluent and clear.
- 5 No more will fools become celebrities, nor crooks be rewarded with fame.
- 5 No longer will the fool be called noble nor the scoundrel be highly respected.
- 6 For fools are fools and that's that, thinking up new ways to do mischief. They leave a wake of wrecked lives and lies about GOD, Turning their backs on the homeless hungry, ignoring those dying of thirst in the streets.
- 6 For the fool speaks folly, his mind is busy with evil: He practices ungodliness and spreads error concerning the LORD; the hungry he leaves empty and from the thirsty he withholds water.
- 7 And the crooks? Underhanded sneaks they are, inventive in sin and scandal, Exploiting the poor with scams and lies, unmoved by the victimized poor.
- 7 The scoundrel's methods are wicked, he makes up evil schemes to destroy the poor with lies, even when the plea of the needy is just.
- 8 But those who are noble make noble plans, and stand for what is noble.
- 8 But the noble man makes noble plans, and by noble deeds he stands.
- 9 Take your stand, indolent women! Listen to me! Indulgent, indolent women, listen closely to what I have to say.
- 9 You women who are so complacent, rise up and listen to me; you daughters who feel secure, hear what I have to say!
- 10 In just a little over a year from now, you'll be shaken out of your lazy lives. The grape harvest will fail, and there'll be no fruit on the trees.
- 10 In little more than a year you who feel secure will tremble; the grape harvest will fail, and the harvest of fruit will not come.
- 11 Oh tremble, you indolent women. Get serious, you pampered dolls! Strip down and discard your silk fineries. Put on funeral clothes.
- 11 Tremble, you complacent women; shudder, you daughters who feel secure! Strip off your clothes, put sackcloth around your waists.

- 12 Shed honest tears for the lost harvest, the failed vintage.
- 12 Beat your breasts for the pleasant fields, for the fruitful vines
- 13 Weep for my people's gardens and farms that grow nothing but thistles and thornbushes. Cry tears, real tears, for the happy homes no longer happy, the merry city no longer merry.
- 13 and for the land of my people, a land overgrown with thorns and briers-- yes, mourn for all houses of merriment and for this city of revelry.
- 14 The royal palace is deserted, the bustling city quiet as a morgue, The emptied parks and playgrounds taken over by wild animals, delighted with their new home.
- 14 The fortress will be abandoned, the noisy city deserted; citadel and watchtower will become a wasteland forever, the delight of donkeys, a pasture for flocks,
- 15 Yes, weep and grieve until the Spirit is poured down on us from above And the badlands desert grows crops and the fertile fields become forests.
- 15 till the Spirit is poured upon us from on high, and the desert becomes a fertile field, and the fertile field seems like a forest.
- 16 Justice will move into the badlands desert. Right will build a home in the fertile field.
- 16 Justice will dwell in the desert and righteousness live in the fertile field.
- 17 And where there's Right, there'll be Peace and the progeny of Right: quiet lives and endless trust.
- 17 The fruit of righteousness will be peace; the effect of righteousness will be quietness and confidence forever.
- 18 My people will live in a peaceful neighborhood-- in safe houses, in quiet gardens.
- 18 My people will live in peaceful dwelling places, in secure homes, in undisturbed places of rest.
- 19 The forest of your pride will be clear-cut, the city showing off your power leveled.
- 19 Though hail flattens the forest and the city is leveled completely,
- 20 But you will enjoy a blessed life, planting well-watered fields and gardens, with your farm animals grazing freely.
- 20 how blessed you will be, sowing your seed by every stream, and letting your cattle and donkeys range free.

Isaiah 33

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to you, Destroyer, not yet destroyed; And doom to you, Betrayer, not yet betrayed. When you finish destroying, your turn will come--destroyed! When you quit betraying, your turn will come--betrayed!
- 1 Woe to you, O destroyer, you who have not been destroyed! Woe to you, O traitor, you who have not been betrayed! When you stop destroying, you will be destroyed; when you stop betraying, you will be betrayed.
- 2 GOD, treat us kindly. You're our only hope. First thing in the morning, be there for us! When things go bad, help us out!
- 2 O LORD, be gracious to us; we long for you. Be our strength every morning, our salvation in time of distress.
- 3 You spoke in thunder and everyone ran. You showed up and nations scattered.
- 3 At the thunder of your voice, the peoples flee; when you rise up, the nations scatter.
- 4 Your people, for a change, got in on the loot, picking the field clean of the enemy spoils.
- 4 Your plunder, O nations, is harvested as by young locusts; like a swarm of locusts men pounce on it.
- 5 GOD is supremely esteemed. His center holds. Zion brims over with all that is just and right.
- 5 The LORD is exalted, for he dwells on high; he will fill Zion with justice and righteousness.
- 6 GOD keeps your days stable and secure-- salvation, wisdom, and knowledge in surplus, and best of all, Zion's treasure, Fear-of-GOD.
- 6 He will be the sure foundation for your times, a rich store of salvation and wisdom and knowledge; the fear of the LORD is the key to this treasure.
- 7 But look! Listen! Tough men weep openly. Peacemaking diplomats are in bitter tears.
- 7 Look, their brave men cry aloud in the streets; the envoys of peace weep bitterly.

- 8 The roads are empty-- not a soul out on the streets. The peace treaty is broken, its conditions violated, its signers reviled.
- 8 The highways are deserted, no travelers are on the roads. The treaty is broken, its witnesses are despised, no one is respected.
- 9 The very ground under our feet mourns, the Lebanon mountains hang their heads, Flowering Sharon is a weed-choked gully, and the forests of Bashan and Carmel? Bare branches.
- 9 The land mourns and wastes away, Lebanon is ashamed and withers; Sharon is like the Arabah, and Bashan and Carmel drop their leaves.
- 10 "Now I'm stepping in," GOD says. "From now on, I'm taking over. The gloves come off. Now see how mighty I am.
- 10 Now will I arise, says the LORD. "Now will I be exalted; now will I be lifted up.
- 11 There's nothing to you. Pregnant with chaff, you produce straw babies; full of hot air, you self-destruct.
- 11 You conceive chaff, you give birth to straw; your breath is a fire that consumes you.
- 12 You're good for nothing but fertilizer and fuel. Earth to earth--and the sooner the better.
- 12 The peoples will be burned as if to lime; like cut thornbushes they will be set ablaze."
- 13 "If you're far away, get the reports on what I've done, And if you're in the neighborhood, pay attention to my record.
- 13 You who are far away, hear what I have done; you who are near, acknowledge my power!
- 14 The sinners in Zion are rightly terrified; the godless are at their wit's end: 'Who among us can survive this firestorm? Who of us can get out of this purge with our lives?'"
- 14 The sinners in Zion are terrified; trembling grips the godless: "Who of us can dwell with the consuming fire? Who of us can dwell with everlasting burning?"
- 15 The answer's simple: Live right, speak the truth, despise exploitation, refuse bribes, reject violence, avoid evil amusements.
- 15 He who walks righteously and speaks what is right, who rejects gain from extortion and keeps his hand from accepting bribes, who stops his

ears against plots of murder and shuts his eyes against contemplating evil--

16 This is how you raise your standard of living! A safe and stable way to live. A nourishing, satisfying way to live.

16 this is the man who will dwell on the heights, whose refuge will be the mountain fortress. His bread will be supplied, and water will not fail him.

17 Oh, you'll see the king--a beautiful sight! And you'll take in the wide vistas of land.

17 Your eyes will see the king in his beauty and view a land that stretches afar.

18 In your mind you'll go over the old terrors: "What happened to that Assyrian inspector who condemned and confiscated? And the one who gouged us of taxes? And that cheating moneychanger?"

18 In your thoughts you will ponder the former terror: "Where is that chief officer? Where is the one who took the revenue? Where is the officer in charge of the towers?"

19 Gone! Out of sight forever! Their insolence nothing now but a fading stain on the carpet! No more putting up with a language you can't understand, no more sounds of gibberish in your ears.

19 You will see those arrogant people no more, those people of an obscure speech, with their strange, incomprehensible tongue.

20 Just take a look at Zion, will you? Centering our worship in festival feasts! Feast your eyes on Jerusalem, a quiet and permanent place to live. No more pulling up stakes and moving on, no more patched-together lean-tos.

20 Look upon Zion, the city of our festivals; your eyes will see Jerusalem, a peaceful abode, a tent that will not be moved; its stakes will never be pulled up, nor any of its ropes broken.

21 Instead, GOD! GOD majestic, God himself the place in a country of broad rivers and streams, But rivers blocked to invading ships, off-limits to predatory pirates.

21 There the LORD will be our Mighty One. It will be like a place of broad rivers and streams. No galley with oars will ride them, no mighty ship will sail them.

- 22 For GOD makes all the decisions here. GOD is our king. GOD runs this place and he'll keep us safe.
- 22 For the LORD is our judge, the LORD is our lawgiver, the LORD is our king; it is he who will save us.
- 23 Ha! Your sails are in shreds, your mast wobbling, your hold leaking. The plunder is free for the taking, free for all-- for weak and strong, insiders and outsiders.
- 23 Your rigging hangs loose: The mast is not held secure, the sail is not spread. Then an abundance of spoils will be divided and even the lame will carry off plunder.
- 24 No one in Zion will say, "I'm sick." Best of all, they'll all live guilt-free.
- 24 No one living in Zion will say, "I am ill"; and the sins of those who dwell there will be forgiven.

Isaiah 34

MSG

NIV

- 1 Draw in close now, nations. Listen carefully, you people. Pay attention! Earth, you too, and everything in you. World, and all that comes from you.
- 1 Come near, you nations, and listen; pay attention, you peoples! Let the earth hear, and all that is in it, the world, and all that comes out of it!
- 2 And here's why: GOD is angry, good and angry with all the nations, So blazingly angry at their arms and armies that he's going to rid earth of them, wipe them out.
- 2 The LORD is angry with all nations; his wrath is upon all their armies. He will totally destroy them, he will give them over to slaughter.
- 3 The corpses, thrown in a heap, will stink like the town dump in midsummer, Their blood flowing off the mountains like creeks in spring runoff.
- 3 Their slain will be thrown out, their dead bodies will send up a stench; the mountains will be soaked with their blood.
- 4 Stars will fall out of the sky like overripe, rotting fruit in the orchard, And the sky itself will be folded up like a blanket and put away in a closet. All that army of stars, shriveled to nothing, like leaves and fruit in autumn, dropping and rotting!
- 4 All the stars of the heavens will be dissolved and the sky rolled up like a scroll; all the starry host will fall like withered leaves from the vine, like shriveled figs from the fig tree.
- 5 "Once I've finished with earth and sky, I'll start in on Edom. I'll come down hard on Edom, a people I've slated for total termination."
- 5 My sword has drunk its fill in the heavens; see, it descends in judgment on Edom, the people I have totally destroyed.
- 6 GOD has a sword, thirsty for blood and more blood, a sword hungry for well-fed flesh, Lamb and goat blood, the suet-rich kidneys of rams. Yes, GOD has scheduled a sacrifice in Bozrah, the capital, the whole country of Edom a slaughterhouse.

- 6 The sword of the LORD is bathed in blood, it is covered with fat-- the blood of lambs and goats, fat from the kidneys of rams. For the LORD has a sacrifice in Bozrah and a great slaughter in Edom.
- 7 A wholesale slaughter, wild animals and farm animals alike slaughtered. The whole country soaked with blood, all the ground greasy with fat.
- 7 And the wild oxen will fall with them, the bull calves and the great bulls. Their land will be drenched with blood, and the dust will be soaked with fat.
- 8 It's GOD's scheduled time for vengeance, the year all Zion's accounts are settled.
- 8 For the LORD has a day of vengeance, a year of retribution, to uphold Zion's cause.
- 9 Edom's streams will flow sluggish, thick with pollution, the soil sterile, poisoned with waste, The whole country a smoking, stinking garbage dump--
- 9 Edom's streams will be turned into pitch, her dust into burning sulfur; her land will become blazing pitch!
- 10 The fires burning day and night, the skies black with endless smoke. Generation after generation of wasteland-- no more travelers through this country!
- 10 It will not be quenched night and day; its smoke will rise forever. From generation to generation it will lie desolate; no one will ever pass through it again.
- 11 Vultures and skunks will police the streets; owls and crows will feel at home there. God will reverse creation. Chaos! He will cancel fertility. Emptiness!
- 11 The desert owl and screech owl will possess it; the great owl and the raven will nest there. God will stretch out over Edom the measuring line of chaos and the plumb line of desolation.
- 12 Leaders will have no one to lead. They'll name it No Kingdom There, A country where all kings and princes are unemployed.
- 12 Her nobles will have nothing there to be called a kingdom, all her princes will vanish away.
- 13 Thistles will take over, covering the castles, fortresses conquered by weeds and thornbushes. Wild dogs will prowl the ruins, ostriches have the run of the place.

- 13 Thorns will overrun her citadels, nettles and brambles her strongholds.
She will become a haunt for jackals, a home for owls.
- 14 Wildcats and hyenas will hunt together, demons and devils dance
through the night. The night-demon Lilith, evil and rapacious, will
establish permanent quarters.
- 14 Desert creatures will meet with hyenas, and wild goats will bleat to each
other; there the night creatures will also repose and find for themselves
places of rest.
- 15 Scavenging carrion birds will breed and brood, infestations of ominous
evil.
- 15 The owl will nest there and lay eggs, she will hatch them, and care for
her young under the shadow of her wings; there also the falcons will
gather, each with its mate.
- 16 Get and read GOD's book: None of this is going away, this breeding,
brooding evil. GOD has personally commanded it all. His Spirit set it in
motion.
- 16 Look in the scroll of the LORD and read: None of these will be missing,
not one will lack her mate. For it is his mouth that has given the order,
and his Spirit will gather them together.
- 17 GOD has assigned them their place, decreed their fate in detail. This is
permanent-- generation after generation, the same old thing.
- 17 He allots their portions; his hand distributes them by measure. They will
possess it forever and dwell there from generation to generation.

Isaiah 35

MSG

NIV

- 1 Wilderness and desert will sing joyously, the badlands will celebrate and
flower-- Like the crocus in spring,
- 1 The desert and the parched land will be glad; the wilderness will rejoice
and blossom. Like the crocus,
- 2 bursting into blossom, a symphony of song and color. Mountain glories
of Lebanon--a gift. Awesome Carmel, stunning Sharon--gifts. GOD's
resplendent glory, fully on display. GOD awesome, GOD majestic.

- 2 it will burst into bloom; it will rejoice greatly and shout for joy. The glory of Lebanon will be given to it, the splendor of Carmel and Sharon; they will see the glory of the LORD, the splendor of our God.
- 3 Energize the limp hands, strengthen the rubbery knees.
- 3 Strengthen the feeble hands, steady the knees that give way;
- 4 Tell fearful souls, "Courage! Take heart! GOD is here, right here, on his way to put things right And redress all wrongs. He's on his way! He'll save you!"
- 4 say to those with fearful hearts, "Be strong, do not fear; your God will come, he will come with vengeance; with divine retribution he will come to save you."
- 5 Blind eyes will be opened, deaf ears unstopped,
- 5 Then will the eyes of the blind be opened and the ears of the deaf unstopped.
- 6 Lame men and women will leap like deer, the voiceless break into song. Springs of water will burst out in the wilderness, streams flow in the desert.
- 6 Then will the lame leap like a deer, and the mute tongue shout for joy. Water will gush forth in the wilderness and streams in the desert.
- 7 Hot sands will become a cool oasis, thirsty ground a splashing fountain. Even lowly jackals will have water to drink, and barren grasslands flourish richly.
- 7 The burning sand will become a pool, the thirsty ground bubbling springs. In the haunts where jackals once lay, grass and reeds and papyrus will grow.
- 8 There will be a highway called the Holy Road. No one rude or rebellious is permitted on this road. It's for GOD's people exclusively-- impossible to get lost on this road. Not even fools can get lost on it.
- 8 And a highway will be there; it will be called the Way of Holiness. The unclean will not journey on it; it will be for those who walk in that Way; wicked fools will not go about on it.
- 9 No lions on this road, no dangerous wild animals-- Nothing and no one dangerous or threatening. Only the redeemed will walk on it.
- 9 No lion will be there, nor will any ferocious beast get up on it; they will not be found there. But only the redeemed will walk there,

- 10 The people GOD has ransomed will come back on this road. They'll sing as they make their way home to Zion, unfading halos of joy encircling their heads, Welcomed home with gifts of joy and gladness as all sorrows and sighs scurry into the night.
- 10 and the ransomed of the LORD will return. They will enter Zion with singing; everlasting joy will crown their heads. Gladness and joy will overtake them, and sorrow and sighing will flee away.

Isaiah 36

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria made war on all the fortress cities of Judah and took them.
- 1 In the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah's reign, Sennacherib king of Assyria attacked all the fortified cities of Judah and captured them.
- 2 Then the king of Assyria sent his general, the "Rabshekah," accompanied by a huge army, from Lachish to Jerusalem to King Hezekiah. The general stopped at the aqueduct where it empties into the upper pool on the road to the public laundry.
- 2 Then the king of Assyria sent his field commander with a large army from Lachish to King Hezekiah at Jerusalem. When the commander stopped at the aqueduct of the Upper Pool, on the road to the Washerman's Field,
- 3 Three men went out to meet him: Eliakim son of Hilkiyah, in charge of the palace; Shebna the secretary; and Joah son of Asaph, the official historian.
- 3 Eliakim son of Hilkiyah the palace administrator, Shebna the secretary, and Joah son of Asaph the recorder went out to him.
- 4 The Rabshekah said to them, "Tell Hezekiah that the Great King, the king of Assyria, says this: 'What kind of backing do you think you have against me?'
- 4 The field commander said to them, "Tell Hezekiah, " 'This is what the great king, the king of Assyria, says: On what are you basing this confidence of yours?'

- 5 You're bluffing and I'm calling your bluff. Your words are no match for my weapons. What kind of backup do you have now that you've rebelled against me?
- 5 You say you have strategy and military strength--but you speak only empty words. On whom are you depending, that you rebel against me?
- 6 Egypt? Don't make me laugh. Egypt is a rubber crutch. Lean on Egypt and you'll end up flat on your face. That's all Pharaoh king of Egypt is to anyone who leans on him.
- 6 Look now, you are depending on Egypt, that splintered reed of a staff, which pierces a man's hand and wounds him if he leans on it! Such is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who depend on him.
- 7 And if you try to tell me, "We're leaning on our GOD," isn't it a bit late? Hasn't Hezekiah just gotten rid of all the places of worship, telling you, "You've got to worship at this altar"?
- 7 And if you say to me, "We are depending on the LORD our God"--isn't he the one whose high places and altars Hezekiah removed, saying to Judah and Jerusalem, "You must worship before this altar"?
- 8 "Be reasonable. Face the facts: My master the king of Assyria will give you two thousand horses if you can put riders on them.
- 8 'Come now, make a bargain with my master, the king of Assyria: I will give you two thousand horses--if you can put riders on them!
- 9 You can't do it, can you? So how do you think, depending on flimsy Egypt's chariots and riders, you can stand up against even the lowest-ranking captain in my master's army?
- 9 How then can you repulse one officer of the least of my master's officials, even though you are depending on Egypt for chariots and horsemen?
- 10 "And besides, do you think I came all this way to destroy this land without first getting GOD's blessing? It was your GOD who told me, Make war on this land. Destroy it."
- 10 Furthermore, have I come to attack and destroy this land without the LORD? The LORD himself told me to march against this country and destroy it.' "
- 11 Eliakim, Shebna, and Joah answered the Rabshekah, "Please talk to us in Aramaic. We understand Aramaic. Don't talk to us in Hebrew within earshot of all the people gathered around."

- 11 Then Eliakim, Shebna and Joah said to the field commander, "Please speak to your servants in Aramaic, since we understand it. Don't speak to us in Hebrew in the hearing of the people on the wall."
- 12 But the Rabshekah replied, "Do you think my master has sent me to give this message to your master and you but not also to the people clustered here? It's their fate that's at stake. They're the ones who are going to end up eating their own excrement and drinking their own urine."
- 12 But the commander replied, "Was it only to your master and you that my master sent me to say these things, and not to the men sitting on the wall--who, like you, will have to eat their own filth and drink their own urine?"
- 13 Then the Rabshekah stood up and called out loudly in Hebrew, the common language, "Listen to the message of the great king, the king of Assyria!
- 13 Then the commander stood and called out in Hebrew, "Hear the words of the great king, the king of Assyria!
- 14 Don't listen to Hezekiah's lies. He can't save you.
- 14 This is what the king says: Do not let Hezekiah deceive you. He cannot deliver you!
- 15 And don't pay any attention to Hezekiah's pious sermons telling you to lean on GOD, telling you 'GOD will save us, depend on it. GOD won't let this city fall to the king of Assyria.'
- 15 Do not let Hezekiah persuade you to trust in the LORD when he says, 'The LORD will surely deliver us; this city will not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.'
- 16 "Don't listen to Hezekiah. Listen to the king of Assyria's offer: 'Make peace with me. Come and join me. Everyone will end up with a good life, with plenty of land and water,
- 16 Do not listen to Hezekiah. This is what the king of Assyria says: Make peace with me and come out to me. Then every one of you will eat from his own vine and fig tree and drink water from his own cistern,
- 17 and eventually something far better. I'll turn you loose in wide open spaces, with more than enough fertile and productive land for everyone.'
- 17 until I come and take you to a land like your own--a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards.

- 18 Don't let Hezekiah mislead you with his lies, 'GOD will save us.' Has that ever happened? Has any god in history ever gotten the best of the king of Assyria?
- 18 Do not let Hezekiah mislead you when he says, 'The LORD will deliver us.' Has the god of any nation ever delivered his land from the hand of the king of Assyria?
- 19 Look around you. Where are the gods of Hamath and Arpad? The gods of Sepharvaim? Did the gods do anything for Samaria?
- 19 Where are the gods of Hamath and Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim? Have they rescued Samaria from my hand?
- 20 Name one god that has ever saved its countries from me. So what makes you think that GOD could save Jerusalem from me?"
- 20 Who of all the gods of these countries has been able to save his land from me? How then can the LORD deliver Jerusalem from my hand?"
- 21 The three men were silent. They said nothing, for the king had already commanded, "Don't answer him."
- 21 But the people remained silent and said nothing in reply, because the king had commanded, "Do not answer him."
- 22 Then Eliakim son of Hilkiah, the palace administrator, Shebna the secretary, and Joah son of Asaph, the court historian, tearing their clothes in defeat and despair, went back and reported what the Rabshekah had said to Hezekiah.
- 22 Then Eliakim son of Hilkiah the palace administrator, Shebna the secretary, and Joah son of Asaph the recorder went to Hezekiah, with their clothes torn, and told him what the field commander had said.

Isaiah 37

MSG

NIV

- 1 When King Hezekiah heard the report, he also tore his clothes and dressed in rough, penitential burlap gunnysacks, and went into the sanctuary of GOD.
- 1 When King Hezekiah heard this, he tore his clothes and put on sackcloth and went into the temple of the LORD.

- 2 He sent Eliakim the palace administrator, Shebna the secretary, and the senior priests, all of them also dressed in penitential burlap, to the prophet Isaiah son of Amoz.
- 2 He sent Eliakim the palace administrator, Shebna the secretary, and the leading priests, all wearing sackcloth, to the prophet Isaiah son of Amoz.
- 3 They said to him, "Hezekiah says, 'This is a black day. We're in crisis. We're like pregnant women without even the strength to have a baby!'
- 3 They told him, "This is what Hezekiah says: This day is a day of distress and rebuke and disgrace, as when children come to the point of birth and there is no strength to deliver them.
- 4 Do you think your GOD heard what the Rabshekah said, sent by his master the king of Assyria to mock the living God? And do you think your GOD will do anything about it? Pray for us, Isaiah. Pray for those of us left here holding the fort!"
- 4 It may be that the LORD your God will hear the words of the field commander, whom his master, the king of Assyria, has sent to ridicule the living God, and that he will rebuke him for the words the LORD your God has heard. Therefore pray for the remnant that still survives."
- 5 Then King Hezekiah's servants came to Isaiah.
- 5 When King Hezekiah's officials came to Isaiah,
- 6 Isaiah said, "Tell your master this: 'GOD's Message: Don't be upset by what you've heard, all those words the servants of the Assyrian king have used to mock me.
- 6 Isaiah said to them, "Tell your master, 'This is what the LORD says: Do not be afraid of what you have heard--those words with which the underlings of the king of Assyria have blasphemed me.
- 7 I personally will take care of him. I'll arrange it so that he'll get a rumor of bad news back home and rush home to take care of it. And he'll die there. Killed--a violent death."
- 7 Listen! I am going to put a spirit in him so that when he hears a certain report, he will return to his own country, and there I will have him cut down with the sword.' "
- 8 The Rabshekah left and found the king of Assyria fighting against Libnah. (He had gotten word that the king had left Lachish.)
- 8 When the field commander heard that the king of Assyria had left Lachish, he withdrew and found the king fighting against Libnah.

- 9 Just then the Assyrian king received an intelligence report on King Tirhakah of Ethiopia: "He is on his way to make war on you." On hearing that, he sent messengers to Hezekiah with instructions to deliver this message:
- 9 Now Sennacherib received a report that Tirhakah, the Cushite king of Egypt, was marching out to fight against him. When he heard it, he sent messengers to Hezekiah with this word:
- 10 "Don't let your GOD, on whom you so naively lean, deceive you, promising that Jerusalem won't fall to the king of Assyria.
- 10 Say to Hezekiah king of Judah: Do not let the god you depend on deceive you when he says, 'Jerusalem will not be handed over to the king of Assyria.'
- 11 Use your head! Look around at what the kings of Assyria have done all over the world--one country after another devastated! And do you think you're going to get off?
- 11 Surely you have heard what the kings of Assyria have done to all the countries, destroying them completely. And will you be delivered?
- 12 Have any of the gods of any of these countries ever stepped in and saved them, even one of these nations my predecessors destroyed--Gozan, Haran, Rezeph, and the people of Eden who lived in Telassar?
- 12 Did the gods of the nations that were destroyed by my forefathers deliver them--the gods of Gozan, Haran, Rezeph and the people of Eden who were in Tel Assar?
- 13 Look around. Do you see anything left of the king of Hamath, the king of Arpad, the king of the city of Sepharvaim, the king of Hena, the king of Ivvah?"
- 13 Where is the king of Hamath, the king of Arpad, the king of the city of Sepharvaim, or of Hena or Ivvah?"
- 14 Hezekiah took the letter from the hands of the messengers and read it. Then he went into the sanctuary of GOD and spread the letter out before GOD.
- 14 Hezekiah received the letter from the messengers and read it. Then he went up to the temple of the LORD and spread it out before the LORD.
- 15 Then Hezekiah prayed to GOD:
- 15 And Hezekiah prayed to the LORD:

- 16 "GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, enthroned over the cherubim-angels, you are God, the only God there is, God of all kingdoms on earth. You made heaven and earth.
- 16 O LORD Almighty, God of Israel, enthroned between the cherubim, you alone are God over all the kingdoms of the earth. You have made heaven and earth.
- 17 Listen, O GOD, and hear. Look, O GOD, and see. Mark all these words of Sennacherib that he sent to mock the living God.
- 17 Give ear, O LORD, and hear; open your eyes, O LORD, and see; listen to all the words Sennacherib has sent to insult the living God.
- 18 It's quite true, O GOD, that the kings of Assyria have devastated all the nations and their lands.
- 18 It is true, O LORD, that the Assyrian kings have laid waste all these peoples and their lands.
- 19 They've thrown their gods into the trash and burned them--no great achievement since they were no-gods anyway, gods made in workshops, carved from wood and chiseled from rock. An end to the no-gods!
- 19 They have thrown their gods into the fire and destroyed them, for they were not gods but only wood and stone, fashioned by human hands.
- 20 But now step in, O GOD, our God. Save us from him. Let all the kingdoms of earth know that you and you alone are GOD."
- 20 Now, O LORD our God, deliver us from his hand, so that all kingdoms on earth may know that you alone, O LORD, are God. "
- 21 Then Isaiah son of Amoz sent this word to Hezekiah: "GOD's Message, the God of Israel: Because you brought King Sennacherib of Assyria to me in prayer,
- 21 Then Isaiah son of Amoz sent a message to Hezekiah: "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: Because you have prayed to me concerning Sennacherib king of Assyria,
- 22 here is my answer, GOD's answer: "'She has no use for you, Sennacherib, nothing but contempt, this virgin daughter Zion. She spits at you and turns on her heel, this daughter Jerusalem.
- 22 this is the word the LORD has spoken against him: "The Virgin Daughter of Zion despises and mocks you. The Daughter of Jerusalem tosses her head as you flee.

- 23 "'Who do you think you've been mocking and reviling all these years? Who do you think you've been jeering and treating with such utter contempt All these years? The Holy of Israel!
- 23 Who is it you have insulted and blasphemed? Against whom have you raised your voice and lifted your eyes in pride? Against the Holy One of Israel!
- 24 You've used your servants to mock the Master. You've bragged, "With my fleet of chariots I've gone to the highest mountain ranges, penetrated the far reaches of Lebanon, Chopped down its giant cedars, its finest cypresses. I conquered its highest peak, explored its deepest forest.
- 24 By your messengers you have heaped insults on the Lord. And you have said, 'With my many chariots I have ascended the heights of the mountains, the utmost heights of Lebanon. I have cut down its tallest cedars, the choicest of its pines. I have reached its remotest heights, the finest of its forests.
- 25 I dug wells and drank my fill. I emptied the famous rivers of Egypt with one kick of my foot.
- 25 I have dug wells in foreign lands and drunk the water there. With the soles of my feet I have dried up all the streams of Egypt.'
- 26 "'Haven't you gotten the news that I've been behind this all along? This is a longstanding plan of mine and I'm just now making it happen, using you to devastate strong cities, turning them into piles of rubble
- 26 Have you not heard? Long ago I ordained it. In days of old I planned it; now I have brought it to pass, that you have turned fortified cities into piles of stone.
- 27 and leaving their citizens helpless, bewildered, and confused, drooping like unwatered plants, stunted like withered seedlings.
- 27 Their people, drained of power, are dismayed and put to shame. They are like plants in the field, like tender green shoots, like grass sprouting on the roof, scorched before it grows up.
- 28 "'I know all about your pretentious poses, your officious comings and goings, and, yes, the tantrums you throw against me.
- 28 But I know where you stay and when you come and go and how you rage against me.
- 29 Because of all your wild raging against me, your unbridled arrogance that I keep hearing of, I'll put my hook in your nose and my bit in your

mouth. I'll show you who's boss. I'll turn you around and take you back to where you came from.

29 Because you rage against me and because your insolence has reached my ears, I will put my hook in your nose and my bit in your mouth, and I will make you return by the way you came.

30 "And this, Hezekiah, will be your confirming sign: This year's crops will be slim pickings, and next year it won't be much better. But in three years, farming will be back to normal, with regular sowing and reaping, planting and harvesting.

30 This will be the sign for you, O Hezekiah: This year you will eat what grows by itself, and the second year what springs from that. But in the third year sow and reap, plant vineyards and eat their fruit.

31 What's left of the people of Judah will put down roots and make a new start.

31 Once more a remnant of the house of Judah will take root below and bear fruit above.

32 The people left in Jerusalem will get moving again. Mount Zion survivors will take hold again. The zeal of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will do all this.'

32 For out of Jerusalem will come a remnant, and out of Mount Zion a band of survivors. The zeal of the LORD Almighty will accomplish this.

33 "Finally, this is GOD's verdict on the king of Assyria: "Don't worry, he won't enter this city, won't let loose a single arrow, Won't brandish so much as one shield, let alone build a siege ramp against it.

33 Therefore this is what the LORD says concerning the king of Assyria: He will not enter this city or shoot an arrow here. He will not come before it with shield or build a siege ramp against it.

34 He'll go back the same way he came. He won't set a foot in this city. GOD's Decree.

34 By the way that he came he will return; he will not enter this city," declares the LORD.

35 I've got my hand on this city to save it, Save it for my very own sake, but also for the sake of my David dynasty."

35 I will defend this city and save it, for my sake and for the sake of David my servant!

- 36 Then the Angel of GOD arrived and struck the Assyrian camp--185,000 Assyrians died. By the time the sun came up, they were all dead--an army of corpses!
- 36 Then the angel of the LORD went out and put to death a hundred and eighty-five thousand men in the Assyrian camp. When the people got up the next morning--there were all the dead bodies!
- 37 Sennacherib, king of Assyria, got out of there fast, back home to Nineveh.
- 37 So Sennacherib king of Assyria broke camp and withdrew. He returned to Nineveh and stayed there.
- 38 As he was worshiping in the sanctuary of his god Nisroch, he was murdered by his sons Adrammelech and Sharezer. They escaped to the land of Ararat. His son Esar-haddon became the next king.
- 38 One day, while he was worshiping in the temple of his god Nisroch, his sons Adrammelech and Sharezer cut him down with the sword, and they escaped to the land of Ararat. And Esarhaddon his son succeeded him as king.

Isaiah 38

MSG

NIV

- 1 At that time, Hezekiah got sick. He was about to die. The prophet Isaiah son of Amoz visited him and said, "GOD says, 'Prepare your affairs and your family. This is it: You're going to die. You're not going to get well.'"
- 1 In those days Hezekiah became ill and was at the point of death. The prophet Isaiah son of Amoz went to him and said, "This is what the LORD says: Put your house in order, because you are going to die; you will not recover."
- 2 Hezekiah turned away from Isaiah and, facing the wall, prayed to GOD:
- 2 Hezekiah turned his face to the wall and prayed to the LORD,
- 3 "GOD, please, I beg you: Remember how I've lived my life. I've lived faithfully in your presence, lived out of a heart that was totally yours. You've seen how I've lived, the good that I have done." And Hezekiah wept as he prayed--painful tears.

- 3 Remember, O LORD, how I have walked before you faithfully and with wholehearted devotion and have done what is good in your eyes. And Hezekiah wept bitterly.
- 4 Then GOD told Isaiah,
- 4 Then the word of the LORD came to Isaiah:
- 5 "Go and speak with Hezekiah. Give him this Message from me, GOD, the God of your ancestor David: 'I've heard your prayer. I have seen your tears. Here's what I'll do: I'll add fifteen years to your life.
- 5 Go and tell Hezekiah, 'This is what the LORD, the God of your father David, says: I have heard your prayer and seen your tears; I will add fifteen years to your life.
- 6 And I'll save both you and this city from the king of Assyria. I have my hand on this city.
- 6 And I will deliver you and this city from the hand of the king of Assyria. I will defend this city.
- 7 "'And this is your confirming sign, confirming that I, GOD, will do exactly what I have promised.
- 7 'This is the LORD's sign to you that the LORD will do what he has promised:
- 8 Watch for this: As the sun goes down and the shadow lengthens on the sundial of Ahaz, I'm going to reverse the shadow ten notches on the dial.'" And that's what happened: The declining sun's shadow reversed ten notches on the dial.
- 8 I will make the shadow cast by the sun go back the ten steps it has gone down on the stairway of Ahaz.' " So the sunlight went back the ten steps it had gone down.
- 9 This is what Hezekiah king of Judah wrote after he'd been sick and then recovered from his sickness:
- 9 A writing of Hezekiah king of Judah after his illness and recovery:
- 10 In the very prime of life I have to leave. Whatever time I have left is spent in death's waiting room.
- 10 I said, "In the prime of my life must I go through the gates of death and be robbed of the rest of my years?"
- 11 No more glimpses of GOD in the land of the living, No more meetings with my neighbors, no more rubbing shoulders with friends.

- 11 I said, "I will not again see the LORD, the LORD, in the land of the living; no longer will I look on mankind, or be with those who now dwell in this world.
- 12 This body I inhabit is taken down and packed away like a camper's tent. Like a weaver, I've rolled up the carpet of my life as God cuts me free of the loom And at day's end sweeps up the scraps and pieces.
- 12 Like a shepherd's tent my house has been pulled down and taken from me. Like a weaver I have rolled up my life, and he has cut me off from the loom; day and night you made an end of me.
- 13 I cry for help until morning. Like a lion, God pummels and pounds me, relentlessly finishing me off.
- 13 I waited patiently till dawn, but like a lion he broke all my bones; day and night you made an end of me.
- 14 I squawk like a doomed hen, moan like a dove. My eyes ache from looking up for help: "Master, I'm in trouble! Get me out of this!"
- 14 I cried like a swift or thrush, I moaned like a mourning dove. My eyes grew weak as I looked to the heavens. I am troubled; O Lord, come to my aid!"
- 15 But what's the use? God himself gave me the word. He's done it to me. I can't sleep-- I'm that upset, that troubled.
- 15 But what can I say? He has spoken to me, and he himself has done this. I will walk humbly all my years because of this anguish of my soul.
- 16 O Master, these are the conditions in which people live, and yes, in these very conditions my spirit is still alive-- fully recovered with a fresh infusion of life!
- 16 Lord, by such things men live; and my spirit finds life in them too. You restored me to health and let me live.
- 17 It seems it was good for me to go through all those troubles. Throughout them all you held tight to my lifeline. You never let me tumble over the edge into nothing. But my sins you let go of, threw them over your shoulder--good riddance!
- 17 Surely it was for my benefit that I suffered such anguish. In your love you kept me from the pit of destruction; you have put all my sins behind your back.
- 18 The dead don't thank you, and choirs don't sing praises from the morgue. Those buried six feet under don't witness to your faithful ways.

- 18 For the grave cannot praise you, death cannot sing your praise; those who go down to the pit cannot hope for your faithfulness.
- 19 It's the living--live men, live women--who thank you, just as I'm doing right now. Parents give their children full reports on your faithful ways.
- 19 The living, the living--they praise you, as I am doing today; fathers tell their children about your faithfulness.
- 20 GOD saves and will save me. As fiddles and mandolins strike up the tunes, We'll sing, oh we'll sing, sing, for the rest of our lives in the Sanctuary of GOD.
- 20 The LORD will save me, and we will sing with stringed instruments all the days of our lives in the temple of the LORD.
- 21 Isaiah had said, "Prepare a poultice of figs and put it on the boil so he may recover."
- 21 Isaiah had said, "Prepare a poultice of figs and apply it to the boil, and he will recover."
- 22 Hezekiah had said, "What is my cue that it's all right to enter again the Sanctuary of GOD?"
- 22 Hezekiah had asked, "What will be the sign that I will go up to the temple of the LORD?"

Isaiah 39

MSG

NIV

- 1 Sometime later, King Merodach-baladan son of Baladan of Babylon sent messengers with greetings and a gift to Hezekiah. He had heard that Hezekiah had been sick and was now well.
- 1 At that time Merodach-Baladan son of Baladan king of Babylon sent Hezekiah letters and a gift, because he had heard of his illness and recovery.
- 2 Hezekiah received the messengers warmly. He took them on a tour of his royal precincts, proudly showing them all his treasures: silver, gold, spices, expensive oils, all his weapons--everything out on display. There was nothing in his house or kingdom that Hezekiah didn't show them.
- 2 Hezekiah received the envoys gladly and showed them what was in his storehouses--the silver, the gold, the spices, the fine oil, his entire armory

- and everything found among his treasures. There was nothing in his palace or in all his kingdom that Hezekiah did not show them.
- 3 Later the prophet Isaiah showed up. He asked Hezekiah, "What were these men up to? What did they say? And where did they come from?" Hezekiah said, "They came from a long way off, from Babylon."
- 3 Then Isaiah the prophet went to King Hezekiah and asked, "What did those men say, and where did they come from?" "From a distant land," Hezekiah replied. "They came to me from Babylon."
- 4 "And what did they see in your palace?" "Everything," said Hezekiah. "I showed them the works, opened all the doors and impressed them with it all."
- 4 The prophet asked, "What did they see in your palace?" "They saw everything in my palace," Hezekiah said. "There is nothing among my treasures that I did not show them."
- 5 Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Now listen to this Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies:
- 5 Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear the word of the LORD Almighty:
- 6 I have to warn you, the time is coming when everything in this palace, along with everything your ancestors accumulated before you, will be hauled off to Babylon. GOD says that there will be nothing left. Nothing.
- 6 The time will surely come when everything in your palace, and all that your fathers have stored up until this day, will be carried off to Babylon. Nothing will be left, says the LORD.
- 7 And not only your things but your sons. Some of your sons will be taken into exile, ending up as eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon."
- 7 And some of your descendants, your own flesh and blood who will be born to you, will be taken away, and they will become eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon."
- 8 Hezekiah replied to Isaiah, "Good. If GOD says so, it's good." Within himself he was thinking, "But surely nothing bad will happen in my lifetime. I'll enjoy peace and stability as long as I live."
- 8 The word of the LORD you have spoken is good, Hezekiah replied. For he thought, "There will be peace and security in my lifetime."

Isaiah 40

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Comfort, oh comfort my people," says your God.
- 1 Comfort, comfort my people, says your God.
- 2 "Speak softly and tenderly to Jerusalem, but also make it very clear That she has served her sentence, that her sin is taken care of--forgiven! She's been punished enough and more than enough, and now it's over and done with."
- 2 Speak tenderly to Jerusalem, and proclaim to her that her hard service has been completed, that her sin has been paid for, that she has received from the LORD's hand double for all her sins.
- 3 Thunder in the desert! "Prepare for GOD's arrival! Make the road straight and smooth, a highway fit for our God.
- 3 A voice of one calling: "In the desert prepare the way for the LORD; make straight in the wilderness a highway for our God.
- 4 Fill in the valleys, level off the hills, Smooth out the ruts, clear out the rocks.
- 4 Every valley shall be raised up, every mountain and hill made low; the rough ground shall become level, the rugged places a plain.
- 5 Then GOD's bright glory will shine and everyone will see it. Yes. Just as GOD has said."
- 5 And the glory of the LORD will be revealed, and all mankind together will see it. For the mouth of the LORD has spoken."
- 6 A voice says, "Shout!" I said, "What shall I shout?" "These people are nothing but grass, their love fragile as wildflowers.
- 6 A voice says, "Cry out." And I said, "What shall I cry?" "All men are like grass, and all their glory is like the flowers of the field.
- 7 The grass withers, the wildflowers fade, if GOD so much as puffs on them. Aren't these people just so much grass?
- 7 The grass withers and the flowers fall, because the breath of the LORD blows on them. Surely the people are grass.
- 8 True, the grass withers and the wildflowers fade, but our God's Word stands firm and forever."
- 8 The grass withers and the flowers fall, but the word of our God stands forever."

- 9 Climb a high mountain, Zion. You're the preacher of good news. Raise your voice. Make it good and loud, Jerusalem. You're the preacher of good news. Speak loud and clear. Don't be timid! Tell the cities of Judah, "Look! Your God!"
- 9 You who bring good tidings to Zion, go up on a high mountain. You who bring good tidings to Jerusalem, lift up your voice with a shout, lift it up, do not be afraid; say to the towns of Judah, "Here is your God!"
- 10 Look at him! GOD, the Master, comes in power, ready to go into action. He is going to pay back his enemies and reward those who have loved him.
- 10 See, the Sovereign LORD comes with power, and his arm rules for him. See, his reward is with him, and his recompense accompanies him.
- 11 Like a shepherd, he will care for his flock, gathering the lambs in his arms, Hugging them as he carries them, leading the nursing ewes to good pasture.
- 11 He tends his flock like a shepherd: He gathers the lambs in his arms and carries them close to his heart; he gently leads those that have young.
- 12 Who has scooped up the ocean in his two hands, or measured the sky between his thumb and little finger, Who has put all the earth's dirt in one of his baskets, weighed each mountain and hill?
- 12 Who has measured the waters in the hollow of his hand, or with the breadth of his hand marked off the heavens? Who has held the dust of the earth in a basket, or weighed the mountains on the scales and the hills in a balance?
- 13 Who could ever have told GOD what to do or taught him his business?
- 13 Who has understood the mind of the LORD, or instructed him as his counselor?
- 14 What expert would he have gone to for advice, what school would he attend to learn justice? What god do you suppose might have taught him what he knows, showed him how things work?
- 14 Whom did the LORD consult to enlighten him, and who taught him the right way? Who was it that taught him knowledge or showed him the path of understanding?
- 15 Why, the nations are but a drop in a bucket, a mere smudge on a window. Watch him sweep up the islands like so much dust off the floor!

- 15 Surely the nations are like a drop in a bucket; they are regarded as dust on the scales; he weighs the islands as though they were fine dust.
- 16 There aren't enough trees in Lebanon nor enough animals in those vast forests to furnish adequate fuel and offerings for his worship.
- 16 Lebanon is not sufficient for altar fires, nor its animals enough for burnt offerings.
- 17 All the nations add up to simply nothing before him-- less than nothing is more like it. A minus.
- 17 Before him all the nations are as nothing; they are regarded by him as worthless and less than nothing.
- 18 So who even comes close to being like God? To whom or what can you compare him?
- 18 To whom, then, will you compare God? What image will you compare him to?
- 19 Some no-god idol? Ridiculous! It's made in a workshop, cast in bronze, Given a thin veneer of gold, and draped with silver filigree.
- 19 As for an idol, a craftsman casts it, and a goldsmith overlays it with gold and fashions silver chains for it.
- 20 Or, perhaps someone will select a fine wood-- olive wood, say--that won't rot, Then hire a woodcarver to make a no-god, giving special care to its base so it won't tip over!
- 20 A man too poor to present such an offering selects wood that will not rot. He looks for a skilled craftsman to set up an idol that will not topple.
- 21 Have you not been paying attention? Have you not been listening? Haven't you heard these stories all your life? Don't you understand the foundation of all things?
- 21 Do you not know? Have you not heard? Has it not been told you from the beginning? Have you not understood since the earth was founded?
- 22 God sits high above the round ball of earth. The people look like mere ants. He stretches out the skies like a canvas-- yes, like a tent canvas to live under.
- 22 He sits enthroned above the circle of the earth, and its people are like grasshoppers. He stretches out the heavens like a canopy, and spreads them out like a tent to live in.
- 23 He ignores what all the princes say and do. The rulers of the earth count for nothing.

- 23 He brings princes to naught and reduces the rulers of this world to nothing.
- 24 Princes and rulers don't amount to much. Like seeds barely rooted, just sprouted, They shrivel when God blows on them. Like flecks of chaff, they're gone with the wind.
- 24 No sooner are they planted, no sooner are they sown, no sooner do they take root in the ground, than he blows on them and they wither, and a whirlwind sweeps them away like chaff.
- 25 "So--who is like me? Who holds a candle to me?" says The Holy.
- 25 To whom will you compare me? Or who is my equal? says the Holy One.
- 26 Look at the night skies: Who do you think made all this? Who marches this army of stars out each night, counts them off, calls each by name -- so magnificent! so powerful!-- and never overlooks a single one?
- 26 Lift your eyes and look to the heavens: Who created all these? He who brings out the starry host one by one, and calls them each by name. Because of his great power and mighty strength, not one of them is missing.
- 27 Why would you ever complain, O Jacob, or, whine, Israel, saying, "GOD has lost track of me. He doesn't care what happens to me"?
- 27 Why do you say, O Jacob, and complain, O Israel, "My way is hidden from the LORD; my cause is disregarded by my God"?
- 28 Don't you know anything? Haven't you been listening? GOD doesn't come and go. God lasts. He's Creator of all you can see or imagine. He doesn't get tired out, doesn't pause to catch his breath. And he knows everything, inside and out.
- 28 Do you not know? Have you not heard? The LORD is the everlasting God, the Creator of the ends of the earth. He will not grow tired or weary, and his understanding no one can fathom.
- 29 He energizes those who get tired, gives fresh strength to dropouts.
- 29 He gives strength to the weary and increases the power of the weak.
- 30 For even young people tire and drop out, young folk in their prime stumble and fall.
- 30 Even youths grow tired and weary, and young men stumble and fall;
- 31 But those who wait upon GOD get fresh strength. They spread their wings and soar like eagles, They run and don't get tired, they walk and

don't lag behind.

- 31 but those who hope in the LORD will renew their strength. They will soar on wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not be faint.

Isaiah 41

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Quiet down, far-flung ocean islands. Listen! Sit down and rest, everyone. Recover your strength. Gather around me. Say what's on your heart. Together let's decide what's right.
- 1 Be silent before me, you islands! Let the nations renew their strength! Let them come forward and speak; let us meet together at the place of judgment.
- 2 "Who got things rolling here, got this champion from the east on the move? Who recruited him for this job, then rounded up and corralled the nations so he could run roughshod over kings? He's off and running, pulverizing nations into dust, leaving only stubble and chaff in his wake.
- 2 Who has stirred up one from the east, calling him in righteousness to his service? He hands nations over to him and subdues kings before him. He turns them to dust with his sword, to windblown chaff with his bow.
- 3 He chases them and comes through unscathed, his feet scarcely touching the path.
- 3 He pursues them and moves on unscathed, by a path his feet have not traveled before.
- 4 "Who did this? Who made it happen? Who always gets things started? I did. GOD. I'm first on the scene. I'm also the last to leave.
- 4 Who has done this and carried it through, calling forth the generations from the beginning? I, the LORD--with the first of them and with the last--I am he."
- 5 "Far-flung ocean islands see it and panic. The ends of the earth are shaken. Fearfully they huddle together.
- 5 The islands have seen it and fear; the ends of the earth tremble. They approach and come forward;
- 6 They try to help each other out, making up stories in the dark.

6 each helps the other and says to his brother, "Be strong!"

7 The godmakers in the workshops go into overtime production, crafting new models of no-gods, Urging one another on--'Good job!' 'Great design!'-- pounding in nails at the base so that the things won't tip over.

7 The craftsman encourages the goldsmith, and he who smooths with the hammer spurs on him who strikes the anvil. He says of the welding, "It is good." He nails down the idol so it will not topple.

8 "But you, Israel, are my servant. You're Jacob, my first choice, descendants of my good friend Abraham.

8 But you, O Israel, my servant, Jacob, whom I have chosen, you descendants of Abraham my friend,

9 I pulled you in from all over the world, called you in from every dark corner of the earth, Telling you, 'You're my servant, serving on my side. I've picked you. I haven't dropped you.'

9 I took you from the ends of the earth, from its farthest corners I called you. I said, 'You are my servant'; I have chosen you and have not rejected you.

10 Don't panic. I'm with you. There's no need to fear for I'm your God. I'll give you strength. I'll help you. I'll hold you steady, keep a firm grip on you.

10 So do not fear, for I am with you; do not be dismayed, for I am your God. I will strengthen you and help you; I will uphold you with my righteous right hand.

11 "Count on it: Everyone who had it in for you will end up out in the cold-- real losers. Those who worked against you will end up empty-handed-- nothing to show for their lives.

11 All who rage against you will surely be ashamed and disgraced; those who oppose you will be as nothing and perish.

12 When you go out looking for your old adversaries you won't find them-- Not a trace of your old enemies, not even a memory.

12 Though you search for your enemies, you will not find them. Those who wage war against you will be as nothing at all.

13 That's right. Because I, your GOD, have a firm grip on you and I'm not letting go. I'm telling you, 'Don't panic. I'm right here to help you.'

13 For I am the LORD, your God, who takes hold of your right hand and says to you, Do not fear; I will help you.

- 14 "Do you feel like a lowly worm, Jacob? Don't be afraid. Feel like a fragile insect, Israel? I'll help you. I, GOD, want to reassure you. The God who buys you back, The Holy of Israel.
- 14 Do not be afraid, O worm Jacob, O little Israel, for I myself will help you," declares the LORD, your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel.
- 15 I'm transforming you from worm to harrow, from insect to iron. As a sharp-toothed harrow you'll smooth out the mountains, turn those tough old hills into loamy soil.
- 15 See, I will make you into a threshing sledge, new and sharp, with many teeth. You will thresh the mountains and crush them, and reduce the hills to chaff.
- 16 You'll open the rough ground to the weather, to the blasts of sun and wind and rain. But you'll be confident and exuberant, expansive in The Holy of Israel!
- 16 You will winnow them, the wind will pick them up, and a gale will blow them away. But you will rejoice in the LORD and glory in the Holy One of Israel.
- 17 "The poor and homeless are desperate for water, their tongues parched and no water to be found. But I'm there to be found, I'm there for them, and I, God of Israel, will not leave them thirsty.
- 17 The poor and needy search for water, but there is none; their tongues are parched with thirst. But I the LORD will answer them; I, the God of Israel, will not forsake them.
- 18 I'll open up rivers for them on the barren hills, spout fountains in the valleys. I'll turn the baked-clay badlands into a cool pond, the waterless waste into splashing creeks.
- 18 I will make rivers flow on barren heights, and springs within the valleys. I will turn the desert into pools of water, and the parched ground into springs.
- 19 I'll plant the red cedar in that treeless wasteland, also acacia, myrtle, and olive. I'll place the cypress in the desert, with plenty of oaks and pines.
- 19 I will put in the desert the cedar and the acacia, the myrtle and the olive. I will set pines in the wasteland, the fir and the cypress together,
- 20 Everyone will see this. No one can miss it-- unavoidable, indisputable evidence That I, GOD, personally did this. It's created and signed by The Holy of Israel.

- 20 so that people may see and know, may consider and understand, that the hand of the LORD has done this, that the Holy One of Israel has created it.
- 21 "Set out your case for your gods," says GOD. "Bring your evidence," says the King of Jacob.
- 21 Present your case, says the LORD. "Set forth your arguments," says Jacob's King.
- 22 "Take the stand on behalf of your idols, offer arguments, assemble reasons. Spread out the facts before us so that we can assess them ourselves. Ask them, 'If you are gods, explain what the past means--
- 22 Bring in your idols to tell us what is going to happen. Tell us what the former things were, so that we may consider them and know their final outcome. Or declare to us the things to come,
- 23 or, failing that, tell us what will happen in the future. Can't do that? How about doing something--anything! Good or bad--whatever. Can you hurt us or help us? Do we need to be afraid?'
- 23 tell us what the future holds, so we may know that you are gods. Do something, whether good or bad, so that we will be dismayed and filled with fear.
- 24 They say nothing, because they are nothing-- sham gods, no-gods, fool-making gods.
- 24 But you are less than nothing and your works are utterly worthless; he who chooses you is detestable.
- 25 "I, God, started someone out from the north and he's come. He was called out of the east by name. He'll stomp the rulers into the mud the way a potter works the clay.
- 25 I have stirred up one from the north, and he comes-- one from the rising sun who calls on my name. He treads on rulers as if they were mortar, as if he were a potter treading the clay.
- 26 Let me ask you, Did anyone guess that this might happen? Did anyone tell us earlier so we might confirm it with 'Yes, he's right!'? No one mentioned it, no one announced it, no one heard a peep out of you.
- 26 Who told of this from the beginning, so we could know, or beforehand, so we could say, 'He was right'? No one told of this, no one foretold it, no one heard any words from you.

- 27 But I told Zion all about this beforehand. I gave Jerusalem a preacher of good news.
- 27 I was the first to tell Zion, 'Look, here they are!' I gave to Jerusalem a messenger of good tidings.
- 28 But around here there's no one-- no one who knows what's going on. I ask, but no one can tell me the score.
- 28 I look but there is no one-- no one among them to give counsel, no one to give answer when I ask them.
- 29 Nothing here. It's all smoke and hot air-- sham gods, hollow gods, no-gods.
- 29 See, they are all false! Their deeds amount to nothing; their images are but wind and confusion.

Isaiah 42

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Take a good look at my servant. I'm backing him to the hilt. He's the one I chose, and I couldn't be more pleased with him. I've bathed him with my Spirit, my life. He'll set everything right among the nations.
- 1 Here is my servant, whom I uphold, my chosen one in whom I delight; I will put my Spirit on him and he will bring justice to the nations.
- 2 He won't call attention to what he does with loud speeches or gaudy parades.
- 2 He will not shout or cry out, or raise his voice in the streets.
- 3 He won't brush aside the bruised and the hurt and he won't disregard the small and insignificant, but he'll steadily and firmly set things right.
- 3 A bruised reed he will not break, and a smoldering wick he will not snuff out. In faithfulness he will bring forth justice;
- 4 He won't tire out and quit. He won't be stopped until he's finished his work--to set things right on earth. Far-flung ocean islands wait expectantly for his teaching."
- 4 he will not falter or be discouraged till he establishes justice on earth. In his law the islands will put their hope."
- 5 GOD's Message, the God who created the cosmos, stretched out the skies, laid out the earth and all that grows from it, Who breathes life into

earth's people, makes them alive with his own life:

- 5 This is what God the LORD says-- he who created the heavens and stretched them out, who spread out the earth and all that comes out of it, who gives breath to its people, and life to those who walk on it:
- 6 "I am GOD. I have called you to live right and well. I have taken responsibility for you, kept you safe. I have set you among my people to bind them to me, and provided you as a lighthouse to the nations,
- 6 I, the LORD, have called you in righteousness; I will take hold of your hand. I will keep you and will make you to be a covenant for the people and a light for the Gentiles,
- 7 To make a start at bringing people into the open, into light: opening blind eyes, releasing prisoners from dungeons, emptying the dark prisons.
- 7 to open eyes that are blind, to free captives from prison and to release from the dungeon those who sit in darkness.
- 8 I am GOD. That's my name. I don't franchise my glory, don't endorse the no-god idols.
- 8 I am the LORD; that is my name! I will not give my glory to another or my praise to idols.
- 9 Take note: The earlier predictions of judgment have been fulfilled. I'm announcing the new salvation work. Before it bursts on the scene, I'm telling you all about it."
- 9 See, the former things have taken place, and new things I declare; before they spring into being I announce them to you."
- 10 Sing to GOD a brand-new song, sing his praises all over the world! Let the sea and its fish give a round of applause, with all the far-flung islands joining in.
- 10 Sing to the LORD a new song, his praise from the ends of the earth, you who go down to the sea, and all that is in it, you islands, and all who live in them.
- 11 Let the desert and its camps raise a tune, calling the Kedar nomads to join in. Let the villagers in Sela round up a choir and perform from the tops of the mountains.
- 11 Let the desert and its towns raise their voices; let the settlements where Kedar lives rejoice. Let the people of Sela sing for joy; let them shout from the mountaintops.
- 12 Make GOD's glory resound; echo his praises from coast to coast.

- 12 Let them give glory to the LORD and proclaim his praise in the islands.
- 13 GOD steps out like he means business. You can see he's primed for action. He shouts, announcing his arrival; he takes charge and his enemies fall into line:
- 13 The LORD will march out like a mighty man, like a warrior he will stir up his zeal; with a shout he will raise the battle cry and will triumph over his enemies.
- 14 "I've been quiet long enough. I've held back, biting my tongue. But now I'm letting loose, letting go, like a woman who's having a baby--
- 14 For a long time I have kept silent, I have been quiet and held myself back. But now, like a woman in childbirth, I cry out, I gasp and pant.
- 15 Stripping the hills bare, withering the wildflowers, Drying up the rivers, turning lakes into mudflats.
- 15 I will lay waste the mountains and hills and dry up all their vegetation; I will turn rivers into islands and dry up the pools.
- 16 But I'll take the hand of those who don't know the way, who can't see where they're going. I'll be a personal guide to them, directing them through unknown country. I'll be right there to show them what roads to take, make sure they don't fall into the ditch. These are the things I'll be doing for them-- sticking with them, not leaving them for a minute."
- 16 I will lead the blind by ways they have not known, along unfamiliar paths I will guide them; I will turn the darkness into light before them and make the rough places smooth. These are the things I will do; I will not forsake them.
- 17 But those who invested in the no-gods are bankrupt--dead broke.
- 17 But those who trust in idols, who say to images, 'You are our gods,' will be turned back in utter shame.
- 18 Pay attention! Are you deaf? Open your eyes! Are you blind?
- 18 Hear, you deaf; look, you blind, and see!
- 19 You're my servant, and you're not looking! You're my messenger, and you're not listening! The very people I depended upon, servants of GOD, blind as a bat--willfully blind!
- 19 Who is blind but my servant, and deaf like the messenger I send? Who is blind like the one committed to me, blind like the servant of the LORD?

- 20 You've seen a lot, but looked at nothing. You've heard everything, but listened to nothing.
- 20 You have seen many things, but have paid no attention; your ears are open, but you hear nothing."
- 21 GOD intended, out of the goodness of his heart, to be lavish in his revelation.
- 21 It pleased the LORD for the sake of his righteousness to make his law great and glorious.
- 22 But this is a people battered and cowed, shut up in attics and closets, Victims licking their wounds, feeling ignored, abandoned.
- 22 But this is a people plundered and looted, all of them trapped in pits or hidden away in prisons. They have become plunder, with no one to rescue them; they have been made loot, with no one to say, "Send them back."
- 23 But is anyone out there listening? Is anyone paying attention to what's coming?
- 23 Which of you will listen to this or pay close attention in time to come?
- 24 Who do you think turned Jacob over to the thugs, let loose the robbers on Israel? Wasn't it GOD himself, this God against whom we've sinned--not doing what he commanded, not listening to what he said?
- 24 Who handed Jacob over to become loot, and Israel to the plunderers? Was it not the LORD, against whom we have sinned? For they would not follow his ways; they did not obey his law.
- 25 Isn't it God's anger that's behind all this, God's punishing power? Their whole world collapsed but they still didn't get it; their life is in ruins but they don't take it to heart.
- 25 So he poured out on them his burning anger, the violence of war. It enveloped them in flames, yet they did not understand; it consumed them, but they did not take it to heart.

Isaiah 43

MSG

NIV

- 1 But now, GOD's Message, the God who made you in the first place, Jacob, the One who got you started, Israel: "Don't be afraid, I've

redeemed you. I've called your name. You're mine.

- 1 But now, this is what the LORD says-- he who created you, O Jacob, he who formed you, O Israel: "Fear not, for I have redeemed you; I have summoned you by name; you are mine.
- 2 When you're in over your head, I'll be there with you. When you're in rough waters, you will not go down. When you're between a rock and a hard place, it won't be a dead end--
- 2 When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you pass through the rivers, they will not sweep over you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be burned; the flames will not set you ablaze.
- 3 Because I am GOD, your personal God, The Holy of Israel, your Savior. I paid a huge price for you: all of Egypt, with rich Cush and Seba thrown in!
- 3 For I am the LORD, your God, the Holy One of Israel, your Savior; I give Egypt for your ransom, Cush and Seba in your stead.
- 4 That's how much you mean to me! That's how much I love you! I'd sell off the whole world to get you back, trade the creation just for you.
- 4 Since you are precious and honored in my sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you, and people in exchange for your life.
- 5 "So don't be afraid: I'm with you. I'll round up all your scattered children, pull them in from east and west.
- 5 Do not be afraid, for I am with you; I will bring your children from the east and gather you from the west.
- 6 I'll send orders north and south: 'Send them back. Return my sons from distant lands, my daughters from faraway places.
- 6 I will say to the north, 'Give them up!' and to the south, 'Do not hold them back.' Bring my sons from afar and my daughters from the ends of the earth--
- 7 I want them back, every last one who bears my name, every man, woman, and child Whom I created for my glory, yes, personally formed and made each one."
- 7 everyone who is called by my name, whom I created for my glory, whom I formed and made."

- 8 Get the blind and deaf out here and ready-- the blind (though there's nothing wrong with their eyes) and the deaf (though there's nothing wrong with their ears).
- 8 Lead out those who have eyes but are blind, who have ears but are deaf.
- 9 Then get the other nations out here and ready. Let's see what they have to say about this, how they account for what's happened. Let them present their expert witnesses and make their case; let them try to convince us what they say is true.
- 9 All the nations gather together and the peoples assemble. Which of them foretold this and proclaimed to us the former things? Let them bring in their witnesses to prove they were right, so that others may hear and say, "It is true."
- 10 "But you are my witnesses." GOD's Decree. "You're my handpicked servant So that you'll come to know and trust me, understand both that I am and who I am. Previous to me there was no such thing as a god, nor will there be after me.
- 10 You are my witnesses, declares the LORD, "and my servant whom I have chosen, so that you may know and believe me and understand that I am he. Before me no god was formed, nor will there be one after me.
- 11 I, yes I, am GOD. I'm the only Savior there is.
- 11 I, even I, am the LORD, and apart from me there is no savior.
- 12 I spoke, I saved, I told you what existed long before these upstart gods appeared on the scene. And you know it, you're my witnesses, you're the evidence." GOD's Decree. "Yes, I am God.
- 12 I have revealed and saved and proclaimed-- I, and not some foreign god among you. You are my witnesses," declares the LORD, "that I am God.
- 13 I've always been God and I always will be God. No one can take anything from me. I make; who can unmake it?"
- 13 Yes, and from ancient days I am he. No one can deliver out of my hand. When I act, who can reverse it?"
- 14 GOD, your Redeemer, The Holy of Israel, says: "Just for you, I will march on Babylon. I'll turn the tables on the Babylonians. Instead of whooping it up, they'll be wailing.
- 14 This is what the LORD says-- your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel: "For your sake I will send to Babylon and bring down as fugitives all the Babylonians, in the ships in which they took pride.

15 I am GOD, your Holy One, Creator of Israel, your King."
15 I am the LORD, your Holy One, Israel's Creator, your King."
16 This is what GOD says, the God who builds a road right through the ocean, who carves a path through pounding waves,
16 This is what the LORD says-- he who made a way through the sea, a path through the mighty waters,
17 The God who summons horses and chariots and armies-- they lie down and then can't get up; they're snuffed out like so many candles:
17 who drew out the chariots and horses, the army and reinforcements together, and they lay there, never to rise again, extinguished, snuffed out like a wick:
18 "Forget about what's happened; don't keep going over old history.
18 Forget the former things; do not dwell on the past.
19 Be alert, be present. I'm about to do something brand-new. It's bursting out! Don't you see it? There it is! I'm making a road through the desert, rivers in the badlands.
19 See, I am doing a new thing! Now it springs up; do you not perceive it? I am making a way in the desert and streams in the wasteland.
20 Wild animals will say "Thank you!" --the coyotes and the buzzards-- Because I provided water in the desert, rivers through the sun-baked earth, Drinking water for the people I chose,
20 The wild animals honor me, the jackals and the owls, because I provide water in the desert and streams in the wasteland, to give drink to my people, my chosen,
21 the people I made especially for myself, a people custom-made to praise me.
21 the people I formed for myself that they may proclaim my praise.
22 "But you didn't pay a bit of attention to me, Jacob. You so quickly tired of me, Israel.
22 Yet you have not called upon me, O Jacob, you have not wearied yourselves for me, O Israel.
23 You wouldn't even bring sheep for offerings in worship. You couldn't be bothered with sacrifices. It wasn't that I asked that much from you. I didn't expect expensive presents.
23 You have not brought me sheep for burnt offerings, nor honored me with your sacrifices. I have not burdened you with grain offerings nor

- wearied you with demands for incense.
- 24 But you didn't even do the minimum-- so stingy with me, so closefisted. Yet you haven't been stingy with your sins. You've been plenty generous with them--and I'm fed up.
- 24 You have not bought any fragrant calamus for me, or lavished on me the fat of your sacrifices. But you have burdened me with your sins and wearied me with your offenses.
- 25 "But I, yes I, am the one who takes care of your sins--that's what I do. I don't keep a list of your sins.
- 25 I, even I, am he who blots out your transgressions, for my own sake, and remembers your sins no more.
- 26 "So, make your case against me. Let's have this out. Make your arguments. Prove you're in the right.
- 26 Review the past for me, let us argue the matter together; state the case for your innocence.
- 27 Your original ancestor started the sinning, and everyone since has joined in.
- 27 Your first father sinned; your spokesmen rebelled against me.
- 28 That's why I had to disqualify the Temple leaders, repudiate Jacob and discredit Israel.
- 28 So I will disgrace the dignitaries of your temple, and I will consign Jacob to destruction and Israel to scorn.

Isaiah 44

MSG

NIV

- 1 "But for now, dear servant Jacob, listen-- yes, you, Israel, my personal choice.
- 1 But now listen, O Jacob, my servant, Israel, whom I have chosen.
- 2 GOD who made you has something to say to you; the God who formed you in the womb wants to help you. Don't be afraid, dear servant Jacob, Jeshurun, the one I chose.
- 2 This is what the LORD says-- he who made you, who formed you in the womb, and who will help you: Do not be afraid, O Jacob, my servant, Jeshurun, whom I have chosen.

- 3 For I will pour water on the thirsty ground and send streams coursing through the parched earth. I will pour my Spirit into your descendants and my blessing on your children.
- 3 For I will pour water on the thirsty land, and streams on the dry ground; I will pour out my Spirit on your offspring, and my blessing on your descendants.
- 4 They shall sprout like grass on the prairie, like willows alongside creeks.
- 4 They will spring up like grass in a meadow, like poplar trees by flowing streams.
- 5 This one will say, 'I am GOD's,' and another will go by the name Jacob; That one will write on his hand 'GOD's property'-- and be proud to be called Israel."
- 5 One will say, 'I belong to the LORD'; another will call himself by the name of Jacob; still another will write on his hand, 'The LORD's,' and will take the name Israel.
- 6 GOD, King of Israel, your Redeemer, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, says: "I'm first, I'm last, and everything in between. I'm the only God there is.
- 6 This is what the LORD says-- Israel's King and Redeemer, the LORD Almighty: I am the first and I am the last; apart from me there is no God.
- 7 Who compares with me? Speak up. See if you measure up. From the beginning, who else has always announced what's coming? So what is coming next? Anybody want to venture a try?
- 7 Who then is like me? Let him proclaim it. Let him declare and lay out before me what has happened since I established my ancient people, and what is yet to come-- yes, let him foretell what will come.
- 8 Don't be afraid, and don't worry: Haven't I always kept you informed, told you what was going on? You're my eyewitnesses: Have you ever come across a God, a real God, other than me? There's no Rock like me that I know of."
- 8 Do not tremble, do not be afraid. Did I not proclaim this and foretell it long ago? You are my witnesses. Is there any God besides me? No, there is no other Rock; I know not one."
- 9 All those who make no-god idols don't amount to a thing, and what they work so hard at making is nothing. Their little puppet-gods see nothing and know nothing--they're total embarrassments!

- 9 All who make idols are nothing, and the things they treasure are worthless. Those who would speak up for them are blind; they are ignorant, to their own shame.
- 10 Who would bother making gods that can't do anything, that can't "god"?
- 10 Who shapes a god and casts an idol, which can profit him nothing?
- 11 Watch all the no-god worshipers hide their faces in shame. Watch the no-god makers slink off humiliated when their idols fail them. Get them out here in the open. Make them face God-reality.
- 11 He and his kind will be put to shame; craftsmen are nothing but men. Let them all come together and take their stand; they will be brought down to terror and infamy.
- 12 The blacksmith makes his no-god, works it over in his forge, hammering it on his anvil--such hard work! He works away, fatigued with hunger and thirst.
- 12 The blacksmith takes a tool and works with it in the coals; he shapes an idol with hammers, he forges it with the might of his arm. He gets hungry and loses his strength; he drinks no water and grows faint.
- 13 The woodworker draws up plans for his no-god, traces it on a block of wood. He shapes it with chisels and planes into human shape--a beautiful woman, a handsome man, ready to be placed in a chapel.
- 13 The carpenter measures with a line and makes an outline with a marker; he roughs it out with chisels and marks it with compasses. He shapes it in the form of man, of man in all his glory, that it may dwell in a shrine.
- 14 He first cuts down a cedar, or maybe picks out a pine or oak, and lets it grow strong in the forest, nourished by the rain.
- 14 He cut down cedars, or perhaps took a cypress or oak. He let it grow among the trees of the forest, or planted a pine, and the rain made it grow.
- 15 Then it can serve a double purpose: Part he uses as firewood for keeping warm and baking bread; from the other part he makes a god that he worships--carves it into a god shape and prays before it.
- 15 It is man's fuel for burning; some of it he takes and warms himself, he kindles a fire and bakes bread. But he also fashions a god and worships it; he makes an idol and bows down to it.
- 16 With half he makes a fire to warm himself and barbecue his supper. He eats his fill and sits back satisfied with his stomach full and his feet

- warmed by the fire: "Ah, this is the life."
- 16 Half of the wood he burns in the fire; over it he prepares his meal, he roasts his meat and eats his fill. He also warms himself and says, "Ah! I am warm; I see the fire."
- 17 And he still has half left for a god, made to his personal design--a handy, convenient no-god to worship whenever so inclined. Whenever the need strikes him he prays to it, "Save me. You're my god."
- 17 From the rest he makes a god, his idol; he bows down to it and worships. He prays to it and says, "Save me; you are my god."
- 18 Pretty stupid, wouldn't you say? Don't they have eyes in their heads? Are their brains working at all?
- 18 They know nothing, they understand nothing; their eyes are plastered over so they cannot see, and their minds closed so they cannot understand.
- 19 Doesn't it occur to them to say, "Half of this tree I used for firewood: I baked bread, roasted meat, and enjoyed a good meal. And now I've used the rest to make an abominable no-god. Here I am praying to a stick of wood!"
- 19 No one stops to think, no one has the knowledge or understanding to say, "Half of it I used for fuel; I even baked bread over its coals, I roasted meat and I ate. Shall I make a detestable thing from what is left? Shall I bow down to a block of wood?"
- 20 This lover of emptiness, of nothing, is so out of touch with reality, so far gone, that he can't even look at what he's doing, can't even look at the no-god stick of wood in his hand and say, "This is crazy."
- 20 He feeds on ashes, a deluded heart misleads him; he cannot save himself, or say, "Is not this thing in my right hand a lie?"
- 21 "Remember these things, O Jacob. Take it seriously, Israel, that you're my servant. I made you, shaped you: You're my servant. O Israel, I'll never forget you.
- 21 Remember these things, O Jacob, for you are my servant, O Israel. I have made you, you are my servant; O Israel, I will not forget you.
- 22 I've wiped the slate of all your wrongdoings. There's nothing left of your sins. Come back to me, come back. I've redeemed you."

- 22 I have swept away your offenses like a cloud, your sins like the morning mist. Return to me, for I have redeemed you."
- 23 High heavens, sing! GOD has done it. Deep earth, shout! And you mountains, sing! A forest choir of oaks and pines and cedars! GOD has redeemed Jacob. GOD's glory is on display in Israel.
- 23 Sing for joy, O heavens, for the LORD has done this; shout aloud, O earth beneath. Burst into song, you mountains, you forests and all your trees, for the LORD has redeemed Jacob, he displays his glory in Israel.
- 24 GOD, your Redeemer, who shaped your life in your mother's womb, says: "I am GOD. I made all that is. With no help from you I spread out the skies and laid out the earth."
- 24 This is what the LORD says-- your Redeemer, who formed you in the womb: I am the LORD, who has made all things, who alone stretched out the heavens, who spread out the earth by myself,
- 25 He makes the magicians look ridiculous and turns fortunetellers into jokes. He makes the experts look trivial and their latest knowledge look silly.
- 25 who foils the signs of false prophets and makes fools of diviners, who overthrows the learning of the wise and turns it into nonsense,
- 26 But he backs the word of his servant and confirms the counsel of his messengers. He says to Jerusalem, "Be inhabited," and to the cities of Judah, "Be rebuilt," and to the ruins, "I raise you up."
- 26 who carries out the words of his servants and fulfills the predictions of his messengers, who says of Jerusalem, 'It shall be inhabited,' of the towns of Judah, 'They shall be built,' and of their ruins, 'I will restore them,'
- 27 He says to Ocean, "Dry up. I'm drying up your rivers."
- 27 who says to the watery deep, 'Be dry, and I will dry up your streams,'
- 28 He says to Cyrus, "My shepherd-- everything I want, you'll do it." He says to Jerusalem, "Be built," and to the Temple, "Be established."
- 28 who says of Cyrus, 'He is my shepherd and will accomplish all that I please; he will say of Jerusalem, "Let it be rebuilt," and of the temple, "Let its foundations be laid." ' "

Isaiah 45

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message to his anointed, to Cyrus, whom he took by the hand To give the task of taming the nations, of terrifying their kings-- He gave him free rein, no restrictions:
- 1 This is what the LORD says to his anointed, to Cyrus, whose right hand I take hold of to subdue nations before him and to strip kings of their armor, to open doors before him so that gates will not be shut:
- 2 "I'll go ahead of you, clearing and paving the road. I'll break down bronze city gates, smash padlocks, kick down barred entrances.
- 2 I will go before you and will level the mountains; I will break down gates of bronze and cut through bars of iron.
- 3 I'll lead you to buried treasures, secret caches of valuables-- Confirmations that it is, in fact, I, GOD, the God of Israel, who calls you by your name.
- 3 I will give you the treasures of darkness, riches stored in secret places, so that you may know that I am the LORD, the God of Israel, who summons you by name.
- 4 It's because of my dear servant Jacob, Israel my chosen, That I've singled you out, called you by name, and given you this privileged work. And you don't even know me!
- 4 For the sake of Jacob my servant, of Israel my chosen, I summon you by name and bestow on you a title of honor, though you do not acknowledge me.
- 5 I am GOD, the only God there is. Besides me there are no real gods. I'm the one who armed you for this work, though you don't even know me,
- 5 I am the LORD, and there is no other; apart from me there is no God. I will strengthen you, though you have not acknowledged me,
- 6 So that everyone, from east to west, will know that I have no god-rivals. I am GOD, the only God there is.
- 6 so that from the rising of the sun to the place of its setting men may know there is none besides me. I am the LORD, and there is no other.
- 7 I form light and create darkness, I make harmonies and create discords. I, GOD, do all these things.
- 7 I form the light and create darkness, I bring prosperity and create disaster; I, the LORD, do all these things.

- 8 "Open up, heavens, and rain. Clouds, pour out buckets of my goodness! Loosen up, earth, and bloom salvation; sprout right living. I, GOD, generate all this.
- 8 You heavens above, rain down righteousness; let the clouds shower it down. Let the earth open wide, let salvation spring up, let righteousness grow with it; I, the LORD, have created it.
- 9 But doom to you who fight your Maker-- you're a pot at odds with the potter! Does clay talk back to the potter: 'What are you doing? What clumsy fingers!'
- 9 Woe to him who quarrels with his Maker, to him who is but a potsherd among the potsherds on the ground. Does the clay say to the potter, 'What are you making?' Does your work say, 'He has no hands'?
- 10 Would a sperm say to a father, 'Who gave you permission to use me to make a baby?' Or a fetus to a mother, 'Why have you cooped me up in this belly?'"
- 10 Woe to him who says to his father, 'What have you begotten?' or to his mother, 'What have you brought to birth?'
- 11 Thus GOD, The Holy of Israel, Israel's Maker, says: "Do you question who or what I'm making? Are you telling me what I can or cannot do?
- 11 This is what the LORD says-- the Holy One of Israel, and its Maker: Concerning things to come, do you question me about my children, or give me orders about the work of my hands?
- 12 I made earth, and I created man and woman to live on it. I handcrafted the skies and direct all the constellations in their turnings.
- 12 It is I who made the earth and created mankind upon it. My own hands stretched out the heavens; I marshaled their starry hosts.
- 13 And now I've got Cyrus on the move. I've rolled out the red carpet before him. He will build my city. He will bring home my exiles. I didn't hire him to do this. I told him. I, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies."
- 13 I will raise up Cyrus in my righteousness: I will make all his ways straight. He will rebuild my city and set my exiles free, but not for a price or reward, says the LORD Almighty."
- 14 GOD says: "The workers of Egypt, the merchants of Ethiopia, and those statuesque Sabeans Will all come over to you--all yours. Docile in chains, they'll follow you, Hands folded in reverence, praying before you: 'Amazing! God is with you! There is no other God--none.'"

- 14 This is what the LORD says: "The products of Egypt and the merchandise of Cush, and those tall Sabeans-- they will come over to you and will be yours; they will trudge behind you, coming over to you in chains. They will bow down before you and plead with you, saying, 'Surely God is with you, and there is no other; there is no other god.' "
- 15 Clearly, you are a God who works behind the scenes, God of Israel, Savior God.
- 15 Truly you are a God who hides himself, O God and Savior of Israel.
- 16 Humiliated, all those others will be ashamed to show their faces in public. Out of work and at loose ends, the makers of no-god idols won't know what to do with themselves.
- 16 All the makers of idols will be put to shame and disgraced; they will go off into disgrace together.
- 17 The people of Israel, though, are saved by you, GOD, saved with an eternal salvation. They won't be ashamed, they won't be at loose ends, ever.
- 17 But Israel will be saved by the LORD with an everlasting salvation; you will never be put to shame or disgraced, to ages everlasting.
- 18 GOD, Creator of the heavens-- he is, remember, God. Maker of earth-- he put it on its foundations, built it from scratch. He didn't go to all that trouble to just leave it empty, nothing in it. He made it to be lived in. This GOD says: "I am GOD, the one and only.
- 18 For this is what the LORD says-- he who created the heavens, he is God; he who fashioned and made the earth, he founded it; he did not create it to be empty, but formed it to be inhabited-- he says: "I am the LORD, and there is no other.
- 19 I don't just talk to myself or mumble under my breath. I never told Jacob, 'Seek me in emptiness, in dark nothingness.' I am GOD. I work out in the open, saying what's right, setting things right.
- 19 I have not spoken in secret, from somewhere in a land of darkness; I have not said to Jacob's descendants, 'Seek me in vain.' I, the LORD, speak the truth; I declare what is right.
- 20 So gather around, come on in, all you refugees and castoffs. They don't seem to know much, do they-- those who carry around their no-god blocks of wood, praying for help to a dead stick?

- 20 Gather together and come; assemble, you fugitives from the nations.
Ignorant are those who carry about idols of wood, who pray to gods that cannot save.
- 21 So tell me what you think. Look at the evidence. Put your heads together. Make your case. Who told you, and a long time ago, what's going on here? Who made sense of things for you? Wasn't I the one? GOD? It had to be me. I'm the only God there is-- The only God who does things right and knows how to help.
- 21 Declare what is to be, present it-- let them take counsel together. Who foretold this long ago, who declared it from the distant past? Was it not I, the LORD? And there is no God apart from me, a righteous God and a Savior; there is none but me.
- 22 So turn to me and be helped--saved!-- everyone, whoever and wherever you are. I am GOD, the only God there is, the one and only.
- 22 Turn to me and be saved, all you ends of the earth; for I am God, and there is no other.
- 23 I promise in my own name: Every word out of my mouth does what it says. I never take back what I say. Everyone is going to end up kneeling before me. Everyone is going to end up saying of me,
- 23 By myself I have sworn, my mouth has uttered in all integrity a word that will not be revoked: Before me every knee will bow; by me every tongue will swear.
- 24 'Yes! Salvation and strength are in GOD!'" All who have raged against him will be brought before him, disgraced by their unbelief.
- 24 They will say of me, 'In the LORD alone are righteousness and strength.' " All who have raged against him will come to him and be put to shame.
- 25 And all who are connected with Israel will have a robust, praising, good life in GOD!
- 25 But in the LORD all the descendants of Israel will be found righteous and will exult.

Isaiah 46

MSG

NIV

- 1 The god Bel falls down, god Nebo slumps. The no-god hunks of wood are loaded on mules And have to be hauled off, wearing out the poor mules--
- 1 Bel bows down, Nebo stoops low; their idols are borne by beasts of burden. The images that are carried about are burdensome, a burden for the weary.
- 2 Dead weight, burdens who can't bear burdens, hauled off to captivity.
- 2 They stoop and bow down together; unable to rescue the burden, they themselves go off into captivity.
- 3 "Listen to me, family of Jacob, everyone that's left of the family of Israel. I've been carrying you on my back from the day you were born,
- 3 Listen to me, O house of Jacob, all you who remain of the house of Israel, you whom I have upheld since you were conceived, and have carried since your birth.
- 4 And I'll keep on carrying you when you're old. I'll be there, bearing you when you're old and gray. I've done it and will keep on doing it, carrying you on my back, saving you.
- 4 Even to your old age and gray hairs I am he, I am he who will sustain you. I have made you and I will carry you; I will sustain you and I will rescue you.
- 5 "So to whom will you compare me, the Incomparable? Can you picture me without reducing me?
- 5 To whom will you compare me or count me equal? To whom will you liken me that we may be compared?
- 6 People with a lot of money hire craftsmen to make them gods. The artisan delivers the god, and they kneel and worship it!
- 6 Some pour out gold from their bags and weigh out silver on the scales; they hire a goldsmith to make it into a god, and they bow down and worship it.
- 7 They carry it around in holy parades, then take it home and put it on a shelf. And there it sits, day in and day out, a dependable god, always right where you put it. Say anything you want to it, it never talks back. Of course, it never does anything either!
- 7 They lift it to their shoulders and carry it; they set it up in its place, and there it stands. From that spot it cannot move. Though one cries out to it, it does not answer; it cannot save him from his troubles.

- 8 "Think about this. Wrap your minds around it. This is serious business, rebels. Take it to heart.
- 8 Remember this, fix it in mind, take it to heart, you rebels.
- 9 Remember your history, your long and rich history. I am GOD, the only God you've had or ever will have-- incomparable, irreplaceable--
- 9 Remember the former things, those of long ago; I am God, and there is no other; I am God, and there is none like me.
- 10 From the very beginning telling you what the ending will be, All along letting you in on what is going to happen, Assuring you, 'I'm in this for the long haul, I'll do exactly what I set out to do,'
- 10 I make known the end from the beginning, from ancient times, what is still to come. I say: My purpose will stand, and I will do all that I please.
- 11 Calling that eagle, Cyrus, out of the east, from a far country the man I chose to help me. I've said it, and I'll most certainly do it. I've planned it, so it's as good as done.
- 11 From the east I summon a bird of prey; from a far-off land, a man to fulfill my purpose. What I have said, that will I bring about; what I have planned, that will I do.
- 12 "Now listen to me: You're a hardheaded bunch and hard to help.
- 12 Listen to me, you stubborn-hearted, you who are far from righteousness.
- 13 I'm ready to help you right now. Deliverance is not a long-range plan. Salvation isn't on hold. I'm putting salvation to work in Zion now, and glory in Israel.
- 13 I am bringing my righteousness near, it is not far away; and my salvation will not be delayed. I will grant salvation to Zion, my splendor to Israel.

Isaiah 47

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Get off your high horse and sit in the dirt, virgin daughter of Babylon. No more throne for you--sit on the ground, daughter of the Chaldeans. Nobody will be calling you 'charming' and 'alluring' anymore. Get used to it.

- 1 Go down, sit in the dust, Virgin Daughter of Babylon; sit on the ground without a throne, Daughter of the Babylonians. No more will you be called tender or delicate.
- 2 Get a job, any old job: Clean gutters, scrub toilets. Hock your gowns and scarves, put on overalls--the party's over.
- 2 Take millstones and grind flour; take off your veil. Lift up your skirts, bare your legs, and wade through the streams.
- 3 Your nude body will be on public display, exposed to vulgar taunts. It's vengeance time, and I'm taking vengeance. No one gets let off the hook."
- 3 Your nakedness will be exposed and your shame uncovered. I will take vengeance; I will spare no one."
- 4 Our Redeemer speaks, named GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, The Holy of Israel:
- 4 Our Redeemer--the LORD Almighty is his name-- is the Holy One of Israel.
- 5 "Shut up and get out of the way, daughter of Chaldeans. You'll no longer be called 'First Lady of the Kingdoms.'
- 5 Sit in silence, go into darkness, Daughter of the Babylonians; no more will you be called queen of kingdoms.
- 6 I was fed up with my people, thoroughly disgusted with my progeny. I turned them over to you, but you had no compassion. You put old men and women to cruel, hard labor.
- 6 I was angry with my people and desecrated my inheritance; I gave them into your hand, and you showed them no mercy. Even on the aged you laid a very heavy yoke.
- 7 You said, 'I'm the First Lady. I'll always be the pampered darling.' You took nothing seriously, took nothing to heart, never gave tomorrow a thought.
- 7 You said, 'I will continue forever-- the eternal queen!' But you did not consider these things or reflect on what might happen.
- 8 Well, start thinking, playgirl. You're acting like the center of the universe, Smugly saying to yourself, 'I'm Number One. There's nobody but me. I'll never be a widow, I'll never lose my children.'
- 8 Now then, listen, you wanton creature, lounging in your security and saying to yourself, 'I am, and there is none besides me. I will never be a widow or suffer the loss of children.'

- 9 Those two things are going to hit you both at once, suddenly, on the same day: Spouse and children gone, a total loss, despite your many enchantments and charms.
- 9 Both of these will overtake you in a moment, on a single day: loss of children and widowhood. They will come upon you in full measure, in spite of your many sorceries and all your potent spells.
- 10 You were so confident and comfortable in your evil life, saying, 'No one sees me.' You thought you knew so much, had everything figured out. What delusion! Smugly telling yourself, 'I'm Number One. There's nobody but me.'
- 10 You have trusted in your wickedness and have said, 'No one sees me.' Your wisdom and knowledge mislead you when you say to yourself, 'I am, and there is none besides me.'
- 11 Ruin descends-- you can't charm it away. Disaster strikes-- you can't cast it off with spells. Catastrophe, sudden and total-- and you're totally at sea, totally bewildered!
- 11 Disaster will come upon you, and you will not know how to conjure it away. A calamity will fall upon you that you cannot ward off with a ransom; a catastrophe you cannot foresee will suddenly come upon you.
- 12 But don't give up. From your great repertoire of enchantments there must be one you haven't yet tried. You've been at this a long time. Surely something will work.
- 12 Keep on, then, with your magic spells and with your many sorceries, which you have labored at since childhood. Perhaps you will succeed, perhaps you will cause terror.
- 13 I know you're exhausted trying out remedies, but don't give up. Call in the astrologers and stargazers. They're good at this. Surely they can work up something!
- 13 All the counsel you have received has only worn you out! Let your astrologers come forward, those stargazers who make predictions month by month, let them save you from what is coming upon you.
- 14 "Fat chance. You'd be grasping at straws that are already in the fire, A fire that is even now raging. Your 'experts' are in it and won't get out. It's not a fire for cooking venison stew, not a fire to warm you on a winter night!

- 14 Surely they are like stubble; the fire will burn them up. They cannot even save themselves from the power of the flame. Here are no coals to warm anyone; here is no fire to sit by.
- 15 That's the fate of your friends in sorcery, your magician buddies you've been in cahoots with all your life. They reel, confused, bumping into one another. None of them bother to help you.
- 15 That is all they can do for you-- these you have labored with and trafficked with since childhood. Each of them goes on in his error; there is not one that can save you.

Isaiah 48

MSG

NIV

- 1 "And now listen to this, family of Jacob, you who are called by the name Israel: Who got you started in the loins of Judah, you who use GOD's name to back up your promises and pray to the God of Israel? But do you mean it? Do you live like it?
- 1 Listen to this, O house of Jacob, you who are called by the name of Israel and come from the line of Judah, you who take oaths in the name of the LORD and invoke the God of Israel-- but not in truth or righteousness--
- 2 You claim to be citizens of the Holy City; you act as though you lean on the God of Israel, named GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 2 you who call yourselves citizens of the holy city and rely on the God of Israel-- the LORD Almighty is his name:
- 3 For a long time now, I've let you in on the way I work: I told you what I was going to do beforehand, then I did it and it was done, and that's that.
- 3 I foretold the former things long ago, my mouth announced them and I made them known; then suddenly I acted, and they came to pass.
- 4 I know you're a bunch of hardheads, obstinate and flint-faced,
- 4 For I knew how stubborn you were; the sinews of your neck were iron, your forehead was bronze.
- 5 So I got a running start and began telling you what was going on before it even happened. That is why you can't say, 'My god-idol did this.' 'My favorite god-carving commanded this.'

- 5 Therefore I told you these things long ago; before they happened I announced them to you so that you could not say, 'My idols did them; my wooden image and metal god ordained them.'
- 6 You have all this evidence confirmed by your own eyes and ears. Shouldn't you be talking about it? And that was just the beginning. I have a lot more to tell you, things you never knew existed.
- 6 You have heard these things; look at them all. Will you not admit them? "From now on I will tell you of new things, of hidden things unknown to you.
- 7 This isn't a variation on the same old thing. This is new, brand-new, something you'd never guess or dream up. When you hear this you won't be able to say, 'I knew that all along.'
- 7 They are created now, and not long ago; you have not heard of them before today. So you cannot say, 'Yes, I knew of them.'
- 8 You've never been good listeners to me. You have a history of ignoring me, A sorry track record of fickle attachments-- rebels from the womb.
- 8 You have neither heard nor understood; from of old your ear has not been open. Well do I know how treacherous you are; you were called a rebel from birth.
- 9 But out of the sheer goodness of my heart, because of who I am, I keep a tight rein on my anger and hold my temper. I don't wash my hands of you.
- 9 For my own name's sake I delay my wrath; for the sake of my praise I hold it back from you, so as not to cut you off.
- 10 Do you see what I've done? I've refined you, but not without fire. I've tested you like silver in the furnace of affliction.
- 10 See, I have refined you, though not as silver; I have tested you in the furnace of affliction.
- 11 Out of myself, simply because of who I am, I do what I do. I have my reputation to keep up. I'm not playing second fiddle to either gods or people.
- 11 For my own sake, for my own sake, I do this. How can I let myself be defamed? I will not yield my glory to another.
- 12 "Listen, Jacob. Listen, Israel-- I'm the One who named you! I'm the One. I got things started and, yes, I'll wrap them up.

- 12 Listen to me, O Jacob, Israel, whom I have called: I am he; I am the first and I am the last.
- 13 Earth is my work, handmade. And the skies--I made them too, horizon to horizon. When I speak, they're on their feet, at attention.
- 13 My own hand laid the foundations of the earth, and my right hand spread out the heavens; when I summon them, they all stand up together.
- 14 "Come everybody, gather around, listen: Who among the gods has delivered the news? I, GOD, love this man Cyrus, and I'm using him to do what I want with Babylon.
- 14 Come together, all of you, and listen: Which of the idols has foretold these things? The LORD's chosen ally will carry out his purpose against Babylon; his arm will be against the Babylonians.
- 15 I, yes I, have spoken. I've called him. I've brought him here. He'll be successful.
- 15 I, even I, have spoken; yes, I have called him. I will bring him, and he will succeed in his mission.
- 16 Come close, listen carefully: I've never kept secrets from you. I've always been present with you." And now, the Master, GOD, sends me and his Spirit
- 16 Come near me and listen to this: From the first announcement I have not spoken in secret; at the time it happens, I am there." And now the Sovereign LORD has sent me, with his Spirit.
- 17 with this Message from GOD, your Redeemer, The Holy of Israel: "I am GOD, your God, who teaches you how to live right and well. I show you what to do, where to go.
- 17 This is what the LORD says-- your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel: "I am the LORD your God, who teaches you what is best for you, who directs you in the way you should go.
- 18 If you had listened all along to what I told you, your life would have flowed full like a river, blessings rolling in like waves from the sea.
- 18 If only you had paid attention to my commands, your peace would have been like a river, your righteousness like the waves of the sea.
- 19 Children and grandchildren are like sand, your progeny like grains of sand. There would be no end of them, no danger of losing touch with me."

- 19 Your descendants would have been like the sand, your children like its numberless grains; their name would never be cut off nor destroyed from before me."
- 20 Get out of Babylon! Run from the Babylonians! Shout the news. Broadcast it. Let the world know, the whole world. Tell them, "GOD redeemed his dear servant Jacob!"
- 20 Leave Babylon, flee from the Babylonians! Announce this with shouts of joy and proclaim it. Send it out to the ends of the earth; say, "The LORD has redeemed his servant Jacob."
- 21 They weren't thirsty when he led them through the deserts. He made water pour out of the rock; he split the rock and the water gushed.
- 21 They did not thirst when he led them through the deserts; he made water flow for them from the rock; he split the rock and water gushed out.
- 22 "There is no peace," says GOD, "for the wicked."
- 22 There is no peace, says the LORD, "for the wicked."

Isaiah 49

MSG

NIV

- 1 Listen, far-flung islands, pay attention, faraway people: GOD put me to work from the day I was born. The moment I entered the world he named me.
- 1 Listen to me, you islands; hear this, you distant nations: Before I was born the LORD called me; from my birth he has made mention of my name.
- 2 He gave me speech that would cut and penetrate. He kept his hand on me to protect me. He made me his straight arrow and hid me in his quiver.
- 2 He made my mouth like a sharpened sword, in the shadow of his hand he hid me; he made me into a polished arrow and concealed me in his quiver.
- 3 He said to me, "You're my dear servant, Israel, through whom I'll shine."
- 3 He said to me, "You are my servant, Israel, in whom I will display my splendor."
- 4 But I said, "I've worked for nothing. I've nothing to show for a life of hard work. Nevertheless, I'll let GOD have the last word. I'll let him

pronounce his verdict."

- 4 But I said, "I have labored to no purpose; I have spent my strength in vain and for nothing. Yet what is due me is in the LORD's hand, and my reward is with my God."
- 5 "And now," GOD says, this God who took me in hand from the moment of birth to be his servant, To bring Jacob back home to him, to set a reunion for Israel-- What an honor for me in GOD's eyes! That God should be my strength!
- 5 And now the LORD says-- he who formed me in the womb to be his servant to bring Jacob back to him and gather Israel to himself, for I am honored in the eyes of the LORD and my God has been my strength--
- 6 He says, "But that's not a big enough job for my servant-- just to recover the tribes of Jacob, merely to round up the strays of Israel. I'm setting you up as a light for the nations so that my salvation becomes global!"
- 6 he says: "It is too small a thing for you to be my servant to restore the tribes of Jacob and bring back those of Israel I have kept. I will also make you a light for the Gentiles, that you may bring my salvation to the ends of the earth."
- 7 GOD, Redeemer of Israel, The Holy of Israel, says to the despised one, kicked around by the nations, slave labor to the ruling class: "Kings will see, get to their feet--the princes, too-- and then fall on their faces in homage Because of GOD, who has faithfully kept his word, The Holy of Israel, who has chosen you."
- 7 This is what the LORD says-- the Redeemer and Holy One of Israel-- to him who was despised and abhorred by the nation, to the servant of rulers: "Kings will see you and rise up, princes will see and bow down, because of the LORD, who is faithful, the Holy One of Israel, who has chosen you."
- 8 GOD also says: "When the time's ripe, I answer you. When victory's due, I help you. I form you and use you to reconnect the people with me, To put the land in order, to resettle families on the ruined properties.
- 8 This is what the LORD says: "In the time of my favor I will answer you, and in the day of salvation I will help you; I will keep you and will make you to be a covenant for the people, to restore the land and to reassign its desolate inheritances,

- 9 I tell prisoners, 'Come on out. You're free!' and those huddled in fear, 'It's all right. It's safe now.' There'll be foodstands along all the roads, picnics on all the hills--
- 9 to say to the captives, 'Come out,' and to those in darkness, 'Be free!' "They will feed beside the roads and find pasture on every barren hill.
- 10 Nobody hungry, nobody thirsty, shade from the sun, shelter from the wind, For the Compassionate One guides them, takes them to the best springs.
- 10 They will neither hunger nor thirst, nor will the desert heat or the sun beat upon them. He who has compassion on them will guide them and lead them beside springs of water.
- 11 I'll make all my mountains into roads, turn them into a superhighway.
- 11 I will turn all my mountains into roads, and my highways will be raised up.
- 12 Look: These coming from far countries, and those, out of the north, These streaming in from the west, and those from all the way down the Nile!"
- 12 See, they will come from afar-- some from the north, some from the west, some from the region of Aswan. "
- 13 Heavens, raise the roof! Earth, wake the dead! Mountains, send up cheers! GOD has comforted his people. He has tenderly nursed his beaten-up, beaten-down people.
- 13 Shout for joy, O heavens; rejoice, O earth; burst into song, O mountains! For the LORD comforts his people and will have compassion on his afflicted ones.
- 14 But Zion said, "I don't get it. GOD has left me. My Master has forgotten I even exist."
- 14 But Zion said, "The LORD has forsaken me, the Lord has forgotten me."
- 15 "Can a mother forget the infant at her breast, walk away from the baby she bore? But even if mothers forget, I'd never forget you--never.
- 15 Can a mother forget the baby at her breast and have no compassion on the child she has borne? Though she may forget, I will not forget you!
- 16 Look, I've written your names on the backs of my hands. The walls you're rebuilding are never out of my sight.

- 16 See, I have engraved you on the palms of my hands; your walls are ever before me.
- 17 Your builders are faster than your wreckers. The demolition crews are gone for good.
- 17 Your sons hasten back, and those who laid you waste depart from you.
- 18 Look up, look around, look well! See them all gathering, coming to you? As sure as I am the living God"--GOD's Decree-- "you're going to put them on like so much jewelry, you're going to use them to dress up like a bride.
- 18 Lift up your eyes and look around; all your sons gather and come to you. As surely as I live," declares the LORD, "you will wear them all as ornaments; you will put them on, like a bride.
- 19 "And your ruined land? Your devastated, decimated land? Filled with more people than you know what to do with! And your barbarian enemies, a fading memory.
- 19 Though you were ruined and made desolate and your land laid waste, now you will be too small for your people, and those who devoured you will be far away.
- 20 The children born in your exile will be saying, 'It's getting too crowded here. I need more room.'
- 20 The children born during your bereavement will yet say in your hearing, 'This place is too small for us; give us more space to live in.'
- 21 And you'll say to yourself, 'Where on earth did these children come from? I lost everything, had nothing, was exiled and penniless. So who reared these children? How did these children get here?'"
- 21 Then you will say in your heart, 'Who bore me these? I was bereaved and barren; I was exiled and rejected. Who brought these up? I was left all alone, but these--where have they come from?' "
- 22 The Master, GOD, says: "Look! I signal to the nations, I raise my flag to summon the people. Here they'll come: women carrying your little boys in their arms, men carrying your little girls on their shoulders.
- 22 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: "See, I will beckon to the Gentiles, I will lift up my banner to the peoples; they will bring your sons in their arms and carry your daughters on their shoulders.
- 23 Kings will be your babysitters, princesses will be your nursemaids. They'll offer to do all your drudge work-- scrub your floors, do your

laundry. You'll know then that I am GOD. No one who hopes in me ever regrets it."

23 Kings will be your foster fathers, and their queens your nursing mothers. They will bow down before you with their faces to the ground; they will lick the dust at your feet. Then you will know that I am the LORD; those who hope in me will not be disappointed."

24 Can plunder be retrieved from a giant, prisoners of war gotten back from a tyrant?

24 Can plunder be taken from warriors, or captives rescued from the fierce?

25 But GOD says, "Even if a giant grips the plunder and a tyrant holds my people prisoner, I'm the one who's on your side, defending your cause, rescuing your children.

25 But this is what the LORD says: "Yes, captives will be taken from warriors, and plunder retrieved from the fierce; I will contend with those who contend with you, and your children I will save.

26 And your enemies, crazed and desperate, will turn on themselves, killing each other in a frenzy of self-destruction. Then everyone will know that I, GOD, have saved you--I, the Mighty One of Jacob."

26 I will make your oppressors eat their own flesh; they will be drunk on their own blood, as with wine. Then all mankind will know that I, the LORD, am your Savior, your Redeemer, the Mighty One of Jacob."

Isaiah 50

MSG

NIV

1 GOD says: "Can you produce your mother's divorce papers proving I got rid of her? Can you produce a receipt proving I sold you? Of course you can't. It's your sins that put you here, your wrongs that got you shipped out.

1 This is what the LORD says: "Where is your mother's certificate of divorce with which I sent her away? Or to which of my creditors did I sell you? Because of your sins you were sold; because of your transgressions your mother was sent away.

- 2 So why didn't anyone come when I knocked? Why didn't anyone answer when I called? Do you think I've forgotten how to help? Am I so decrepit that I can't deliver? I'm as powerful as ever, and can reverse what I once did: I can dry up the sea with a word, turn river water into desert sand, And leave the fish stinking in the sun, stranded on dry land . . .
- 2 When I came, why was there no one? When I called, why was there no one to answer? Was my arm too short to ransom you? Do I lack the strength to rescue you? By a mere rebuke I dry up the sea, I turn rivers into a desert; their fish rot for lack of water and die of thirst.
- 3 Turn all the lights out in the sky and pull down the curtain."
- 3 I clothe the sky with darkness and make sackcloth its covering."
- 4 The Master, GOD, has given me a well-taught tongue, So I know how to encourage tired people. He wakes me up in the morning, Wakes me up, opens my ears to listen as one ready to take orders.
- 4 The Sovereign LORD has given me an instructed tongue, to know the word that sustains the weary. He wakens me morning by morning, wakens my ear to listen like one being taught.
- 5 The Master, GOD, opened my ears, and I didn't go back to sleep, didn't pull the covers back over my head.
- 5 The Sovereign LORD has opened my ears, and I have not been rebellious; I have not drawn back.
- 6 I followed orders, stood there and took it while they beat me, held steady while they pulled out my beard, Didn't dodge their insults, faced them as they spit in my face.
- 6 I offered my back to those who beat me, my cheeks to those who pulled out my beard; I did not hide my face from mocking and spitting.
- 7 And the Master, GOD, stays right there and helps me, so I'm not disgraced. Therefore I set my face like flint, confident that I'll never regret this.
- 7 Because the Sovereign LORD helps me, I will not be disgraced. Therefore have I set my face like flint, and I know I will not be put to shame.
- 8 My champion is right here. Let's take our stand together! Who dares bring suit against me? Let him try!
- 8 He who vindicates me is near. Who then will bring charges against me? Let us face each other! Who is my accuser? Let him confront me!

- 9 Look! the Master, GOD, is right here. Who would dare call me guilty? Look! My accusers are a clothes bin of threadbare socks and shirts, fodder for moths!
- 9 It is the Sovereign LORD who helps me. Who is he that will condemn me? They will all wear out like a garment; the moths will eat them up.
- 10 Who out there fears GOD, actually listens to the voice of his servant? For anyone out there who doesn't know where you're going, anyone groping in the dark, Here's what: Trust in GOD. Lean on your God!
- 10 Who among you fears the LORD and obeys the word of his servant? Let him who walks in the dark, who has no light, trust in the name of the LORD and rely on his God.
- 11 But if all you're after is making trouble, playing with fire, Go ahead and see where it gets you. Set your fires, stir people up, blow on the flames, But don't expect me to just stand there and watch. I'll hold your feet to those flames.
- 11 But now, all you who light fires and provide yourselves with flaming torches, go, walk in the light of your fires and of the torches you have set ablaze. This is what you shall receive from my hand: You will lie down in torment.

Isaiah 51

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Listen to me, all you who are serious about right living and committed to seeking GOD. Ponder the rock from which you were cut, the quarry from which you were dug.
- 1 Listen to me, you who pursue righteousness and who seek the LORD: Look to the rock from which you were cut and to the quarry from which you were hewn;
- 2 Yes, ponder Abraham, your father, and Sarah, who bore you. Think of it! One solitary man when I called him, but once I blessed him, he multiplied.
- 2 look to Abraham, your father, and to Sarah, who gave you birth. When I called him he was but one, and I blessed him and made him many.

- 3 Likewise I, GOD, will comfort Zion, comfort all her mounds of ruins. I'll transform her dead ground into Eden, her moonscape into the garden of GOD, A place filled with exuberance and laughter, thankful voices and melodic songs.
- 3 The LORD will surely comfort Zion and will look with compassion on all her ruins; he will make her deserts like Eden, her wastelands like the garden of the LORD. Joy and gladness will be found in her, thanksgiving and the sound of singing.
- 4 "Pay attention, my people. Listen to me, nations. Revelation flows from me. My decisions light up the world.
- 4 Listen to me, my people; hear me, my nation: The law will go out from me; my justice will become a light to the nations.
- 5 My deliverance arrives on the run, my salvation right on time. I'll bring justice to the peoples. Even faraway islands will look to me and take hope in my saving power.
- 5 My righteousness draws near speedily, my salvation is on the way, and my arm will bring justice to the nations. The islands will look to me and wait in hope for my arm.
- 6 Look up at the skies, ponder the earth under your feet. The skies will fade out like smoke, the earth will wear out like work pants, and the people will die off like flies. But my salvation will last forever, my setting-things-right will never be obsolete.
- 6 Lift up your eyes to the heavens, look at the earth beneath; the heavens will vanish like smoke, the earth will wear out like a garment and its inhabitants die like flies. But my salvation will last forever, my righteousness will never fail.
- 7 "Listen now, you who know right from wrong, you who hold my teaching inside you: Pay no attention to insults, and when mocked don't let it get you down.
- 7 Hear me, you who know what is right, you people who have my law in your hearts: Do not fear the reproach of men or be terrified by their insults.
- 8 Those insults and mockeries are moth-eaten, from brains that are termite-ridden, But my setting-things-right lasts, my salvation goes on and on and on."

- 8 For the moth will eat them up like a garment; the worm will devour them like wool. But my righteousness will last forever, my salvation through all generations."
- 9 Wake up, wake up, flex your muscles, GOD! Wake up as in the old days, in the long ago. Didn't you once make mincemeat of Rahab, dispatch the old chaos-dragon?
- 9 Awake, awake! Clothe yourself with strength, O arm of the LORD; awake, as in days gone by, as in generations of old. Was it not you who cut Rahab to pieces, who pierced that monster through?
- 10 And didn't you once dry up the sea, the powerful waters of the deep, And then made the bottom of the ocean a road for the redeemed to walk across?
- 10 Was it not you who dried up the sea, the waters of the great deep, who made a road in the depths of the sea so that the redeemed might cross over?
- 11 In the same way GOD's ransomed will come back, come back to Zion cheering, shouting, Joy eternal wreathing their heads, exuberant ecstasies transporting them-- and not a sign of moans or groans.
- 11 The ransomed of the LORD will return. They will enter Zion with singing; everlasting joy will crown their heads. Gladness and joy will overtake them, and sorrow and sighing will flee away.
- 12 "I, I'm the One comforting you. What are you afraid of--or who? Some man or woman who'll soon be dead? Some poor wretch destined for dust?
- 12 I, even I, am he who comforts you. Who are you that you fear mortal men, the sons of men, who are but grass,
- 13 You've forgotten me, GOD, who made you, who unfurled the skies, who founded the earth. And here you are, quaking like an aspen before the tantrums of a tyrant who thinks he can kick down the world. But what will come of the tantrums?
- 13 that you forget the LORD your Maker, who stretched out the heavens and laid the foundations of the earth, that you live in constant terror every day because of the wrath of the oppressor, who is bent on destruction? For where is the wrath of the oppressor?
- 14 The victims will be released before you know it. They're not going to die. They're not even going to go hungry.

- 14 The cowering prisoners will soon be set free; they will not die in their dungeon, nor will they lack bread.
- 15 For I am GOD, your very own God, who stirs up the sea and whips up the waves, named GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 15 For I am the LORD your God, who churns up the sea so that its waves roar-- the LORD Almighty is his name.
- 16 I teach you how to talk, word by word, and personally watch over you, Even while I'm unfurling the skies, setting earth on solid foundations, and greeting Zion: 'Welcome, my people!'"
- 16 I have put my words in your mouth and covered you with the shadow of my hand-- I who set the heavens in place, who laid the foundations of the earth, and who say to Zion, 'You are my people.' "
- 17 So wake up! Rub the sleep from your eyes! Up on your feet, Jerusalem! You've drunk the cup GOD handed you, the strong drink of his anger. You drank it down to the last drop, staggered and collapsed, dead-drunk.
- 17 Awake, awake! Rise up, O Jerusalem, you who have drunk from the hand of the LORD the cup of his wrath, you who have drained to its dregs the goblet that makes men stagger.
- 18 And nobody to help you home, no one among your friends or children to take you by the hand and put you in bed.
- 18 Of all the sons she bore there was none to guide her; of all the sons she reared there was none to take her by the hand.
- 19 You've been hit with a double dose of trouble --does anyone care? Assault and battery, hunger and death --will anyone comfort?
- 19 These double calamities have come upon you-- who can comfort you?-- ruin and destruction, famine and sword-- who can console you?
- 20 Your sons and daughters have passed out, strewn in the streets like stunned rabbits, Sleeping off the strong drink of GOD's anger, the rage of your God.
- 20 Your sons have fainted; they lie at the head of every street, like antelope caught in a net. They are filled with the wrath of the LORD and the rebuke of your God.
- 21 Therefore listen, please, you with your splitting headaches, You who are nursing the hangovers that didn't come from drinking wine.
- 21 Therefore hear this, you afflicted one, made drunk, but not with wine.

- 22 Your Master, your GOD, has something to say, your God has taken up his people's case: "Look, I've taken back the drink that sent you reeling. No more drinking from that jug of my anger!"
- 22 This is what your Sovereign LORD says, your God, who defends his people: "See, I have taken out of your hand the cup that made you stagger; from that cup, the goblet of my wrath, you will never drink again.
- 23 I've passed it over to your abusers to drink, those who ordered you, 'Down on the ground so we can walk all over you!' And you had to do it. Flat on the ground, you were the dirt under their feet."
- 23 I will put it into the hands of your tormentors, who said to you, 'Fall prostrate that we may walk over you.' And you made your back like the ground, like a street to be walked over."

Isaiah 52

MSG

NIV

- 1 Wake up, wake up! Pull on your boots, Zion! Dress up in your Sunday best, Jerusalem, holy city! Those who want no part of God have been culled out. They won't be coming along.
- 1 Awake, awake, O Zion, clothe yourself with strength. Put on your garments of splendor, O Jerusalem, the holy city. The uncircumcised and defiled will not enter you again.
- 2 Brush off the dust and get to your feet, captive Jerusalem! Throw off your chains, captive daughter of Zion!
- 2 Shake off your dust; rise up, sit enthroned, O Jerusalem. Free yourself from the chains on your neck, O captive Daughter of Zion.
- 3 GOD says, "You were sold for nothing. You're being bought back for nothing."
- 3 For this is what the LORD says: "You were sold for nothing, and without money you will be redeemed."
- 4 Again, the Master, GOD, says, "Early on, my people went to Egypt and lived, strangers in the land. At the other end, Assyria oppressed them.
- 4 For this is what the Sovereign LORD says: "At first my people went down to Egypt to live; lately, Assyria has oppressed them.

- 5 And now, what have I here?" GOD's Decree. "My people are hauled off again for no reason at all. Tyrants on the warpath, whooping it up, and day after day, incessantly, my reputation blackened.
- 5 And now what do I have here? declares the LORD. "For my people have been taken away for nothing, and those who rule them mock, " declares the LORD. "And all day long my name is constantly blasphemed.
- 6 Now it's time that my people know who I am, what I'm made of--yes, that I have something to say. Here I am!"
- 6 Therefore my people will know my name; therefore in that day they will know that it is I who foretold it. Yes, it is I."
- 7 How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of the messenger bringing good news, Breaking the news that all's well, proclaiming good times, announcing salvation, telling Zion, "Your God reigns!"
- 7 How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of those who bring good news, who proclaim peace, who bring good tidings, who proclaim salvation, who say to Zion, "Your God reigns!"
- 8 Voices! Listen! Your scouts are shouting, thunderclap shouts, shouting in joyful unison. They see with their own eyes GOD coming back to Zion.
- 8 Listen! Your watchmen lift up their voices; together they shout for joy. When the LORD returns to Zion, they will see it with their own eyes.
- 9 Break into song! Boom it out, ruins of Jerusalem: "GOD has comforted his people! He's redeemed Jerusalem!"
- 9 Burst into songs of joy together, you ruins of Jerusalem, for the LORD has comforted his people, he has redeemed Jerusalem.
- 10 GOD has rolled up his sleeves. All the nations can see his holy, muscled arm. Everyone, from one end of the earth to the other, sees him at work, doing his salvation work.
- 10 The LORD will lay bare his holy arm in the sight of all the nations, and all the ends of the earth will see the salvation of our God.
- 11 Out of here! Out of here! Leave this place! Don't look back. Don't contaminate yourselves with plunder. Just leave, but leave clean. Purify yourselves in the process of worship, carrying the holy vessels of GOD.
- 11 Depart, depart, go out from there! Touch no unclean thing! Come out from it and be pure, you who carry the vessels of the LORD.
- 12 But you don't have to be in a hurry. You're not running from anybody! GOD is leading you out of here, and the God of Israel is also your rear

guard.

12 But you will not leave in haste or go in flight; for the LORD will go before you, the God of Israel will be your rear guard.

13 "Just watch my servant blossom! Exalted, tall, head and shoulders above the crowd!

13 See, my servant will act wisely; he will be raised and lifted up and highly exalted.

14 But he didn't begin that way. At first everyone was appalled. He didn't even look human-- a ruined face, disfigured past recognition.

14 Just as there were many who were appalled at him-- his appearance was so disfigured beyond that of any man and his form marred beyond human likeness--

15 Nations all over the world will be in awe, taken aback, kings shocked into silence when they see him. For what was unheard of they'll see with their own eyes, what was unthinkable they'll have right before them."

15 so will he sprinkle many nations, and kings will shut their mouths because of him. For what they were not told, they will see, and what they have not heard, they will understand.

Isaiah 53

MSG

NIV

1 Who believes what we've heard and seen? Who would have thought GOD's saving power would look like this?

1 Who has believed our message and to whom has the arm of the LORD been revealed?

2 The servant grew up before God--a scrawny seedling, a scrubby plant in a parched field. There was nothing attractive about him, nothing to cause us to take a second look.

2 He grew up before him like a tender shoot, and like a root out of dry ground. He had no beauty or majesty to attract us to him, nothing in his appearance that we should desire him.

3 He was looked down on and passed over, a man who suffered, who knew pain firsthand. One look at him and people turned away. We looked down on him, thought he was scum.

- 3 He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, and familiar with suffering. Like one from whom men hide their faces he was despised, and we esteemed him not.
- 4 But the fact is, it was our pains he carried-- our disfigurements, all the things wrong with us. We thought he brought it on himself, that God was punishing him for his own failures.
- 4 Surely he took up our infirmities and carried our sorrows, yet we considered him stricken by God, smitten by him, and afflicted.
- 5 But it was our sins that did that to him, that ripped and tore and crushed him--our sins! He took the punishment, and that made us whole. Through his bruises we get healed.
- 5 But he was pierced for our transgressions, he was crushed for our iniquities; the punishment that brought us peace was upon him, and by his wounds we are healed.
- 6 We're all like sheep who've wandered off and gotten lost. We've all done our own thing, gone our own way. And GOD has piled all our sins, everything we've done wrong, on him, on him.
- 6 We all, like sheep, have gone astray, each of us has turned to his own way; and the LORD has laid on him the iniquity of us all.
- 7 He was beaten, he was tortured, but he didn't say a word. Like a lamb taken to be slaughtered and like a sheep being sheared, he took it all in silence.
- 7 He was oppressed and afflicted, yet he did not open his mouth; he was led like a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is silent, so he did not open his mouth.
- 8 Justice miscarried, and he was led off-- and did anyone really know what was happening? He died without a thought for his own welfare, beaten bloody for the sins of my people.
- 8 By oppression and judgment he was taken away. And who can speak of his descendants? For he was cut off from the land of the living; for the transgression of my people he was stricken.
- 9 They buried him with the wicked, threw him in a grave with a rich man, Even though he'd never hurt a soul or said one word that wasn't true.
- 9 He was assigned a grave with the wicked, and with the rich in his death, though he had done no violence, nor was any deceit in his mouth.

- 10 Still, it's what GOD had in mind all along, to crush him with pain. The plan was that he give himself as an offering for sin so that he'd see life come from it--life, life, and more life. And GOD's plan will deeply prosper through him.
- 10 Yet it was the LORD's will to crush him and cause him to suffer, and though the LORD makes his life a guilt offering, he will see his offspring and prolong his days, and the will of the LORD will prosper in his hand.
- 11 Out of that terrible travail of soul, he'll see that it's worth it and be glad he did it. Through what he experienced, my righteous one, my servant, will make many "righteous ones," as he himself carries the burden of their sins.
- 11 After the suffering of his soul, he will see the light of life and be satisfied; by his knowledge my righteous servant will justify many, and he will bear their iniquities.
- 12 Therefore I'll reward him extravagantly-- the best of everything, the highest honors-- Because he looked death in the face and didn't flinch, because he embraced the company of the lowest. He took on his own shoulders the sin of the many, he took up the cause of all the black sheep.
- 12 Therefore I will give him a portion among the great, and he will divide the spoils with the strong, because he poured out his life unto death, and was numbered with the transgressors. For he bore the sin of many, and made intercession for the transgressors.

Isaiah 54

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Sing, barren woman, who has never had a baby. Fill the air with song, you who've never experienced childbirth! You're ending up with far more children than all those childbearing women." GOD says so!
- 1 Sing, O barren woman, you who never bore a child; burst into song, shout for joy, you who were never in labor; because more are the children of the desolate woman than of her who has a husband, says the LORD.

- 2 "Clear lots of ground for your tents! Make your tents large. Spread out! Think big! Use plenty of rope, drive the tent pegs deep.
- 2 Enlarge the place of your tent, stretch your tent curtains wide, do not hold back; lengthen your cords, strengthen your stakes.
- 3 You're going to need lots of elbow room for your growing family. You're going to take over whole nations; you're going to resettle abandoned cities.
- 3 For you will spread out to the right and to the left; your descendants will dispossess nations and settle in their desolate cities.
- 4 Don't be afraid--you're not going to be embarrassed. Don't hold back--you're not going to come up short. You'll forget all about the humiliations of your youth, and the indignities of being a widow will fade from memory.
- 4 Do not be afraid; you will not suffer shame. Do not fear disgrace; you will not be humiliated. You will forget the shame of your youth and remember no more the reproach of your widowhood.
- 5 For your Maker is your bridegroom, his name, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies! Your Redeemer is The Holy of Israel, known as God of the whole earth.
- 5 For your Maker is your husband-- the LORD Almighty is his name-- the Holy One of Israel is your Redeemer; he is called the God of all the earth.
- 6 You were like an abandoned wife, devastated with grief, and GOD welcomed you back, Like a woman married young and then left," says your God.
- 6 The LORD will call you back as if you were a wife deserted and distressed in spirit-- a wife who married young, only to be rejected," says your God.
- 7 Your Redeemer GOD says: "I left you, but only for a moment. Now, with enormous compassion, I'm bringing you back.
- 7 For a brief moment I abandoned you, but with deep compassion I will bring you back.
- 8 In an outburst of anger I turned my back on you-- but only for a moment. It's with lasting love that I'm tenderly caring for you.
- 8 In a surge of anger I hid my face from you for a moment, but with everlasting kindness I will have compassion on you," says the LORD

your Redeemer.

- 9 "This exile is just like the days of Noah for me: I promised then that the waters of Noah would never again flood the earth. I'm promising now no more anger, no more dressing you down.
- 9 To me this is like the days of Noah, when I swore that the waters of Noah would never again cover the earth. So now I have sworn not to be angry with you, never to rebuke you again.
- 10 For even if the mountains walk away and the hills fall to pieces, My love won't walk away from you, my covenant commitment of peace won't fall apart." The GOD who has compassion on you says so.
- 10 Though the mountains be shaken and the hills be removed, yet my unfailing love for you will not be shaken nor my covenant of peace be removed," says the LORD, who has compassion on you.
- 11 "Afflicted city, storm-battered, unpitied: I'm about to rebuild you with stones of turquoise, Lay your foundations with sapphires,
- 11 O afflicted city, lashed by storms and not comforted, I will build you with stones of turquoise, your foundations with sapphires.
- 12 construct your towers with rubies, Your gates with jewels, and all your walls with precious stones.
- 12 I will make your battlements of rubies, your gates of sparkling jewels, and all your walls of precious stones.
- 13 All your children will have GOD for their teacher-- what a mentor for your children!
- 13 All your sons will be taught by the LORD, and great will be your children's peace.
- 14 You'll be built solid, grounded in righteousness, far from any trouble-- nothing to fear! far from terror--it won't even come close!
- 14 In righteousness you will be established: Tyranny will be far from you; you will have nothing to fear. Terror will be far removed; it will not come near you.
- 15 If anyone attacks you, don't for a moment suppose that I sent them, And if any should attack, nothing will come of it.
- 15 If anyone does attack you, it will not be my doing; whoever attacks you will surrender to you.
- 16 I create the blacksmith who fires up his forge and makes a weapon designed to kill. I also create the destroyer--

- 16 See, it is I who created the blacksmith who fans the coals into flame and forges a weapon fit for its work. And it is I who have created the destroyer to work havoc;
- 17 but no weapon that can hurt you has ever been forged. Any accuser who takes you to court will be dismissed as a liar. This is what GOD's servants can expect. I'll see to it that everything works out for the best." GOD's Decree.
- 17 no weapon forged against you will prevail, and you will refute every tongue that accuses you. This is the heritage of the servants of the LORD, and this is their vindication from me," declares the LORD.

Isaiah 55

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Hey there! All who are thirsty, come to the water! Are you penniless? Come anyway--buy and eat! Come, buy your drinks, buy wine and milk. Buy without money--everything's free!
- 1 Come, all you who are thirsty, come to the waters; and you who have no money, come, buy and eat! Come, buy wine and milk without money and without cost.
- 2 Why do you spend your money on junk food, your hard-earned cash on cotton candy? Listen to me, listen well: Eat only the best, fill yourself with only the finest.
- 2 Why spend money on what is not bread, and your labor on what does not satisfy? Listen, listen to me, and eat what is good, and your soul will delight in the richest of fare.
- 3 Pay attention, come close now, listen carefully to my life-giving, life-nourishing words. I'm making a lasting covenant commitment with you, the same that I made with David: sure, solid, enduring love.
- 3 Give ear and come to me; hear me, that your soul may live. I will make an everlasting covenant with you, my faithful love promised to David.
- 4 I set him up as a witness to the nations, made him a prince and leader of the nations,
- 4 See, I have made him a witness to the peoples, a leader and commander of the peoples.

- 5 And now I'm doing it to you: You'll summon nations you've never heard of, and nations who've never heard of you will come running to you Because of me, your GOD, because The Holy of Israel has honored you."
- 5 Surely you will summon nations you know not, and nations that do not know you will hasten to you, because of the LORD your God, the Holy One of Israel, for he has endowed you with splendor."
- 6 Seek GOD while he's here to be found, pray to him while he's close at hand.
- 6 Seek the LORD while he may be found; call on him while he is near.
- 7 Let the wicked abandon their way of life and the evil their way of thinking. Let them come back to GOD, who is merciful, come back to our God, who is lavish with forgiveness.
- 7 Let the wicked forsake his way and the evil man his thoughts. Let him turn to the LORD, and he will have mercy on him, and to our God, for he will freely pardon.
- 8 "I don't think the way you think. The way you work isn't the way I work." GOD's Decree.
- 8 For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, declares the LORD.
- 9 "For as the sky soars high above earth, so the way I work surpasses the way you work, and the way I think is beyond the way you think.
- 9 As the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways and my thoughts than your thoughts.
- 10 Just as rain and snow descend from the skies and don't go back until they've watered the earth, Doing their work of making things grow and blossom, producing seed for farmers and food for the hungry,
- 10 As the rain and the snow come down from heaven, and do not return to it without watering the earth and making it bud and flourish, so that it yields seed for the sower and bread for the eater,
- 11 So will the words that come out of my mouth not come back empty-handed. They'll do the work I sent them to do, they'll complete the assignment I gave them.
- 11 so is my word that goes out from my mouth: It will not return to me empty, but will accomplish what I desire and achieve the purpose for which I sent it.

- 12 "So you'll go out in joy, you'll be led into a whole and complete life. The mountains and hills will lead the parade, bursting with song. All the trees of the forest will join the procession, exuberant with applause.
- 12 You will go out in joy and be led forth in peace; the mountains and hills will burst into song before you, and all the trees of the field will clap their hands.
- 13 No more thistles, but giant sequoias, no more thornbushes, but stately pines-- Monuments to me, to GOD, living and lasting evidence of GOD."
- 13 Instead of the thornbush will grow the pine tree, and instead of briars the myrtle will grow. This will be for the LORD's renown, for an everlasting sign, which will not be destroyed."

Isaiah 56

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message: "Guard my common good: Do what's right and do it in the right way, For salvation is just around the corner, my setting-things-right is about to go into action.
- 1 This is what the LORD says: "Maintain justice and do what is right, for my salvation is close at hand and my righteousness will soon be revealed.
- 2 How blessed are you who enter into these things, you men and women who embrace them, Who keep Sabbath and don't defile it, who watch your step and don't do anything evil!
- 2 Blessed is the man who does this, the man who holds it fast, who keeps the Sabbath without desecrating it, and keeps his hand from doing any evil."
- 3 Make sure no outsider who now follows GOD ever has occasion to say, 'GOD put me in second-class. I don't really belong.' And make sure no physically mutilated person is ever made to think, 'I'm damaged goods. I don't really belong.'"
- 3 Let no foreigner who has bound himself to the LORD say, "The LORD will surely exclude me from his people." And let not any eunuch complain, "I am only a dry tree."

- 4 For GOD says: "To the mutilated who keep my Sabbaths and choose what delights me and keep a firm grip on my covenant,
- 4 For this is what the LORD says: "To the eunuchs who keep my Sabbaths, who choose what pleases me and hold fast to my covenant--
- 5 I'll provide them an honored place in my family and within my city, even more honored than that of sons and daughters. I'll confer permanent honors on them that will never be revoked.
- 5 to them I will give within my temple and its walls a memorial and a name better than sons and daughters; I will give them an everlasting name that will not be cut off.
- 6 "And as for the outsiders who now follow me, working for me, loving my name, and wanting to be my servants-- All who keep Sabbath and don't defile it, holding fast to my covenant--
- 6 And foreigners who bind themselves to the LORD to serve him, to love the name of the LORD, and to worship him, all who keep the Sabbath without desecrating it and who hold fast to my covenant--
- 7 I'll bring them to my holy mountain and give them joy in my house of prayer. They'll be welcome to worship the same as the 'insiders,' to bring burnt offerings and sacrifices to my altar. Oh yes, my house of worship will be known as a house of prayer for all people."
- 7 these I will bring to my holy mountain and give them joy in my house of prayer. Their burnt offerings and sacrifices will be accepted on my altar; for my house will be called a house of prayer for all nations."
- 8 The Decree of the Master, GOD himself, who gathers in the exiles of Israel: "I will gather others also, gather them in with those already gathered."
- 8 The Sovereign LORD declares-- he who gathers the exiles of Israel: "I will gather still others to them besides those already gathered."
- 9 A call to the savage beasts: Come on the run. Come, devour, beast barbarians!
- 9 Come, all you beasts of the field, come and devour, all you beasts of the forest!
- 10 For Israel's watchmen are blind, the whole lot of them. They have no idea what's going on. They're dogs without sense enough to bark, lazy dogs, dreaming in the sun--

- 10 Israel's watchmen are blind, they all lack knowledge; they are all mute dogs, they cannot bark; they lie around and dream, they love to sleep.
- 11 But hungry dogs, they do know how to eat, voracious dogs, with never enough. And these are Israel's shepherds! They know nothing, understand nothing. They all look after themselves, grabbing whatever's not nailed down.
- 11 They are dogs with mighty appetites; they never have enough. They are shepherds who lack understanding; they all turn to their own way, each seeks his own gain.
- 12 "Come," they say, "let's have a party. Let's go out and get drunk!" And tomorrow, more of the same: "Let's live it up!"
- 12 Come, each one cries, "let me get wine! Let us drink our fill of beer! And tomorrow will be like today, or even far better."

Isaiah 57

MSG

NIV

- 1 Meanwhile, right-living people die and no one gives them a thought. God-fearing people are carted off and no one even notices. The right-living people are out of their misery, they're finally at rest.
- 1 The righteous perish, and no one ponders it in his heart; devout men are taken away, and no one understands that the righteous are taken away to be spared from evil.
- 2 They lived well and with dignity and now they're finally at peace.
- 2 Those who walk uprightly enter into peace; they find rest as they lie in death.
- 3 "But you, children of a witch, come here! Sons of a slut, daughters of a whore.
- 3 But you--come here, you sons of a sorceress, you offspring of adulterers and prostitutes!
- 4 What business do you have taunting, sneering, and sticking out your tongue? Do you have any idea what wretches you've turned out to be? A race of rebels, a generation of liars.
- 4 Whom are you mocking? At whom do you sneer and stick out your tongue? Are you not a brood of rebels, the offspring of liars?

- 5 You satisfy your lust any place you find some shade and fornicate at whim. You kill your children at any convenient spot-- any cave or crevasse will do.
- 5 You burn with lust among the oaks and under every spreading tree; you sacrifice your children in the ravines and under the overhanging crags.
- 6 You take stones from the creek and set up your sex-and-religion shrines. You've chosen your fate. Your worship will be your doom.
- 6 The idols among the smooth stones of the ravines are your portion; they, they are your lot. Yes, to them you have poured out drink offerings and offered grain offerings. In the light of these things, should I relent?
- 7 You've climbed a high mountain to practice your foul sex-and-death religion.
- 7 You have made your bed on a high and lofty hill; there you went up to offer your sacrifices.
- 8 Behind closed doors you assemble your precious gods and goddesses. Deserting me, you've gone all out, stripped down and made your bed your place of worship. You've climbed into bed with the 'sacred' whores and loved every minute of it, adoring every curve of their naked bodies.
- 8 Behind your doors and your doorposts you have put your pagan symbols. Forsaking me, you uncovered your bed, you climbed into it and opened it wide; you made a pact with those whose beds you love, and you looked on their nakedness.
- 9 You anoint your king-god with ointments and lavish perfumes on yourselves. You send scouts to search out the latest in religion, send them all the way to hell and back.
- 9 You went to Molech with olive oil and increased your perfumes. You sent your ambassadors far away; you descended to the grave itself!
- 10 You wear yourselves out trying the new and the different, and never see what a waste it all is. You've always found strength for the latest fad, never got tired of trying new religions.
- 10 You were wearied by all your ways, but you would not say, 'It is hopeless.' You found renewal of your strength, and so you did not faint.
- 11 "Who talked you into the pursuit of this nonsense, leaving me high and dry, forgetting you ever knew me? Because I don't yell and make a scene do you think I don't exist?

- 11 Whom have you so dreaded and feared that you have been false to me, and have neither remembered me nor pondered this in your hearts? Is it not because I have long been silent that you do not fear me?
- 12 I'll go over, detail by detail, all your 'righteous' attempts at religion, and expose the absurdity of it all.
- 12 I will expose your righteousness and your works, and they will not benefit you.
- 13 Go ahead, cry for help to your collection of no-gods: A good wind will blow them away. They're smoke, nothing but smoke. "But anyone who runs to me for help will inherit the land, will end up owning my holy mountain!"
- 13 When you cry out for help, let your collection of idols save you! The wind will carry all of them off, a mere breath will blow them away. But the man who makes me his refuge will inherit the land and possess my holy mountain."
- 14 Someone says: "Build, build! Make a road! Clear the way, remove the rocks from the road my people will travel."
- 14 And it will be said: "Build up, build up, prepare the road! Remove the obstacles out of the way of my people."
- 15 A Message from the high and towering God, who lives in Eternity, whose name is Holy: "I live in the high and holy places, but also with the low-spirited, the spirit-crushed, And what I do is put new spirit in them, get them up and on their feet again.
- 15 For this is what the high and lofty One says-- he who lives forever, whose name is holy: "I live in a high and holy place, but also with him who is contrite and lowly in spirit, to revive the spirit of the lowly and to revive the heart of the contrite.
- 16 For I'm not going to haul people into court endlessly, I'm not going to be angry forever. Otherwise, people would lose heart. These souls I created would tire out and give up.
- 16 I will not accuse forever, nor will I always be angry, for then the spirit of man would grow faint before me-- the breath of man that I have created.
- 17 I was angry, good and angry, because of Israel's sins. I struck him hard and turned away in anger, while he kept at his stubborn, willful ways.

- 17 I was enraged by his sinful greed; I punished him, and hid my face in anger, yet he kept on in his willful ways.
- 18 When I looked again and saw what he was doing, I decided to heal him, lead him, and comfort him, creating a new language of praise for the mourners.
- 18 I have seen his ways, but I will heal him; I will guide him and restore comfort to him,
- 19 Peace to the far-off, peace to the near-at-hand," says GOD-- "and yes, I will heal them.
- 19 creating praise on the lips of the mourners in Israel. Peace, peace, to those far and near," says the LORD. "And I will heal them."
- 20 But the wicked are storm-battered seas that can't quiet down. The waves stir up garbage and mud.
- 20 But the wicked are like the tossing sea, which cannot rest, whose waves cast up mire and mud.
- 21 There's no peace," God says, "for the wicked.
- 21 There is no peace, says my God, "for the wicked."

Isaiah 58

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Shout! A full-throated shout! Hold nothing back--a trumpet-blast shout! Tell my people what's wrong with their lives, face my family Jacob with their sins!
- 1 Shout it aloud, do not hold back. Raise your voice like a trumpet. Declare to my people their rebellion and to the house of Jacob their sins.
- 2 They're busy, busy, busy at worship, and love studying all about me. To all appearances they're a nation of right-living people-- law-abiding, God-honoring. They ask me, 'What's the right thing to do?' and love having me on their side.
- 2 For day after day they seek me out; they seem eager to know my ways, as if they were a nation that does what is right and has not forsaken the commands of its God. They ask me for just decisions and seem eager for God to come near them.

- 3 But they also complain, 'Why do we fast and you don't look our way? Why do we humble ourselves and you don't even notice?' "Well, here's why: "The bottom line on your 'fast days' is profit. You drive your employees much too hard.
- 3 'Why have we fasted,' they say, 'and you have not seen it? Why have we humbled ourselves, and you have not noticed?' "Yet on the day of your fasting, you do as you please and exploit all your workers.
- 4 You fast, but at the same time you bicker and fight. You fast, but you swing a mean fist. The kind of fasting you do won't get your prayers off the ground.
- 4 Your fasting ends in quarreling and strife, and in striking each other with wicked fists. You cannot fast as you do today and expect your voice to be heard on high.
- 5 Do you think this is the kind of fast day I'm after: a day to show off humility? To put on a pious long face and parade around solemnly in black? Do you call that fasting, a fast day that I, GOD, would like?
- 5 Is this the kind of fast I have chosen, only a day for a man to humble himself? Is it only for bowing one's head like a reed and for lying on sackcloth and ashes? Is that what you call a fast, a day acceptable to the LORD?
- 6 "This is the kind of fast day I'm after: to break the chains of injustice, get rid of exploitation in the workplace, free the oppressed, cancel debts.
- 6 Is not this the kind of fasting I have chosen: to loose the chains of injustice and untie the cords of the yoke, to set the oppressed free and break every yoke?
- 7 What I'm interested in seeing you do is: sharing your food with the hungry, inviting the homeless poor into your homes, putting clothes on the shivering ill-clad, being available to your own families.
- 7 Is it not to share your food with the hungry and to provide the poor wanderer with shelter-- when you see the naked, to clothe him, and not to turn away from your own flesh and blood?
- 8 Do this and the lights will turn on, and your lives will turn around at once. Your righteousness will pave your way. The GOD of glory will secure your passage.
- 8 Then your light will break forth like the dawn, and your healing will quickly appear; then your righteousness will go before you, and the glory

- of the LORD will be your rear guard.
- 9 Then when you pray, GOD will answer. You'll call out for help and I'll say, 'Here I am.' "If you get rid of unfair practices, quit blaming victims, quit gossiping about other people's sins,
- 9 Then you will call, and the LORD will answer; you will cry for help, and he will say: Here am I. "If you do away with the yoke of oppression, with the pointing finger and malicious talk,
- 10 If you are generous with the hungry and start giving yourselves to the down-and-out, Your lives will begin to glow in the darkness, your shadowed lives will be bathed in sunlight.
- 10 and if you spend yourselves in behalf of the hungry and satisfy the needs of the oppressed, then your light will rise in the darkness, and your night will become like the noonday.
- 11 I will always show you where to go. I'll give you a full life in the emptiest of places-- firm muscles, strong bones. You'll be like a well-watered garden, a gurgling spring that never runs dry.
- 11 The LORD will guide you always; he will satisfy your needs in a sun-scorched land and will strengthen your frame. You will be like a well-watered garden, like a spring whose waters never fail.
- 12 You'll use the old rubble of past lives to build anew, rebuild the foundations from out of your past. You'll be known as those who can fix anything, restore old ruins, rebuild and renovate, make the community livable again.
- 12 Your people will rebuild the ancient ruins and will raise up the age-old foundations; you will be called Repairer of Broken Walls, Restorer of Streets with Dwellings.
- 13 "If you watch your step on the Sabbath and don't use my holy day for personal advantage, If you treat the Sabbath as a day of joy, GOD's holy day as a celebration, If you honor it by refusing 'business as usual,' making money, running here and there--
- 13 If you keep your feet from breaking the Sabbath and from doing as you please on my holy day, if you call the Sabbath a delight and the LORD's holy day honorable, and if you honor it by not going your own way and not doing as you please or speaking idle words,

- 14 Then you'll be free to enjoy GOD! Oh, I'll make you ride high and soar above it all. I'll make you feast on the inheritance of your ancestor Jacob." Yes! GOD says so!
- 14 then you will find your joy in the LORD, and I will cause you to ride on the heights of the land and to feast on the inheritance of your father Jacob." The mouth of the LORD has spoken.

Isaiah 59

MSG

NIV

- 1 Look! Listen! GOD's arm is not amputated--he can still save. GOD's ears are not stopped up--he can still hear.
- 1 Surely the arm of the LORD is not too short to save, nor his ear too dull to hear.
- 2 There's nothing wrong with God; the wrong is in you. Your wrongheaded lives caused the split between you and God. Your sins got between you so that he doesn't hear.
- 2 But your iniquities have separated you from your God; your sins have hidden his face from you, so that he will not hear.
- 3 Your hands are drenched in blood, your fingers dripping with guilt, Your lips smeared with lies, your tongue swollen from muttering obscenities.
- 3 For your hands are stained with blood, your fingers with guilt. Your lips have spoken lies, and your tongue mutters wicked things.
- 4 No one speaks up for the right, no one deals fairly. They trust in illusion, they tell lies, they get pregnant with mischief and have sin-babies.
- 4 No one calls for justice; no one pleads his case with integrity. They rely on empty arguments and speak lies; they conceive trouble and give birth to evil.
- 5 They hatch snake eggs and weave spider webs. Eat an egg and die; break an egg and get a snake!
- 5 They hatch the eggs of vipers and spin a spider's web. Whoever eats their eggs will die, and when one is broken, an adder is hatched.
- 6 The spider webs are no good for shirts or shawls. No one can wear these weavings! They weave wickedness, they hatch violence.

- 6 Their cobwebs are useless for clothing; they cannot cover themselves with what they make. Their deeds are evil deeds, and acts of violence are in their hands.
- 7 They compete in the race to do evil and run to be the first to murder. They plan and plot evil, think and breathe evil, and leave a trail of wrecked lives behind them.
- 7 Their feet rush into sin; they are swift to shed innocent blood. Their thoughts are evil thoughts; ruin and destruction mark their ways.
- 8 They know nothing about peace and less than nothing about justice. They make tortuously twisted roads. No peace for the wretch who walks down those roads!
- 8 The way of peace they do not know; there is no justice in their paths. They have turned them into crooked roads; no one who walks in them will know peace.
- 9 Which means that we're a far cry from fair dealing, and we're not even close to right living. We long for light but sink into darkness, long for brightness but stumble through the night.
- 9 So justice is far from us, and righteousness does not reach us. We look for light, but all is darkness; for brightness, but we walk in deep shadows.
- 10 Like the blind, we inch along a wall, groping eyeless in the dark. We shuffle our way in broad daylight, like the dead, but somehow walking.
- 10 Like the blind we grope along the wall, feeling our way like men without eyes. At midday we stumble as if it were twilight; among the strong, we are like the dead.
- 11 We're no better off than bears, groaning, and no worse off than doves, moaning. We look for justice--not a sign of it; for salvation--not so much as a hint.
- 11 We all growl like bears; we moan mournfully like doves. We look for justice, but find none; for deliverance, but it is far away.
- 12 Our wrongdoings pile up before you, God, our sins stand up and accuse us. Our wrongdoings stare us down; we know in detail what we've done:
- 12 For our offenses are many in your sight, and our sins testify against us. Our offenses are ever with us, and we acknowledge our iniquities:
- 13 Mocking and denying GOD, not following our God, Spreading false rumors, inciting sedition, pregnant with lies, muttering malice.

- 13 rebellion and treachery against the LORD, turning our backs on our God, fomenting oppression and revolt, uttering lies our hearts have conceived.
- 14 Justice is beaten back, Righteousness is banished to the sidelines, Truth staggers down the street, Honesty is nowhere to be found,
- 14 So justice is driven back, and righteousness stands at a distance; truth has stumbled in the streets, honesty cannot enter.
- 15 Good is missing in action. Anyone renouncing evil is beaten and robbed. GOD looked and saw evil looming on the horizon-- so much evil and no sign of Justice.
- 15 Truth is nowhere to be found, and whoever shuns evil becomes a prey. The LORD looked and was displeased that there was no justice.
- 16 He couldn't believe what he saw: not a soul around to correct this awful situation. So he did it himself, took on the work of Salvation, fueled by his own Righteousness.
- 16 He saw that there was no one, he was appalled that there was no one to intervene; so his own arm worked salvation for him, and his own righteousness sustained him.
- 17 He dressed in Righteousness, put it on like a suit of armor, with Salvation on his head like a helmet, Put on Judgment like an overcoat, and threw a cloak of Passion across his shoulders.
- 17 He put on righteousness as his breastplate, and the helmet of salvation on his head; he put on the garments of vengeance and wrapped himself in zeal as in a cloak.
- 18 He'll make everyone pay for what they've done: fury for his foes, just deserts for his enemies. Even the far-off islands will get paid off in full.
- 18 According to what they have done, so will he repay wrath to his enemies and retribution to his foes; he will repay the islands their due.
- 19 In the west they'll fear the name of GOD, in the east they'll fear the glory of GOD, For he'll arrive like a river in flood stage, whipped to a torrent by the wind of GOD.
- 19 From the west, men will fear the name of the LORD, and from the rising of the sun, they will revere his glory. For he will come like a pent-up flood that the breath of the LORD drives along.
- 20 "I'll arrive in Zion as Redeemer, to those in Jacob who leave their sins." GOD's Decree.

- 20 The Redeemer will come to Zion, to those in Jacob who repent of their sins, declares the LORD.
- 21 "As for me," GOD says, "this is my covenant with them: My Spirit that I've placed upon you and the words that I've given you to speak, they're not going to leave your mouths nor the mouths of your children nor the mouths of your grandchildren. You will keep repeating these words and won't ever stop." GOD's orders.
- 21 As for me, this is my covenant with them, says the LORD. "My Spirit, who is on you, and my words that I have put in your mouth will not depart from your mouth, or from the mouths of your children, or from the mouths of their descendants from this time on and forever," says the LORD.

Isaiah 60

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Get out of bed, Jerusalem! Wake up. Put your face in the sunlight. GOD's bright glory has risen for you.
- 1 Arise, shine, for your light has come, and the glory of the LORD rises upon you.
- 2 The whole earth is wrapped in darkness, all people sunk in deep darkness, But GOD rises on you, his sunrise glory breaks over you.
- 2 See, darkness covers the earth and thick darkness is over the peoples, but the LORD rises upon you and his glory appears over you.
- 3 Nations will come to your light, kings to your sunburst brightness.
- 3 Nations will come to your light, and kings to the brightness of your dawn.
- 4 Look up! Look around! Watch as they gather, watch as they approach you: Your sons coming from great distances, your daughters carried by their nannies.
- 4 Lift up your eyes and look about you: All assemble and come to you; your sons come from afar, and your daughters are carried on the arm.
- 5 When you see them coming you'll smile--big smiles! Your heart will swell and, yes, burst! All those people returning by sea for the reunion, a rich harvest of exiles gathered in from the nations!

- 5 Then you will look and be radiant, your heart will throb and swell with joy; the wealth on the seas will be brought to you, to you the riches of the nations will come.
- 6 And then streams of camel caravans as far as the eye can see, young camels of nomads in Midian and Ephah, Pouring in from the south from Sheba, loaded with gold and frankincense, preaching the praises of GOD.
- 6 Herds of camels will cover your land, young camels of Midian and Ephah. And all from Sheba will come, bearing gold and incense and proclaiming the praise of the LORD.
- 7 And yes, a great roundup of flocks from the nomads in Kedar and Nebaioth, Welcome gifts for worship at my altar as I bathe my glorious Temple in splendor.
- 7 All Kedar's flocks will be gathered to you, the rams of Nebaioth will serve you; they will be accepted as offerings on my altar, and I will adorn my glorious temple.
- 8 "What's that we see in the distance, a cloud on the horizon, like doves darkening the sky?
- 8 Who are these that fly along like clouds, like doves to their nests?
- 9 It's ships from the distant islands, the famous Tarshish ships Returning your children from faraway places, loaded with riches, with silver and gold, And backed by the name of your GOD, The Holy of Israel, showering you with splendor.
- 9 Surely the islands look to me; in the lead are the ships of Tarshish, bringing your sons from afar, with their silver and gold, to the honor of the LORD your God, the Holy One of Israel, for he has endowed you with splendor.
- 10 Foreigners will rebuild your walls, and their kings assist you in the conduct of worship. When I was angry I hit you hard. It's my desire now to be tender.
- 10 Foreigners will rebuild your walls, and their kings will serve you. Though in anger I struck you, in favor I will show you compassion.
- 11 Your Jerusalem gates will always be open --open house day and night!-- Receiving deliveries of wealth from all nations, and their kings, the delivery boys!

- 11 Your gates will always stand open, they will never be shut, day or night, so that men may bring you the wealth of the nations-- their kings led in triumphal procession.
- 12 Any nation or kingdom that doesn't deliver will perish; those nations will be totally wasted.
- 12 For the nation or kingdom that will not serve you will perish; it will be utterly ruined.
- 13 The rich woods of Lebanon will be delivered --all that cypress and oak and pine-- To give a splendid elegance to my Sanctuary, as I make my footstool glorious.
- 13 The glory of Lebanon will come to you, the pine, the fir and the cypress together, to adorn the place of my sanctuary; and I will glorify the place of my feet.
- 14 The descendants of your oppressor will come bowing and scraping to you. All who looked down at you in contempt will lick your boots. They'll confer a title on you: City of GOD, Zion of The Holy of Israel.
- 14 The sons of your oppressors will come bowing before you; all who despise you will bow down at your feet and will call you the City of the LORD, Zion of the Holy One of Israel.
- 15 Not long ago you were despised refuse-- out-of-the-way, unvisited, ignored. But now I've put you on your feet, towering and grand forever, a joy to look at!
- 15 Although you have been forsaken and hated, with no one traveling through, I will make you the everlasting pride and the joy of all generations.
- 16 When you suck the milk of nations and the breasts of royalty, You'll know that I, GOD, am your Savior, your Redeemer, Champion of Jacob.
- 16 You will drink the milk of nations and be nursed at royal breasts. Then you will know that I, the LORD, am your Savior, your Redeemer, the Mighty One of Jacob.
- 17 I'll give you only the best--no more hand-me-downs! Gold instead of bronze, silver instead of iron, bronze instead of wood, iron instead of stones. I'll install Peace to run your country, make Righteousness your boss.
- 17 Instead of bronze I will bring you gold, and silver in place of iron. Instead of wood I will bring you bronze, and iron in place of stones. I

- will make peace your governor and righteousness your ruler.
- 18 There'll be no more stories of crime in your land, no more robberies, no more vandalism. You'll name your main street Salvation Way, and install Praise Park at the center of town.
- 18 No longer will violence be heard in your land, nor ruin or destruction within your borders, but you will call your walls Salvation and your gates Praise.
- 19 You'll have no more need of the sun by day nor the brightness of the moon at night. GOD will be your eternal light, your God will bathe you in splendor.
- 19 The sun will no more be your light by day, nor will the brightness of the moon shine on you, for the LORD will be your everlasting light, and your God will be your glory.
- 20 Your sun will never go down, your moon will never fade. I will be your eternal light. Your days of grieving are over.
- 20 Your sun will never set again, and your moon will wane no more; the LORD will be your everlasting light, and your days of sorrow will end.
- 21 All your people will live right and well, in permanent possession of the land. They're the green shoot that I planted, planted with my own hands to display my glory.
- 21 Then will all your people be righteous and they will possess the land forever. They are the shoot I have planted, the work of my hands, for the display of my splendor.
- 22 The runt will become a great tribe, the weakling become a strong nation. I am GOD. At the right time I'll make it happen."
- 22 The least of you will become a thousand, the smallest a mighty nation. I am the LORD; in its time I will do this swiftly."

Isaiah 61

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Spirit of GOD, the Master, is on me because GOD anointed me. He sent me to preach good news to the poor, heal the heartbroken, Announce freedom to all captives, pardon all prisoners.

- 1 The Spirit of the Sovereign LORD is on me, because the LORD has anointed me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim freedom for the captives and release from darkness for the prisoners,
- 2 GOD sent me to announce the year of his grace-- a celebration of God's destruction of our enemies-- and to comfort all who mourn,
- 2 to proclaim the year of the LORD's favor and the day of vengeance of our God, to comfort all who mourn,
- 3 To care for the needs of all who mourn in Zion, give them bouquets of roses instead of ashes, Messages of joy instead of news of doom, a praising heart instead of a languid spirit. Rename them "Oaks of Righteousness" planted by GOD to display his glory.
- 3 and provide for those who grieve in Zion-- to bestow on them a crown of beauty instead of ashes, the oil of gladness instead of mourning, and a garment of praise instead of a spirit of despair. They will be called oaks of righteousness, a planting of the LORD for the display of his splendor.
- 4 They'll rebuild the old ruins, raise a new city out of the wreckage. They'll start over on the ruined cities, take the rubble left behind and make it new.
- 4 They will rebuild the ancient ruins and restore the places long devastated; they will renew the ruined cities that have been devastated for generations.
- 5 You'll hire outsiders to herd your flocks and foreigners to work your fields,
- 5 Aliens will shepherd your flocks; foreigners will work your fields and vineyards.
- 6 But you'll have the title "Priests of GOD," honored as ministers of our God. You'll feast on the bounty of nations, you'll bask in their glory.
- 6 And you will be called priests of the LORD, you will be named ministers of our God. You will feed on the wealth of nations, and in their riches you will boast.
- 7 Because you got a double dose of trouble and more than your share of contempt, Your inheritance in the land will be doubled and your joy go on forever.
- 7 Instead of their shame my people will receive a double portion, and instead of disgrace they will rejoice in their inheritance; and so they will

- inherit a double portion in their land, and everlasting joy will be theirs.
- 8 "Because I, GOD, love fair dealing and hate thievery and crime, I'll pay your wages on time and in full, and establish my eternal covenant with you.
- 8 For I, the LORD, love justice; I hate robbery and iniquity. In my faithfulness I will reward them and make an everlasting covenant with them.
- 9 Your descendants will become well-known all over. Your children in foreign countries Will be recognized at once as the people I have blessed."
- 9 Their descendants will be known among the nations and their offspring among the peoples. All who see them will acknowledge that they are a people the LORD has blessed."
- 10 I will sing for joy in GOD, explode in praise from deep in my soul! He dressed me up in a suit of salvation, he outfitted me in a robe of righteousness, As a bridegroom who puts on a tuxedo and a bride a jeweled tiara.
- 10 I delight greatly in the LORD; my soul rejoices in my God. For he has clothed me with garments of salvation and arrayed me in a robe of righteousness, as a bridegroom adorns his head like a priest, and as a bride adorns herself with her jewels.
- 11 For as the earth bursts with spring wildflowers, and as a garden cascades with blossoms, So the Master, GOD, brings righteousness into full bloom and puts praise on display before the nations.
- 11 For as the soil makes the sprout come up and a garden causes seeds to grow, so the Sovereign LORD will make righteousness and praise spring up before all nations.

Isaiah 62

MSG

NIV

- 1 Regarding Zion, I can't keep my mouth shut, regarding Jerusalem, I can't hold my tongue, Until her righteousness blazes down like the sun and her salvation flames up like a torch.

- 1 For Zion's sake I will not keep silent, for Jerusalem's sake I will not remain quiet, till her righteousness shines out like the dawn, her salvation like a blazing torch.
- 2 Foreign countries will see your righteousness, and world leaders your glory. You'll get a brand-new name straight from the mouth of GOD.
- 2 The nations will see your righteousness, and all kings your glory; you will be called by a new name that the mouth of the LORD will bestow.
- 3 You'll be a stunning crown in the palm of GOD's hand, a jeweled gold cup held high in the hand of your God.
- 3 You will be a crown of splendor in the LORD's hand, a royal diadem in the hand of your God.
- 4 No more will anyone call you Rejected, and your country will no more be called Ruined. You'll be called Hephzibah (My Delight), and your land Beulah (Married), Because GOD delights in you and your land will be like a wedding celebration.
- 4 No longer will they call you Deserted, or name your land Desolate. But you will be called Hephzibah, and your land Beulah; for the LORD will take delight in you, and your land will be married.
- 5 For as a young man marries his virgin bride, so your builder marries you, And as a bridegroom is happy in his bride, so your God is happy with you.
- 5 As a young man marries a maiden, so will your sons marry you; as a bridegroom rejoices over his bride, so will your God rejoice over you.
- 6 I've posted watchmen on your walls, Jerusalem. Day and night they keep at it, praying, calling out, reminding GOD to remember.
- 6 I have posted watchmen on your walls, O Jerusalem; they will never be silent day or night. You who call on the LORD, give yourselves no rest,
- 7 They are to give him no peace until he does what he said, until he makes Jerusalem famous as the City of Praise.
- 7 and give him no rest till he establishes Jerusalem and makes her the praise of the earth.
- 8 GOD has taken a solemn oath, an oath he means to keep: "Never again will I open your grain-filled barns to your enemies to loot and eat. Never again will foreigners drink the wine that you worked so hard to produce.
- 8 The LORD has sworn by his right hand and by his mighty arm: "Never again will I give your grain as food for your enemies, and never again

- will foreigners drink the new wine for which you have toiled;
- 9 No. The farmers who grow the food will eat the food and praise GOD for it. And those who make the wine will drink the wine in my holy courtyards."
- 9 but those who harvest it will eat it and praise the LORD, and those who gather the grapes will drink it in the courts of my sanctuary."
- 10 Walk out of the gates. Get going! Get the road ready for the people. Build the highway. Get at it! Clear the debris, hoist high a flag, a signal to all peoples!
- 10 Pass through, pass through the gates! Prepare the way for the people. Build up, build up the highway! Remove the stones. Raise a banner for the nations.
- 11 Yes! GOD has broadcast to all the world: "Tell daughter Zion, 'Look! Your Savior comes, Ready to do what he said he'd do, prepared to complete what he promised.'"
- 11 The LORD has made proclamation to the ends of the earth: "Say to the Daughter of Zion, 'See, your Savior comes! See, his reward is with him, and his recompense accompanies him.' "
- 12 Zion will be called new names: Holy People, GOD-Redeemed, Sought-Out, City-Not-Forsaken.
- 12 They will be called the Holy People, the Redeemed of the LORD; and you will be called Sought After, the City No Longer Deserted.

Isaiah 63

MSG

NIV

- 1 The watchmen call out, "Who goes there, marching out of Edom, out of Bozrah in clothes dyed red? Name yourself, so splendidly dressed, advancing, bristling with power!" "It is I: I speak what is right, I, mighty to save!"
- 1 Who is this coming from Edom, from Bozrah, with his garments stained crimson? Who is this, robed in splendor, striding forward in the greatness of his strength? "It is I, speaking in righteousness, mighty to save."

- 2 "And why are your robes so red, your clothes dyed red like those who tread grapes?"
- 2 Why are your garments red, like those of one treading the winepress?
- 3 "I've been treading the winepress alone. No one was there to help me. Angrily, I stomped the grapes; raging, I trampled the people. Their blood spurted all over me-- all my clothes were soaked with blood.
- 3 I have trodden the winepress alone; from the nations no one was with me. I trampled them in my anger and trod them down in my wrath; their blood spattered my garments, and I stained all my clothing.
- 4 I was set on vengeance. The time for redemption had arrived.
- 4 For the day of vengeance was in my heart, and the year of my redemption has come.
- 5 I looked around for someone to help --no one. I couldn't believe it --not one volunteer. So I went ahead and did it myself, fed and fueled by my rage.
- 5 I looked, but there was no one to help, I was appalled that no one gave support; so my own arm worked salvation for me, and my own wrath sustained me.
- 6 I trampled the people in my anger, crushed them under foot in my wrath, soaked the earth with their lifeblood."
- 6 I trampled the nations in my anger; in my wrath I made them drunk and poured their blood on the ground."
- 7 I'll make a list of GOD's gracious dealings, all the things GOD has done that need praising, All the generous bounties of GOD, his great goodness to the family of Israel-- Compassion lavished, love extravagant.
- 7 I will tell of the kindnesses of the LORD, the deeds for which he is to be praised, according to all the LORD has done for us-- yes, the many good things he has done for the house of Israel, according to his compassion and many kindnesses.
- 8 He said, "Without question these are my people, children who would never betray me." So he became their Savior.
- 8 He said, "Surely they are my people, sons who will not be false to me"; and so he became their Savior.
- 9 In all their troubles, he was troubled, too. He didn't send someone else to help them. He did it himself, in person. Out of his own love and pity he

redeemed them. He rescued them and carried them along for a long, long time.

9 In all their distress he too was distressed, and the angel of his presence saved them. In his love and mercy he redeemed them; he lifted them up and carried them all the days of old.

10 But they turned on him; they grieved his Holy Spirit. So he turned on them, became their enemy and fought them.

10 Yet they rebelled and grieved his Holy Spirit. So he turned and became their enemy and he himself fought against them.

11 Then they remembered the old days, the days of Moses, God's servant: "Where is he who brought the shepherds of his flock up and out of the sea? And what happened to the One who set his Holy Spirit within them?

11 Then his people recalled the days of old, the days of Moses and his people-- where is he who brought them through the sea, with the shepherd of his flock? Where is he who set his Holy Spirit among them,

12 Who linked his arm with Moses' right arm, divided the waters before them, Making him famous ever after,

12 who sent his glorious arm of power to be at Moses' right hand, who divided the waters before them, to gain for himself everlasting renown,

13 and led them through the muddy abyss as surefooted as horses on hard, level ground?

13 who led them through the depths? Like a horse in open country, they did not stumble;

14 Like a herd of cattle led to pasture, the Spirit of GOD gave them rest." That's how you led your people! That's how you became so famous!

14 like cattle that go down to the plain, they were given rest by the Spirit of the LORD. This is how you guided your people to make for yourself a glorious name.

15 Look down from heaven, look at us! Look out the window of your holy and magnificent house! Whatever happened to your passion, your famous mighty acts, Your heartfelt pity, your compassion? Why are you holding back?

15 Look down from heaven and see from your lofty throne, holy and glorious. Where are your zeal and your might? Your tenderness and compassion are withheld from us.

- 16 You are our Father. Abraham and Israel are long dead. They wouldn't know us from Adam. But you're our living Father, our Redeemer, famous from eternity!
- 16 But you are our Father, though Abraham does not know us or Israel acknowledge us; you, O LORD, are our Father, our Redeemer from of old is your name.
- 17 Why, GOD, did you make us wander from your ways? Why did you make us cold and stubborn so that we no longer worshiped you in awe? Turn back for the sake of your servants. You own us! We belong to you!
- 17 Why, O LORD, do you make us wander from your ways and harden our hearts so we do not revere you? Return for the sake of your servants, the tribes that are your inheritance.
- 18 For a while your holy people had it good, but now our enemies have wrecked your holy place.
- 18 For a little while your people possessed your holy place, but now our enemies have trampled down your sanctuary.
- 19 For a long time now, you've paid no attention to us. It's like you never knew us.
- 19 We are yours from of old; but you have not ruled over them, they have not been called by your name.

Isaiah 64

MSG

NIV

- 1 Oh, that you would rip open the heavens and descend, make the mountains shudder at your presence--
- 1 Oh, that you would rend the heavens and come down, that the mountains would tremble before you!
- 2 As when a forest catches fire, as when fire makes a pot to boil--
- 2 As when fire sets twigs ablaze and causes water to boil, come down to make your name known to your enemies and cause the nations to quake before you!
- 3 To shock your enemies into facing you, make the nations shake in their boots! You did terrible things we never expected, descended and made the mountains shudder at your presence.

- 3 For when you did awesome things that we did not expect, you came down, and the mountains trembled before you.
- 4 Since before time began no one has ever imagined, No ear heard, no eye seen, a God like you who works for those who wait for him.
- 4 Since ancient times no one has heard, no ear has perceived, no eye has seen any God besides you, who acts on behalf of those who wait for him.
- 5 You meet those who happily do what is right, who keep a good memory of the way you work. But how angry you've been with us! We've sinned and kept at it so long! Is there any hope for us? Can we be saved?
- 5 You come to the help of those who gladly do right, who remember your ways. But when we continued to sin against them, you were angry. How then can we be saved?
- 6 We're all sin-infected, sin-contaminated. Our best efforts are grease-stained rags. We dry up like autumn leaves-- sin-dried, we're blown off by the wind.
- 6 All of us have become like one who is unclean, and all our righteous acts are like filthy rags; we all shrivel up like a leaf, and like the wind our sins sweep us away.
- 7 No one prays to you or makes the effort to reach out to you Because you've turned away from us, left us to stew in our sins.
- 7 No one calls on your name or strives to lay hold of you; for you have hidden your face from us and made us waste away because of our sins.
- 8 Still, GOD, you are our Father. We're the clay and you're our potter: All of us are what you made us.
- 8 Yet, O LORD, you are our Father. We are the clay, you are the potter; we are all the work of your hand.
- 9 Don't be too angry with us, O GOD. Don't keep a permanent account of wrongdoing. Keep in mind, please, we are your people--all of us.
- 9 Do not be angry beyond measure, O LORD; do not remember our sins forever. Oh, look upon us, we pray, for we are all your people.
- 10 Your holy cities are all ghost towns: Zion's a ghost town, Jerusalem's a field of weeds.
- 10 Your sacred cities have become a desert; even Zion is a desert, Jerusalem a desolation.
- 11 Our holy and beautiful Temple, which our ancestors filled with your praises, Was burned down by fire, all our lovely parks and gardens in

ruins.

- 11 Our holy and glorious temple, where our fathers praised you, has been burned with fire, and all that we treasured lies in ruins.
- 12 In the face of all this, are you going to sit there unmoved, GOD? Aren't you going to say something? Haven't you made us miserable long enough?
- 12 After all this, O LORD, will you hold yourself back? Will you keep silent and punish us beyond measure?

Isaiah 65

MSG

NIV

- 1 "I've made myself available to those who haven't bothered to ask. I'm here, ready to be found by those who haven't bothered to look. I kept saying 'I'm here, I'm right here' to a nation that ignored me.
- 1 I revealed myself to those who did not ask for me; I was found by those who did not seek me. To a nation that did not call on my name, I said, 'Here am I, here am I.'
- 2 I reached out day after day to a people who turned their backs on me, People who make wrong turns, who insist on doing things their own way.
- 2 All day long I have held out my hands to an obstinate people, who walk in ways not good, pursuing their own imaginations--
- 3 They get on my nerves, are rude to my face day after day, Make up their own kitchen religion, a potluck religious stew.
- 3 a people who continually provoke me to my very face, offering sacrifices in gardens and burning incense on altars of brick;
- 4 They spend the night in tombs to get messages from the dead, Eat forbidden foods and drink a witch's brew of potions and charms.
- 4 who sit among the graves and spend their nights keeping secret vigil; who eat the flesh of pigs, and whose pots hold broth of unclean meat;
- 5 They say, 'Keep your distance. Don't touch me. I'm holier than thou.' These people gag me. I can't stand their stench.
- 5 who say, 'Keep away; don't come near me, for I am too sacred for you!' Such people are smoke in my nostrils, a fire that keeps burning all day.

- 6 Look at this! Their sins are all written out-- I have the list before me. I'm not putting up with this any longer. I'll pay them the wages
- 6 See, it stands written before me: I will not keep silent but will pay back in full; I will pay it back into their laps--
- 7 They have coming for their sins. And for the sins of their parents lumped in, a bonus." GOD says so. "Because they've practiced their blasphemous worship, mocking me at their hillside shrines, I'll let loose the consequences and pay them in full for their actions."
- 7 both your sins and the sins of your fathers," says the LORD. "Because they burned sacrifices on the mountains and defied me on the hills, I will measure into their laps the full payment for their former deeds."
- 8 GOD's Message: "But just as one bad apple doesn't ruin the whole bushel, there are still plenty of good apples left. So I'll preserve those in Israel who obey me. I won't destroy the whole nation.
- 8 This is what the LORD says: "As when juice is still found in a cluster of grapes and men say, 'Don't destroy it, there is yet some good in it,' so will I do in behalf of my servants; I will not destroy them all.
- 9 I'll bring out my true children from Jacob and the heirs of my mountains from Judah. My chosen will inherit the land, my servants will move in.
- 9 I will bring forth descendants from Jacob, and from Judah those who will possess my mountains; my chosen people will inherit them, and there will my servants live.
- 10 The lush valley of Sharon in the west will be a pasture for flocks, And in the east, the valley of Achor, a place for herds to graze. These will be for the people who bothered to reach out to me, who wanted me in their lives, who actually bothered to look for me.
- 10 Sharon will become a pasture for flocks, and the Valley of Achor a resting place for herds, for my people who seek me.
- 11 "But you who abandon me, your GOD, who forget the holy mountains, Who hold dinners for Lady Luck and throw cocktail parties for Sir Fate,
- 11 But as for you who forsake the LORD and forget my holy mountain, who spread a table for Fortune and fill bowls of mixed wine for Destiny,
- 12 Well, you asked for it. Fate it will be: your destiny, Death. For when I invited you, you ignored me; when I spoke to you, you brushed me off. You did the very things I exposed as evil; you chose what I hate."

- 12 I will destine you for the sword, and you will all bend down for the slaughter; for I called but you did not answer, I spoke but you did not listen. You did evil in my sight and chose what displeases me."
- 13 Therefore, this is the Message from the Master, GOD: "My servants will eat, and you'll go hungry; My servants will drink, and you'll go thirsty; My servants will rejoice, and you'll hang your heads.
- 13 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: "My servants will eat, but you will go hungry; my servants will drink, but you will go thirsty; my servants will rejoice, but you will be put to shame.
- 14 My servants will laugh from full hearts, and you'll cry out heartbroken, yes, wail from crushed spirits.
- 14 My servants will sing out of the joy of their hearts, but you will cry out from anguish of heart and wail in brokenness of spirit.
- 15 Your legacy to my chosen will be your name reduced to a cussword. I, GOD, will put you to death and give a new name to my servants.
- 15 You will leave your name to my chosen ones as a curse; the Sovereign LORD will put you to death, but to his servants he will give another name.
- 16 Then whoever prays a blessing in the land will use my faithful name for the blessing, And whoever takes an oath in the land will use my faithful name for the oath, Because the earlier troubles are gone and forgotten, banished far from my sight.
- 16 Whoever invokes a blessing in the land will do so by the God of truth; he who takes an oath in the land will swear by the God of truth. For the past troubles will be forgotten and hidden from my eyes.
- 17 "Pay close attention now: I'm creating new heavens and a new earth. All the earlier troubles, chaos, and pain are things of the past, to be forgotten.
- 17 Behold, I will create new heavens and a new earth. The former things will not be remembered, nor will they come to mind.
- 18 Look ahead with joy. Anticipate what I'm creating: I'll create Jerusalem as sheer joy, create my people as pure delight.
- 18 But be glad and rejoice forever in what I will create, for I will create Jerusalem to be a delight and its people a joy.
- 19 I'll take joy in Jerusalem, take delight in my people: No more sounds of weeping in the city, no cries of anguish;

- 19 I will rejoice over Jerusalem and take delight in my people; the sound of weeping and of crying will be heard in it no more.
- 20 No more babies dying in the cradle, or old people who don't enjoy a full lifetime; One-hundredth birthdays will be considered normal-- anything less will seem like a cheat.
- 20 Never again will there be in it an infant who lives but a few days, or an old man who does not live out his years; he who dies at a hundred will be thought a mere youth; he who fails to reach a hundred will be considered accursed.
- 21 They'll build houses and move in. They'll plant fields and eat what they grow.
- 21 They will build houses and dwell in them; they will plant vineyards and eat their fruit.
- 22 No more building a house that some outsider takes over, No more planting fields that some enemy confiscates, For my people will be as long-lived as trees, my chosen ones will have satisfaction in their work.
- 22 No longer will they build houses and others live in them, or plant and others eat. For as the days of a tree, so will be the days of my people; my chosen ones will long enjoy the works of their hands.
- 23 They won't work and have nothing come of it, they won't have children snatched out from under them. For they themselves are plantings blessed by GOD, with their children and grandchildren likewise GOD-blessed.
- 23 They will not toil in vain or bear children doomed to misfortune; for they will be a people blessed by the LORD, they and their descendants with them.
- 24 Before they call out, I'll answer. Before they've finished speaking, I'll have heard.
- 24 Before they call I will answer; while they are still speaking I will hear.
- 25 Wolf and lamb will graze the same meadow, lion and ox eat straw from the same trough, but snakes--they'll get a diet of dirt! Neither animal nor human will hurt or kill anywhere on my Holy Mountain," says GOD.
- 25 The wolf and the lamb will feed together, and the lion will eat straw like the ox, but dust will be the serpent's food. They will neither harm nor destroy on all my holy mountain," says the LORD.

Isaiah 66

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message: "Heaven's my throne, earth is my footstool. What sort of house could you build for me? What holiday spot reserve for me?
- 1 This is what the LORD says: "Heaven is my throne, and the earth is my footstool. Where is the house you will build for me? Where will my resting place be?
- 2 I made all this! I own all this!" GOD's Decree. "But there is something I'm looking for: a person simple and plain, reverently responsive to what I say.
- 2 Has not my hand made all these things, and so they came into being?" declares the LORD. "This is the one I esteem: he who is humble and contrite in spirit, and trembles at my word.
- 3 "Your acts of worship are acts of sin: Your sacrificial slaughter of the ox is no different from murdering the neighbor; Your offerings for worship, no different from dumping pig's blood on the altar; Your presentation of memorial gifts, no different from honoring a no-god idol. You choose self-serving worship, you delight in self-centered worship--disgusting!
- 3 But whoever sacrifices a bull is like one who kills a man, and whoever offers a lamb, like one who breaks a dog's neck; whoever makes a grain offering is like one who presents pig's blood, and whoever burns memorial incense, like one who worships an idol. They have chosen their own ways, and their souls delight in their abominations;
- 4 Well, I choose to expose your nonsense and let you realize your worst fears, Because when I invited you, you ignored me; when I spoke to you, you brushed me off. You did the very things I exposed as evil, you chose what I hate."
- 4 so I also will choose harsh treatment for them and will bring upon them what they dread. For when I called, no one answered, when I spoke, no one listened. They did evil in my sight and chose what displeases me."
- 5 But listen to what GOD has to say to you who reverently respond to his Word: "Your own families hate you and turn you out because of me. They taunt you, 'Let us see GOD's glory! If God's so great, why aren't you happy?' But they're the ones who are going to end up shamed."

- 5 Hear the word of the LORD, you who tremble at his word: "Your brothers who hate you, and exclude you because of my name, have said, 'Let the LORD be glorified, that we may see your joy!' Yet they will be put to shame.
- 6 Rumbles of thunder from the city! A voice out of the Temple! GOD's voice, handing out judgment to his enemies:
- 6 Hear that uproar from the city, hear that noise from the temple! It is the sound of the LORD repaying his enemies all they deserve.
- 7 "Before she went into labor, she had the baby. Before the birth pangs hit, she delivered a son.
- 7 Before she goes into labor, she gives birth; before the pains come upon her, she delivers a son.
- 8 Has anyone ever heard of such a thing? Has anyone seen anything like this? A country born in a day? A nation born in a flash? But Zion was barely in labor when she had her babies!
- 8 Who has ever heard of such a thing? Who has ever seen such things? Can a country be born in a day or a nation be brought forth in a moment? Yet no sooner is Zion in labor than she gives birth to her children.
- 9 Do I open the womb and not deliver the baby? Do I, the One who delivers babies, shut the womb?
- 9 Do I bring to the moment of birth and not give delivery?" says the LORD. "Do I close up the womb when I bring to delivery?" says your God.
- 10 "Rejoice, Jerusalem, and all who love her, celebrate! And all you who have shed tears over her, join in the happy singing.
- 10 Rejoice with Jerusalem and be glad for her, all you who love her; rejoice greatly with her, all you who mourn over her.
- 11 You newborns can satisfy yourselves at her nurturing breasts. Yes, delight yourselves and drink your fill at her ample bosom."
- 11 For you will nurse and be satisfied at her comforting breasts; you will drink deeply and delight in her overflowing abundance."
- 12 GOD's Message: "I'll pour robust well-being into her like a river, the glory of nations like a river in flood. You'll nurse at her breasts, nestle in her bosom, and be bounced on her knees.
- 12 For this is what the LORD says: "I will extend peace to her like a river, and the wealth of nations like a flooding stream; you will nurse and be

carried on her arm and dandled on her knees.

13 As a mother comforts her child, so I'll comfort you. You will be comforted in Jerusalem."

13 As a mother comforts her child, so will I comfort you; and you will be comforted over Jerusalem."

14 You'll see all this and burst with joy --you'll feel ten feet tall-- As it becomes apparent that GOD is on your side and against his enemies.

14 When you see this, your heart will rejoice and you will flourish like grass; the hand of the LORD will be made known to his servants, but his fury will be shown to his foes.

15 For GOD arrives like wildfire and his chariots like a tornado, A furious outburst of anger, a rebuke fierce and fiery.

15 See, the LORD is coming with fire, and his chariots are like a whirlwind; he will bring down his anger with fury, and his rebuke with flames of fire.

16 For it's by fire that GOD brings judgment, a death sentence on the human race. Many, oh so many, are under GOD's sentence of death:

16 For with fire and with his sword the LORD will execute judgment upon all men, and many will be those slain by the LORD.

17 "All who enter the sacred groves for initiation in those unholy rituals that climaxed in that foul and obscene meal of pigs and mice will eat together and then die together." GOD's Decree.

17 Those who consecrate and purify themselves to go into the gardens, following the one in the midst of those who eat the flesh of pigs and rats and other abominable things--they will meet their end together, declares the LORD.

18 "I know everything they've ever done or thought. I'm going to come and then gather everyone--all nations, all languages. They'll come and see my glory.

18 And I, because of their actions and their imaginations, am about to come and gather all nations and tongues, and they will come and see my glory.

19 I'll set up a station at the center. I'll send the survivors of judgment all over the world: Spain and Africa, Turkey and Greece, and the far-off islands that have never heard of me, who know nothing of what I've done

nor who I am. I'll send them out as missionaries to preach my glory among the nations.

- 19 I will set a sign among them, and I will send some of those who survive to the nations--to Tarshish, to the Libyans and Lydians (famous as archers), to Tubal and Greece, and to the distant islands that have not heard of my fame or seen my glory. They will proclaim my glory among the nations.
- 20 They'll return with all your long-lost brothers and sisters from all over the world. They'll bring them back and offer them in living worship to GOD. They'll bring them on horses and wagons and carts, on mules and camels, straight to my holy mountain Jerusalem," says GOD. "They'll present them just as Israelites present their offerings in a ceremonial vessel in the Temple of GOD.
- 20 And they will bring all your brothers, from all the nations, to my holy mountain in Jerusalem as an offering to the LORD--on horses, in chariots and wagons, and on mules and camels," says the LORD. "They will bring them, as the Israelites bring their grain offerings, to the temple of the LORD in ceremonially clean vessels.
- 21 I'll even take some of them and make them priests and Levites," says GOD.
- 21 And I will select some of them also to be priests and Levites," says the LORD.
- 22 "For just as the new heavens and new earth that I am making will stand firm before me" --GOD's Decree-- "So will your children and your reputation stand firm.
- 22 As the new heavens and the new earth that I make will endure before me, declares the LORD, "so will your name and descendants endure.
- 23 Month after month and week by week, everyone will come to worship me," GOD says.
- 23 From one New Moon to another and from one Sabbath to another, all mankind will come and bow down before me," says the LORD.
- 24 "And then they'll go out and look at what happened to those who rebelled against me. Corpses! Maggots endlessly eating away on them, an endless supply of fuel for fires. Everyone who sees what's happened and smells the stench retches."

24 And they will go out and look upon the dead bodies of those who rebelled against me; their worm will not die, nor will their fire be quenched, and they will be loathsome to all mankind.